Manual del Permiso B en Lectura Fácil

GOBIERNO DE ESPAÑA

MINISTERIO DEL INTERIOR

DGT
Dirección General de Tráfico

Edited by the Ministry of the Interior - Directorate-General for Traffic

Based on the content of:

C/ Puerto Navacerrada, 128 Industrial Estate "Las Nieves" 28935 Móstoles (Madrid)

Publications Catalogue of the General State Administration (CPAGE) https://cpage.mpr.gob.es/

NIPO: 128250063

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This document has been adapted and validated following the UNE 153101:2018 EX Easy-to-Read standard.

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GENERAL INDEX

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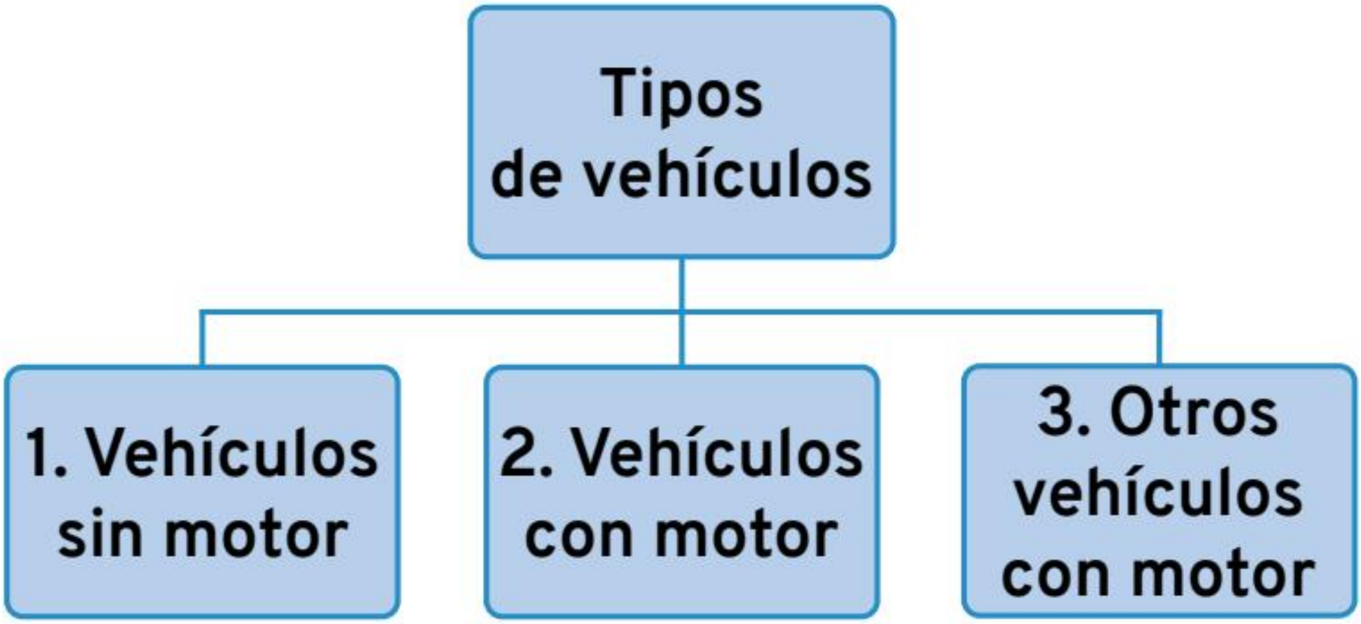
Definitions related to vehicles

Vehicle

Device prepared to travel on roads, streets, highways, and land of all kinds.



Ver vídeo

Non-motor vehicles

Non-motor vehicles
Animal-drawn vehicle
Cycle and bicycle
Trailer
Semi-trailer

Animal-drawn vehicles

For example, a horse-drawn carriage.

Cycle

Vehicle with two or more wheels that has pedals. It moves by the energy and effort of the person riding it.

A bicycle is a two-wheeled cycle.

Ver vídeo

Trailer

Platform with wheels that is attached to a motor vehicle, by means of an axle, to carry loads.

Axle. Bar that goes through an object and helps it move and turn.

In a trailer, the axle makes the load spread out and makes it easier to drive.

Light trailer	Heavy trailer
With load it weighs a maximum of 750 kilos.	With load it can weigh more than 750 kilos.

Semi-trailer

Trailer that is attached directly to a motor vehicle, without an axle.

Light semi-trailer	Non-light semi-trailer
With load it weighs a maximum of 750 kilos.	With load it can weigh more than 750 kilos.

Motor vehicles

Vehicles that need an engine to work. Motor vehicles are classified into:

■ Motor vehicles

They are used to carry people and goods. They are also used to move or tow other vehicles.

Ver vídeo

■ Special vehicles

They are used to do specific jobs or services. Some have their own engine and others are towed. For example, excavators to move earth and tractors to work in the countryside.

There are different types of motor vehicles and special vehicles:

Motor vehicles	
	Two-wheeled motorcycles
	Motorcycles with sidecar
	Three-wheeled vehicles
	Heavy quadricycle (or quadricycle)
	Car
	Pick-up
	Car-derived van
	Adaptable mixed-use vehicle
	Bus / Coach
	Trolleybus
	Lorry

	Furgón / Furgoneta
	Tractocamión
	Vehículo articulado
	Tren de carretera

Special vehicles	
Motorised	
	Quad - ATV
	Tractor
	Motor cultivator
	Self-propelled machine
Towed	
	Agricultural trailer
Towed machine	

Motor vehicles Motorcycles

[Watch video]

Two-wheeled vehicles that must meet at least one of these two characteristics related to **engine capacity** and speed:

- ■ If it is petrol, have an engine with an engine capacity greater than 50 cubic centimetres or, which is the same, 0.05 litres.
- ■ Reach a speed greater than 45 kilometres per hour.

Engine capacity. Measurement used to calculate the power of an engine.

The greater the engine capacity, the greater its power.

Engine capacity is measured in litres or in cubic centimetres.

Motorcycles with sidecar

They are three-wheeled motorcycles that have a seat on the side for another person to sit.

They must meet the same engine capacity and speed characteristics as two-wheeled motorcycles.

Three-wheeled vehicle

Vehicle with three symmetrical wheels that must meet the same engine capacity and speed characteristics as two-wheeled motorcycles and sidecars.

Heavy quadricycle

Four-wheeled motor vehicle that meets these characteristics:

- ■ With load and passengers it weighs a maximum of 450 kilos if it carries people, or 600 kilos if it carries goods.
- ■ The maximum power the engine can have is 15 **kilowatts**.

Kilowatt. Unit used to measure the maximum power a device can have.

Car

Motor vehicle used to carry people.

It has at least four wheels.

It can have a maximum of nine seats, including the driver’s seat.

Ver vídeo

Car-derived van

Motor vehicle with the **bodywork** of a car, but used to carry goods instead of people.

It only has one row of seats to leave more space for goods.

Bodywork. Structure that gives the motor vehicle its shape.

Pick-up

Vehicle in which the seats for people and the load area are separated into two different spaces.

With load and passengers it weighs a maximum of 3,500 kilos.

Adaptable mixed-use vehicle

Vehicle used to carry people or goods.

The seats can be put in or taken out depending on how you want to use the vehicle.

A maximum of nine people can travel in it.

Bus or coach

Vehicle with more than nine seats used to carry people and their luggage.

Lorry

Vehicle with four wheels or more used to carry goods.

Ver vídeo

It has two parts:

- ■ The cab. Space with seats where the passengers and the driver travel. It can have a maximum of nine seats.
- ■ Rest of the lorry. Space at the back. It is the place where the goods travel.

Van

Vehicle with four wheels or more used to carry goods.

Unlike a lorry, the cab and the rest of the vehicle are together, not separated.

Tractor unit

Vehicle used to tow the semi-trailer.

Combination of vehicles

Motor vehicle made up of a motor vehicle and a trailer or semi-trailer attached or connected to it.

Ver vídeo

There are three types of combinations of vehicles:

1. Road train. The trailer is attached to the motor vehicle by means of an axle.

- 2. Articulated vehicle. The semi-trailer is connected to the motor vehicle, without an axle.
- 3. Euromodular configuration. Connected vehicles that have at least 6 axles on their wheels.

Axles connect the wheels to each other and help them turn.

Special vehicles

Quad ATV

Vehicle with four wheels or more that is used more for driving on hills or tracks than on roads.

It is driven with handlebars, like a motorcycle.

Tractor

Vehicle with four wheels or more that has a very large engine.

It is used to carry or tow materials and heavy loads.

Ver vídeo

The tractor is used mainly for field work (agricultural tractor) and in construction (works tractor).

Motor cultivator

Small vehicle that has an engine and wheels.

The person driving it walks and moves it by means of a long part, like handlebars.

This long part is part of the motor cultivator.

It is used mainly in gardening and agriculture to turn over the soil in vegetable gardens or small plots of land.

Self-propelled machine

Vehicle with four wheels or more that is used to do work in the countryside and in construction.

Towed vehicles

There are two types:

- 1. Agricultural trailer Vehicle to do work in the countryside. It must be towed by a tractor or by other special vehicles.

- 2. Towed machine Vehicle that is used to do work on building sites, in the countryside, or in other services. It must be towed by another special vehicle.

Other types of motor vehicles

Some vehicles that have an engine are not considered motor vehicles because they have special characteristics.

Vehicles not considered motor vehicles	
	Tram
	Moped
	Vehicles for people with reduced mobility
	Pedal bicycle with motor
	Personal mobility vehicle

Tram

It runs on rails placed on the road or in the street.

Ver vídeo

Moped

Vehicles with two, three, or four wheels. They have low-power engines. The maximum speed they reach is 45 kilometres per hour. On mopeds, a maximum of two people can travel.

Vehicles for people with reduced mobility

They are made to be used by people who have a physical disability. The maximum speed they reach is 45 kilometres per hour. They weigh a maximum of 350 kilos.

Pedal bicycles with motor

Personal mobility vehicles

They have an electric motor that reaches a speed of between 6 and 25 kilometres per hour.

For example, the electric scooter.

In this type of vehicle, only one person can travel.

Definitions related to people

Driver

Person who drives a vehicle. It is also the person who controls the additional controls in driving school vehicles to learn to drive.

Pedestrian

Person who walks on the pavement and the road. Pedestrians are also people who:

- ■ Pull or push a pram, a wheelchair, or any small vehicle without an engine.
- ■ Walk and take with them a cycle or a two-wheeled moped.
- ■ Travel in a wheelchair.

Vehicle holder

Person who has the vehicle registered in their name in the corresponding official register.

This person will always carry in the vehicle the documents that say they are the holder and will show them to the authorities when they ask for them.

The vehicle holder is responsible for making sure that people who do not have a driving licence do not drive that vehicle.

Usual driver

Person who usually drives a vehicle, even if they are not the holder.

The usual driver must have the driving licence needed to drive that vehicle.

The vehicle holder is the one who authorises that person to be the usual driver.

Categories of vehicles depending on their use

Category	Use
M	Motor vehicles made to transport people and their luggage.
	For example, cars and buses.
N	Motor vehicles made
	to transport goods.
	For example, vans and lorries.
O	Trailers made to transport people and goods.

Contents

Documents needed to drive

To drive a vehicle you need the following documents:

You must always carry these documents in the vehicle when you drive, to show them to the authorities who are responsible for monitoring traffic.

These documents must be the originals. You can also present a photocopy of the documents certified by an official public body. For example, the town hall, the police, or a notary.

Certify. An official body certifies that the copy of the document is authentic

When you need to adapt the vehicle to drive, you must request a special permit and make the necessary changes to the vehicle.

For example, fitting hand controls on the steering wheel for people who have a disability in their legs and difficulty using the car pedals.

We are going to learn about the 4 documents that a driver must have, what they are for, and how they are used.

Driving licence

Document that authorises a person to drive and ensures that they meet the requirements to do so.

Types of driving licence

You must obtain one licence or another depending on the vehicle you are going to drive:

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Ver vídeo

Type of	Vehicles	Minimum age
licence AM	that you can drive Mopeds with two or three wheels and light quadricycles. Vehicles for people with reduced mobility.	to drive 15 years
A1	Motorcycles with a maximum engine capacity of 125 cubic centimetres and a maximum power of 11 kilowatts. Motor tricycles with a maximum power of 15 kilowatts.	16 years
A2	Motorcycles with a maximum power of 35 kilowatts.	18 years
A	Motorcycles and tricycles with any type of engine and power.	20 years

B	**Mopeds.** **Vehicles** **for people** **with reduced mobility.** **Motor vehicles** **that can carry** **up to nine passengers.** **Special** **agricultural vehicles.** **Special** **non-agricultural vehicles** **that reach a** **maximum speed** **of 40 kilometres** **per hour** **and do not weigh more** **than 3,500 kilos.** **Combination of vehicles** **when the trailer** **does not carry a weight greater** **than 750 kilos.**	**18 years**
B+E	Combination of vehicles. The trailer can carry a load of up to 3,500 kilos.	18 years

Points-based driving licence

When you get the driving licence you are given 8 points.

You will lose some of these points or all of them if you commit a serious or very serious offence. For example, using your mobile phone while driving.

You can recover the points after some time by doing a re-education course for driving. This course lasts 12 hours.

New drivers

A person who gets the driving licence is called a new driver during the first year.

New drivers must display in the car a green rectangular plate with a white letter L.

This plate is placed on the rear window of the car.

It must be clearly visible so that other drivers know that the car is being driven by a new driver.

When must you renew your Category B driving licence?

- ■ Every 10 years if you are under 65 years old.
- ■ Every 5 years if you are over 65 years old.

You must apply to renew the licence before it expires.

You must also apply again for the driving licence if you lose it, it is stolen, or any of your personal details change. For example, your address.

Registration certificate

Document that confirms that a vehicle has a **registration number plate** and is authorised to circulate.

Which vehicles must have a registration certificate?

- ■ All motor vehicles.
- ■ Mopeds.
- ■ Trailers and semi-trailers that can transport more than 750 kilos.

Registration number plate. Set of letters and numbers that identify vehicles.

Each vehicle has a different registration number plate, which is stamped on a metal plate and placed on the vehicle.

What information appears on the registration certificate?

- ■ First name, surname(s), and address of the vehicle holder.
- ■ Vehicle registration number and the date it was registered.
- ■ Number of seats the vehicle has.
- ■ Use of the vehicle. That is, whether it is used to transport people or goods.
- ■ Maximum weight the vehicle can carry.

The holder of a vehicle must report any change in their details to the Traffic Headquarters.

You must do it no later than 15 days after the change.

You must also report if you sell or hand over the vehicle to another person. In this case, you have 10 days to report it. The person who buys or receives the vehicle must request that the registration certificate be renewed in their name.

Ver vídeo

Vehicle roadworthiness inspection card (ITV)

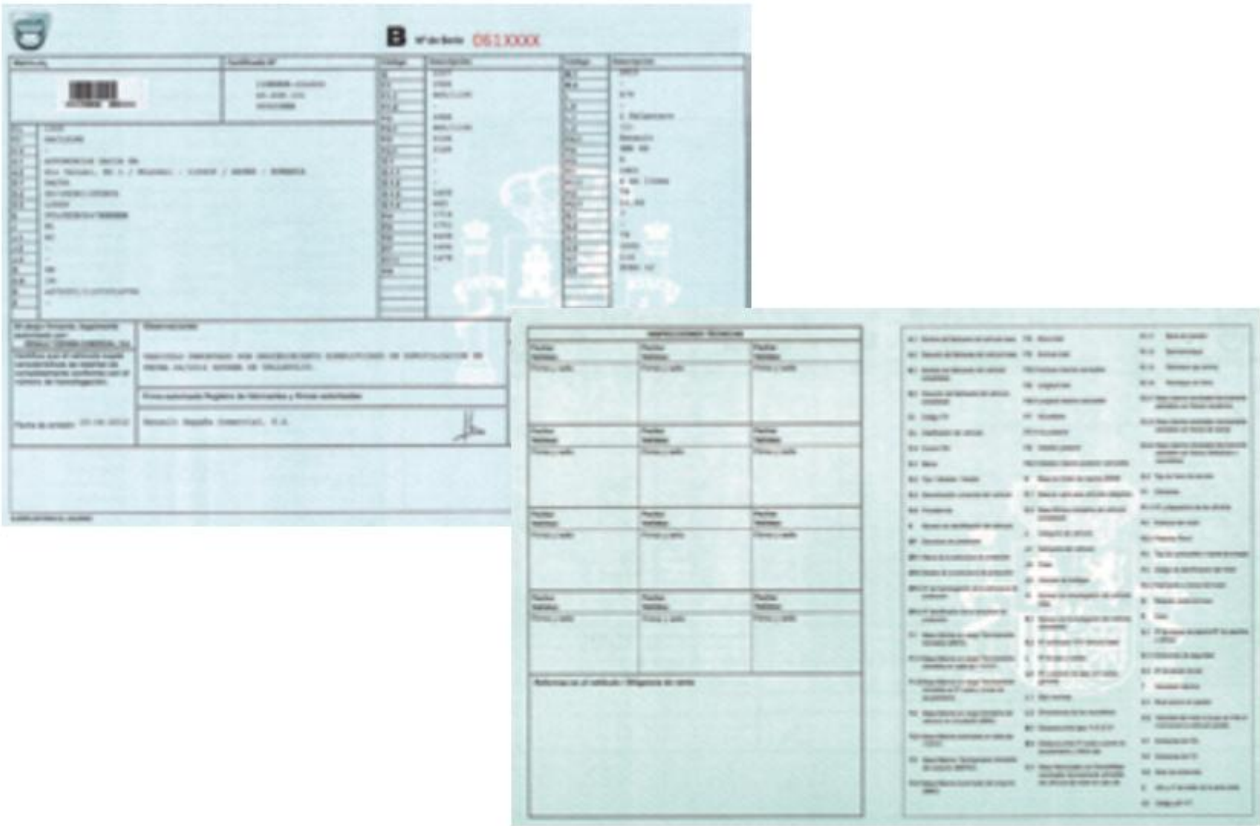
Document that proves that a vehicle has no faults and is in good condition to be used.

Which vehicles must have the roadworthiness inspection card?

- ■ All motor vehicles.
- ■ All mopeds.
- ■ All trailers and semi-trailers.

What information appears on the roadworthiness inspection card?

- ■ Vehicle characteristics.
- ■ Record of the inspections the vehicle has passed.



When must you have your vehicle’s roadworthiness inspection (ITV)?

To know when each vehicle must be inspected, you must take into account what type of vehicle it is, how many years old it is, and what it is used for: whether it is a car, a special vehicle...

Types of vehicle	When to have the roadworthiness inspection (ITV)
Two-wheeled mopeds	First inspection at 3 years. After 3 years, inspection every 2 years.
Three-wheeled mopeds and light quadricycles Motorcycles, three-wheeled vehicles and heavy quadricycles	First inspection at 4 years. After 4 years, inspection every 2 years.
Quads	

Motor vehicles that can carry	First inspection at 4 years. After 4 years, inspection every 2 years.
up to nine passengers	After 10 years, inspection every year.
Motor vehicles that can carry goods with a weight of up to 3.5 tonnes	First inspection at 2 years. After 2 years, inspection every 2 years. After 6 years, inspection every year. After 10 years, inspection every 6 months.
Trailers to carry goods or people or to accommodate people Except the towed caravan	First inspection at 1 year. Up to 10 years, inspection every year. After 10 years, once every 6 months.
Towed caravan	First inspection at 6 years. After 6 years, every 2 years.

You must also have a roadworthiness inspection when the vehicle is modified, or if it has had an accident and the structure has been damaged.

The vehicle holder is the person responsible for checking that the roadworthiness inspections are carried out.

Roadworthiness inspection results

When the vehicle is in good condition, the ITV technicians:

- ■ Write on the roadworthiness inspection card that the vehicle is OK and the date of the next inspection.
- ■ Give you a sticker. You must place it inside the vehicle, on the right-hand side of the windscreen.
- ■ Give you a report. You must always carry it in the vehicle.

When the vehicle has a serious fault or problem:

- ■ You cannot continue driving.
- ■ You must take it to a garage to have it repaired.
- ■ Once repaired, you must take it for a new inspection to check that it can drive again.

Compulsory third-party liability insurance

People who have a motor vehicle have the obligation to take out and pay for insurance. This insurance is used to protect other people, objects, or vehicles if you have an accident. This insurance is called third-party liability insurance.

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Which vehicles must have compulsory third-party liability insurance?

All motor vehicles if the owner lives in Spain, except:

- ■ Trains and trams.
- ■ Wheelchairs.
- ■ Motorised toys.

Other vehicles that do not need to have third-party liability insurance are trailers, semi-trailers, and towed machines that cannot carry more than 750 kilos.

What does compulsory insurance cover?

- ■ Damage that your vehicle causes to an object. For example, repairing a street lamp if you crash into it.
- ■ Damage to another person. For example, if you run over a pedestrian.

However, the insurance does not cover damage to another person if it is that person who behaves badly. For example, if a pedestrian throws themselves against your car so that you run them over.

It will also not cover damage to a person for reasons that are not related to driving.

For example, a road traffic accident caused by a hurricane or a fire.

What does compulsory insurance not cover?

- ■ Injuries suffered in an accident by the driver of the insured vehicle. For example, it does not pay the medical costs of a driver who loses a leg in an accident.
- ■ Damage suffered by objects that are inside the car of the person who is driving.
- ■ Damage that the accident causes to the objects of the insured person, the person who is driving, or their family members. For example, it does not cover repairing a garage door that a driver breaks when entering the home of their brother.
- ■ Damage to people who are not wearing a helmet if it is compulsory to wear one.

■ Accidents and damage that occur in a stolen vehicle.

When there is an accident, the drivers of all vehicles have to inform their insurers. They must do it no later than 7 days after the accident.

What are the consequences of not insuring the vehicle?

- ■ The vehicle cannot be driven. If a traffic officer stops you, they will immobilise the vehicle at that moment.
- ■ The owner of the vehicle has to pay the costs of the place where the vehicle is kept while it has no insurance.
- ■ The owner of the vehicle has to pay a fine.

You must always carry in the vehicle the proof of payment of the insurance. This way you can prove that the vehicle is insured.

This proof will show the following information:

- ■ Name of the insurance company.
- ■ Vehicle registration number.
- ■ Insurance certificate.
- ■ Date when the insurance must be renewed.
- ■ Indication of what damage the insurance covers.

Responsible persons

As a general rule, the person who commits an offence or infringement as a driver or pedestrian is the one who must pay the fine or the penalty.

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However, there are cases in which drivers are responsible for an offence or infringement, even if they did not cause the accident.

These cases are:

■ Drivers and passengers who are not wearing a helmet in vehicles where it is compulsory to wear one.

■ Drivers who carry minors in vehicles where children of that age are not allowed to travel.

When traffic offences or infringements are committed by a person under 18 years of age, the fine must be paid by their father, mother, or guardian.

The person who is the holder of a vehicle is responsible for offences or infringements related to:

- ■ The vehicle documentation.
- ■ Not complying with the vehicle inspections.
- ■ The condition of the vehicle.

Contents

Physical and psychological condition of the driver

You must be in good physical and psychological condition to drive.

There are many physical and psychological factors that affect your safety and that of other people when you drive a vehicle.

For example, your ability to see well, your mood, and the time you take to react to unexpected events that happen on the road.

In addition, you must have enough training to handle the vehicle and understand all traffic rules.

Vision

Through our eyes we receive most of the information needed to drive well.

Some of this information is: road condition, traffic signs, distance to objects, and the speed of other vehicles.

To drive well it is necessary to see the things in front of you, to the sides, and behind.

But some factors make you see less:

- ■ Drinking alcohol.
- ■ Taking drugs.
- ■ Being tired.
- ■ Driving too fast.

Mood

Changes in mood can make you lose concentration and cause a road traffic accident.

For example, having a strong argument while driving or receiving very sad news before driving can change your mood.

Reaction time

It is the time that passes between hearing or seeing something and reacting.

For example, the time that passes between seeing a red traffic light and stopping the car.

In normal conditions, the reaction time of a person who is driving is between half a second and one second.

Factors that make a person take longer to react:

- ■ Being tired (fatigue).
- ■ Being sleepy.
- ■ Being very old.
- ■ Hearing or seeing badly.
- ■ Illnesses.
- ■ Some medicines.
- ■ Alcohol and drugs.
- ■ Eating a lot before driving.
- ■ Too much heat in the car.
- ■ Altered mood.
- ■ Paying little attention to driving.

Factors that influence the driver’s condition

Being tired (fatigue)

It is one of the main risks that can cause accidents on the road.

Fatigue can be physical or psychological. Physical fatigue produces a feeling of tiredness and psychological fatigue makes it harder for you to concentrate.

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What can cause fatigue?

- ■ The condition of the road.
- ■ The condition of the vehicle.
- ■ The condition of the driver.

The condition of the road:

- ■ Road with heavy traffic.
- ■ The road surface is in poor condition.
- ■ You do not know the road.
- ■ Difficult weather: rain, fog, snow, or too much heat.

The condition of the vehicle:

■ Too much heat inside the vehicle. The right temperature is about 23 degrees.

- ■ You drive at night with poor lighting.
- ■ You drive in a vehicle in poor condition or that makes too much noise.
- ■ You are uncomfortable in the seat.

The condition of the driver:

- ■ You drive for many hours without resting or you take very short breaks.
- ■ You drive fast for a long time.
- ■ You drive sleepy, after drinking alcohol, or you are in poor health.
- ■ You do long journeys and at night when you are not used to doing them.
- ■ You have had your driving licence for a short time.
- ■ You drive with your body in a bad posture.

What are the symptoms of fatigue?

There are some signs that warn you that you are suffering from fatigue and you must stop driving.

These signs are:

- ■ Difficulty concentrating on the road.
- ■ Your eyes feel heavy and you start to see badly.
- ■ You hear badly.
- ■ Feeling that your arms are numb.
- ■ Feeling of pressure in your head.
- ■ You move a lot in the seat and change posture.
- ■ You make slower movements.
- ■ Feeling more nervous and irritable.
- ■ Difficulty making decisions about driving.
- ■ You take longer to react.

Being sleepy (drowsiness)

Many road traffic accidents are related to driving while sleepy.

It is not necessary to fall completely asleep to have an accident for this reason. The symptoms of drowsiness appear before falling fully asleep.

Drowsiness.

A state in which you feel tired, heavy in the body, and sleepy.

What can cause drowsiness?

- ■ Sleeping fewer hours than usual.
- ■ Changing the hours when you usually sleep.
- ■ Sleeping badly, even if you sleep many hours.
- ■ Driving on roads with little traffic.
- ■ Drinking alcohol or taking medicines before driving.
- ■ Having illnesses related to sleep.
- ■ Driving at dawn or at midday, after eating.

What are the symptoms of drowsiness?

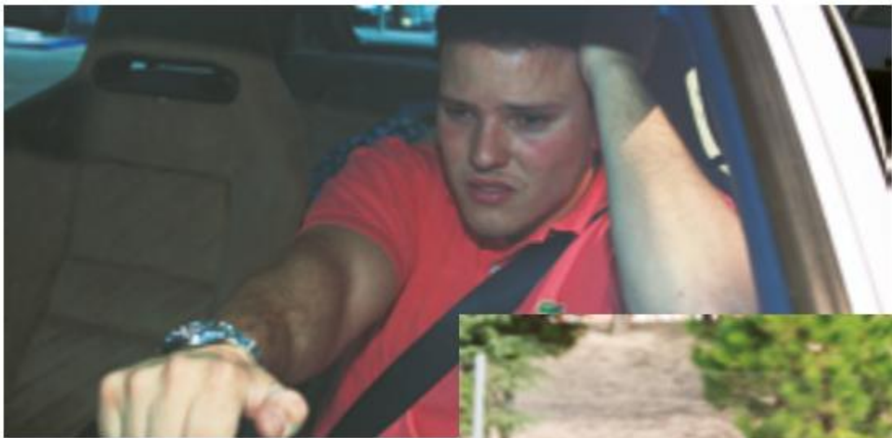
There are some signs that warn you that you are suffering from drowsiness and you must stop driving.

These signs are:

- ■ Difficulty keeping your head upright, or keeping your eyes open.
- ■ Blurred vision.
- ■ Yawning many times.
- ■ Losing concentration or having meaningless thoughts.
- ■ Getting distracted by anything.
- ■ Being restless or irritable.
- ■ Difficulty remembering the last kilometres you have travelled.
- ■ Drifting out of your lane.
- ■ Not paying attention to traffic signs or to the place where you must leave the road.
- ■ Driving very close to the vehicle in front of yours.

Effects of drowsiness:

- ■ Taking longer than normal to react.
- ■ Difficulty making decisions about driving.
- ■ Feeling that it is hard to make movements with your body or you make them more slowly.
- ■ Falling asleep for a few seconds without realising it.



How can you avoid fatigue and drowsiness?

- ■ Stop the vehicle in a safe place when you feel the first symptoms and sleep for 20 or 30 minutes.
- ■ Rest for 20 or 30 minutes every two hours or every 200 kilometres, even if you do not feel fatigue or drowsiness.
- ■ If you have a fatigue detector, follow what it tells you. It is a system that works through sensors and recognises if the person is very tired or about to fall asleep. In those cases it warns you by a light, sound, or vibration in the steering wheel so that you stop the vehicle and do not have an accident.

Sensor. Devices that capture information about things that happen outside the vehicle.

Ver vídeo

Ver vídeo

Alcohol

It is very dangerous to drink alcohol when you are going to drive, even if you drink a small amount.

Alcohol spreads through your whole body through the blood and affects, above all, the brain and eyesight.

Alcohol is the cause of many road traffic accidents.

Blood alcohol level

Blood alcohol is the total amount of alcohol in the blood after drinking.

The blood alcohol level is the amount of alcohol in each litre of blood.

It can be calculated in two ways:

- ■ Grams of alcohol in each litre of blood.
- ■ Milligrams of alcohol in each litre of air that we breathe out from the lungs when we breathe.

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The permitted blood alcohol level depends on the type of vehicle and the driving licence.

- 1. For people who got their driving licence less than two years ago. And for vehicles that carry:
    - ■ Goods with a weight greater than 3,500 kilos.
    - ■ More than nine people.
    - ■ Minors.
    - ■ People in emergency services.
    - ■ Dangerous loads.

The permitted alcohol level is:

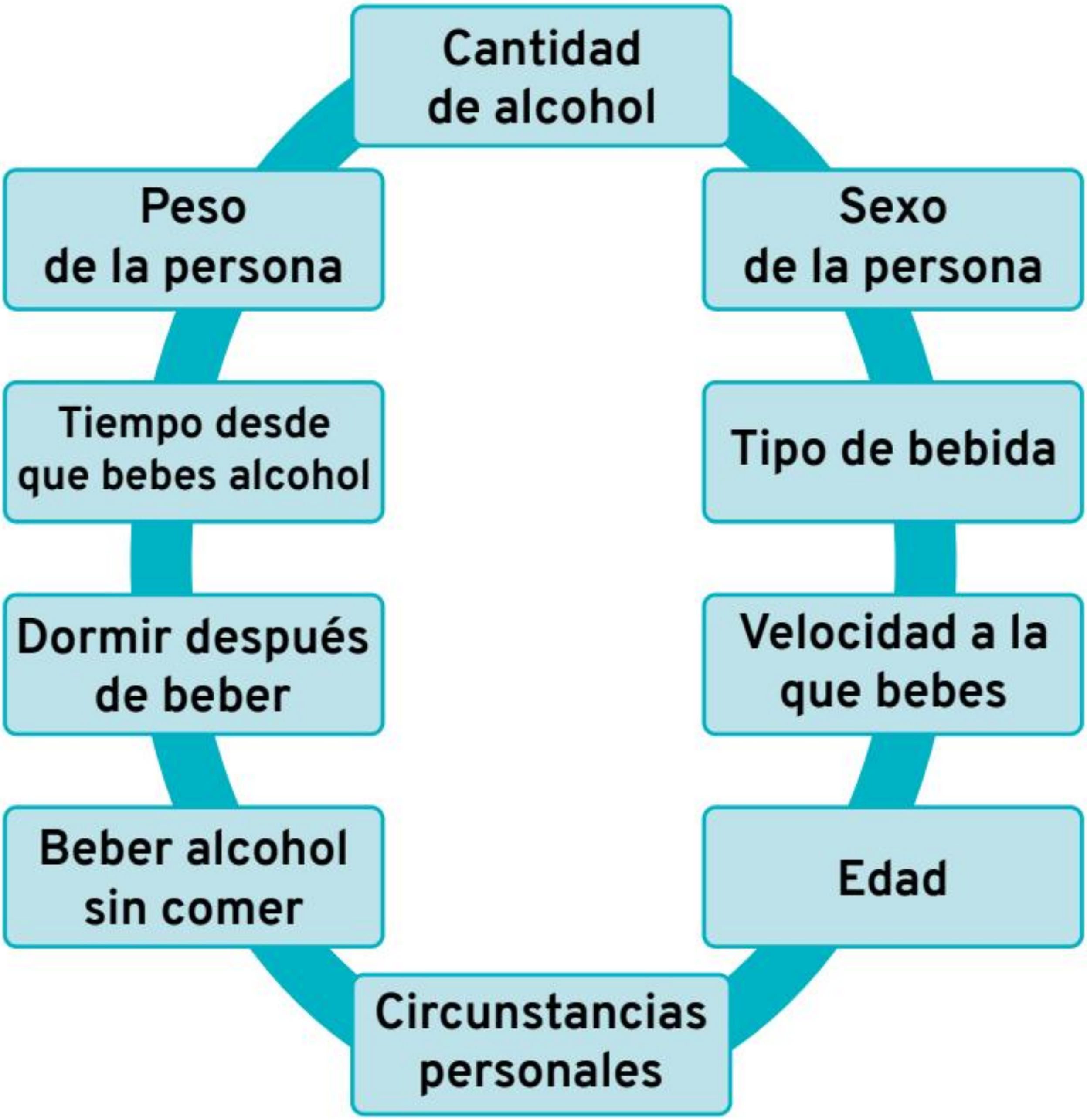
- ■ 0.15 milligrams of alcohol per litre of air.
- ■ 0.3 grams of alcohol per litre of blood.
- 2. For any other vehicle and driver, the permitted alcohol level is:
    - ■ 0.25 milligrams of alcohol per litre of air.
    - ■ 0.5 grams of alcohol per litre of blood.

In any case, the only safe blood alcohol level for driving is 0.0, that is, not drinking alcohol.

What factors influence the blood alcohol level?

Alcohol does not affect all people in the same way.

The factors that influence the blood alcohol level are:



- ■ The amount of alcohol you drink. The more alcohol you drink, the higher the blood alcohol level will be.
- ■ The person's weight. Alcohol affects thin people more.
- ■ The person's sex. Alcohol usually affects women more.
- ■ The time that passes since you drink alcohol. The time when the blood alcohol level is highest is one hour after drinking alcohol. After that, the effects of alcohol go down very slowly.
- ■ The type of drink and the way of drinking it. Alcohol reaches the blood faster after drinking some drinks such as gin or whisky than after drinking other drinks such as wine or beer. Also, alcohol reaches the blood faster when it is mixed with tonic or some soft drinks.
- ■ Sleeping after drinking. Alcohol is removed more slowly when we sleep. For this reason, it is not safe to drive after drinking a lot of alcohol and sleeping a few hours.

- ■ The speed at which you drink. The body removes alcohol better when you drink slowly than when you drink fast.
- ■ Drinking alcohol without eating. Food helps alcohol reach the blood more slowly.
- ■ Age. Alcohol usually affects people under 18 and people over 65 more.

■ Personal circumstances. There are circumstances that can make alcohol affect a person more. For example, being pregnant, stress, or having an illness.

Effects of alcohol while driving

In behaviour

- ■ False confidence in yourself.
- ■ You take more risks.
- ■ You commit more offences that cause accidents.
- ■ You may treat other drivers in a more aggressive or impulsive way.

In the way you see the surroundings	■ **You see traffic signs and traffic lights worse.** ■ **You judge the distance to other vehicles worse.** ■ **Less ability to see what happens to one side and the other.** ■ **You are more dazzled by vehicle lights.** ■ **Possibility of being distracted by elements in the surroundings.**
In movements	■ Difficulty coordinating your body movements.
In decision-making	■ You need more time to react. ■ Greater probability of making bad decisions or not knowing how to carry them out.

Other drugs

Taking drugs before driving is very dangerous. One in 10 people who die in a road traffic accident had taken drugs before driving.

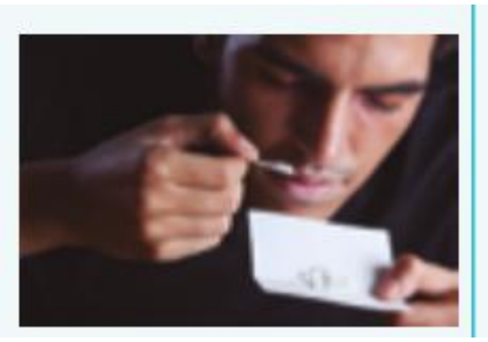
It is forbidden to drive any type of vehicle when a person has taken drugs and they are still in their body.

You may only drive after taking substances prescribed by the doctor and that do not affect driving.

How do drugs harm driving?

All drugs are dangerous and it is forbidden to drive when they have been taken. But each one produces different effects, which are the cause of the danger.

Type of drug	**Possible dangers** **while the person is driving**
Cannabis	■ Seeing the surroundings in a different way. For example, colours look different. ■ Judging distances worse ■ Losing concentration. ■ Needing more time to react.
	■ Falling asleep while driving.
	Watch video



- **Cocaine** ■ Becoming more impulsive or aggressive.
  - ■ Losing the sense of danger.
  - ■ Driving in a more dangerous way.
  - ■ Seeing the surroundings in a different way.
  - ■ Losing concentration.

Watch video

- **Ecstasy** ■ Having hallucinations.
  - ■ Being more sensitive to light or seeing blurred.
  - ■ Losing concentration.
  - ■ Suffering depression or anxiety.
  - ■ Feeling fatigue when the effects of the drug wear off.

- **LSD** ■ Having hallucinations.
  - ■ Reacting aggressively.
  - ■ Having anxiety and even panic.

- **Amphetamines** ■ Losing patience.
  - ■ Having impulsive and violent behaviour.
  - ■ Having little sense of danger.
  - ■ Having delayed fatigue and sleep. This can cause the person to suddenly feel very tired and fall asleep unintentionally when the effect of the drug wears off.

Tests to detect alcohol and drugs

Driving after drinking or taking drugs is prohibited and punished by law. The person who does it will have to pay a fine and may even go to prison.

To find out if a person who is driving has taken alcohol or drugs, a test is carried out.

What does the test involve?

To detect whether a person has drunk alcohol, the traffic officer asks them to blow into a device that measures the amount of alcohol in the blood.

If the test is positive or the person shows signs of having drunk, the test is repeated to confirm it.

To detect whether a person has taken drugs, a saliva sample is taken and the sample is put into a device.

If the person does not agree with the results, they can ask for a blood test.



Test results

If the alcohol or drug tests are positive, the person who is driving will have committed a very serious offence.

The consequences are:

- ■ Paying a fine.
- ■ Losing between 4 and 6 points from the driving licence.
- ■ Possibility of losing the driving licence for a period of time.
- ■ Possibility of going to prison if they have put other people's lives in danger.

The traffic police officer may forbid the person to continue driving.

They will leave the car immobilised until the effects of the alcohol or drugs wear off.

Who must take alcohol and drug detection tests?

People who are driving a vehicle and:

- ■ Have a road traffic accident.
- ■ Show symptoms of driving under the effects of alcohol or drugs.

- ■ Are reported for breaking a traffic rule or committing some other offence.
- ■ Go through a checkpoint to prevent alcohol and drug use.

Pedestrians who, because of their behaviour, could cause a road traffic accident must also take the test.

The law imposes fines and penalties on people who refuse to take these tests when security officers ask them to.

Illnesses and medicines

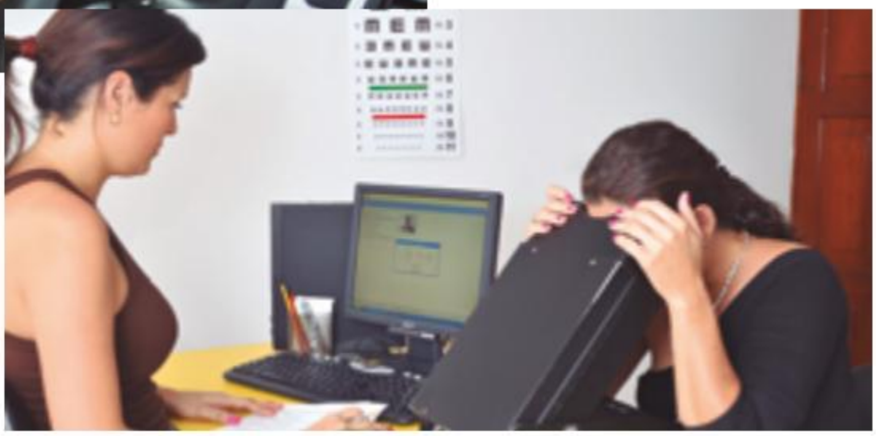
Some illnesses and medicines make a person lose the abilities needed to drive safely.

When you have an illness or take medication, you must always ask doctors whether you can drive.

It is also important to go to the Driver Medical Assessment Centre. There they will tell you whether it is safe to drive with the medication you are taking.

If you have a chronic illness, you can follow these tips to avoid accidents while driving:

- ■ Know the illness well.
- ■ Know the effects of the medicines you take.
- ■ Know how to act in case of a crisis.
- ■ Avoid driving when you feel unwell.
- ■ Do not stop the treatment until the doctor authorises it.
- ■ Do not drink alcohol while you are taking the medication.



Which illnesses can affect driving?

Illness	Tips for driving
Respiratory allergy	■ Drive with the windows closed. ■ Set the air conditioning to a low setting. ■ Keep the vehicle clean and the ventilation ducts clean. ■ Do not mix alcohol with medicines. ■ Do not do long journeys driving. ■ Wear sunglasses. The sun, many times, makes you sneeze. ■ Do not drive at dawn or in damp areas. ■ Do not take medication without a doctor’s prescription.
Stress	■ Do not drive in the phases of highest stress. ■ Do not drive if you take medication for stress. ■ Seek help to reduce stress.
Depression	■ Do not take drugs or alcohol to improve the state of depression. ■ Take only the medication prescribed by the doctor. ■ Put yourself in the hands of specialists and follow the treatment. ■ Do not drive in the periods of greatest depression.

Which medicines can be dangerous for driving?

Medicine	What is it for?	Possible effects
Painkillers	Helps the pain decrease or disappear.	Sleepiness. Vertigo. Lack of concentration.
Cough suppressants	Calm a cough.	Mood changes. Loss of reflexes.
Antihistamines	Treat allergies.	Sleepiness. Depression. Loss of reflexes.
Psychotropic medicines	Treat depression, anxiety and sleep disorders.	Sleepiness. Loss of reflexes. Dizziness. Blurred vision. Confusion.

Diet

Eating a large amount and foods that are hard to digest before driving can cause sleepiness and fatigue. On the other hand, eating too little can cause dizziness.

The most suitable thing is to have several light meals instead of one very heavy one. It is also recommended to wait a while (between 15 and 20 minutes)

after finishing eating before driving.

It is important to drink water or juices so that the body is hydrated and to have less chance of suffering sleepiness or fatigue.

Suitable clothing

You must wear comfortable clothes when you drive. Very tight clothing will not let you move well.

In winter, you must take off your coat before you start driving.

Footwear has to be comfortable and light so you can use the pedals better.

It is not advisable to drive with high-heeled shoes, flip-flops, or shoes with very thick soles.

Ver vídeo

Motorcycle

You must pay special attention to the clothes you wear when you ride a motorcycle.

In this vehicle there is no bodywork to protect you in an accident.

Bodywork. Metal part that covers most parts of a vehicle.

The most suitable clothing to ride a motorcycle is:

- ■ A leather suit or a similar material. This suit must fit your body well.
- ■ Leather gloves with protection.
- ■ Strong boots that support the foot and ankle.
- ■ Wear bright, eye-catching colours.

Ver vídeo

Accidents due to distractions

Distractions while driving happen when the person who is driving pays attention to something that happens inside or outside the vehicle and that has nothing to do with driving.

For example, picking up the mobile phone or looking at a shop window.

When are accidents due to distractions more frequent?

- ■ In young drivers between 18 and 25 years old and in those over 70 years old.
- ■ When there are several people inside the vehicle.
- ■ In the summer months.
- ■ On weekend trips and during the day.
- ■ On roads more than in the city.
- ■ On motorways and dual carriageways.

Ver vídeo

Causes of accidents due to distraction

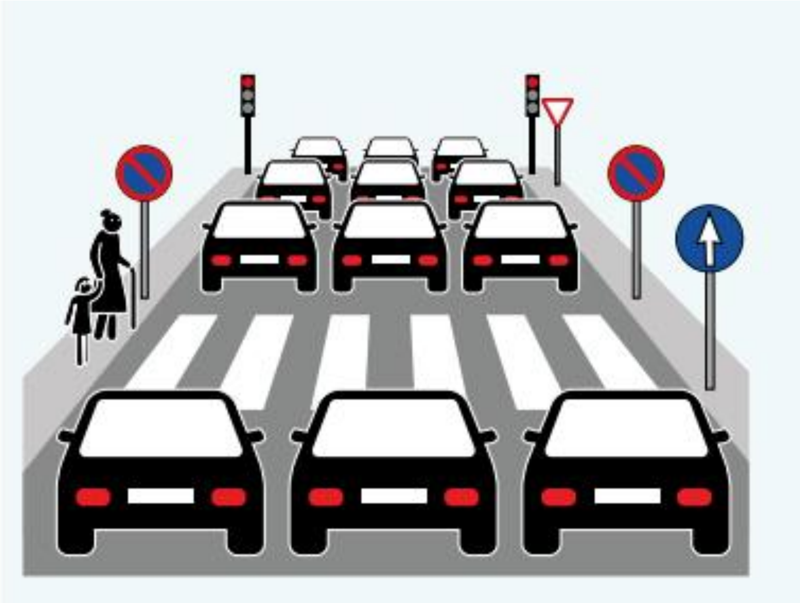
Distractions related to the road

Knowing the road well and being too confident.

Signs are hidden or cannot be seen well for some reason.

Complicated traffic situation with many vehicles, pedestrians and signs to pay attention to.

You cannot see well because it is night-time or because the lights of other cars dazzle you.



Distractions of the person who is driving

Suffering fatigue or sleepiness.

Suffering stress, anxiety or depression.

Being very old.

Consuming alcohol, drugs or taking medicines.

Some behaviours such as: using the mobile phone, lighting a cigarette, or using the GPS satnav.

Looking at a map, throwing an insect out of the vehicle, eating or drinking while driving.

Smoking in the vehicle

People who smoke while driving have twice as many accidents as people who do not smoke.

The reasons are:

- ■ Lack of attention to the road while you look for the cigarette and light it.
- ■ One hand is occupied with the cigarette.
- ■ You see the road worse because of the smoke coming from the cigarette.
- ■ The air inside the car is of worse quality and can affect the abilities needed to drive.

Using the mobile phone

It can be very useful to have a mobile phone in the car in case of a breakdown or emergency. But using it wrongly can cause accidents.

The risk of an accident when using the mobile phone in the vehicle is four times higher than when it is not used.

The reasons are as follows:

- ■ You pay more attention to the conversation than to the road.
- ■ You judge distances worse and you stop seeing some signs because you are not paying attention to driving.
- ■ Leaving the road and entering the opposite lane because you pay attention to the conversation.
- ■ Difficulty handling the steering wheel when you hold the mobile phone in your hand or on your shoulder.
- ■ Disorientation and loss of the sense of time.

In Spain it is forbidden to use a mobile phone while you are driving.

But you can use it through a hands-free device that allows you to talk on the mobile without touching the screen.

However, hands-free devices are also dangerous because the person driving pays part of their attention to the conversation and not to the road.

Recommendations for using the mobile phone and the hands-free device

- ■ Stop the vehicle in a safe place when you need to make a call. Drive again only when the call ends.
- ■ When you talk through the hands-free device, tell the other person that you are driving.
- ■ Do not have conversations that last more than one minute.
- ■ Never call a person if you know they are driving and do not have hands-free.
- ■ When you are driving, be careful with pedestrians who are talking on the mobile. They may be distracted.

GPS sat navs

It is a system that calculates the route from one place to another in real time. It helps you to find your way and to know where you have to go.

If you make a mistake, the GPS sat nav recalculates the route and tells you again where you must go.

Tips to use the GPS sat nav well:

■ Set up the device before you start driving.

Do not do it while you are driving.

- ■ Leave it fixed in one place. Do not let it move or roll around the vehicle.
- ■ Put it in a place where you can see it without taking your eyes off the road.
- ■ Put it in a place that allows the **airbags** to open if necessary.

[Watch video]

Airbag. Safety device that is placed at the front of a car and on the sides to protect passengers in the event of an accident.

Contents

Road safety

Road safety depends on drivers and also on pedestrians.

Ver vídeo

That is why it is necessary for all of us to cooperate by respecting others and travelling in an orderly way when we are walking or in any vehicle.

To achieve this, it is important that we follow all the instructions and obligations set by the law.

For example, it is forbidden to throw objects and materials onto the road or leave them abandoned.

Especially objects that can damage the road, make it difficult for vehicles to pass, or cause an accident.

Ver vídeo

Drivers’ obligations

General obligations

When you drive a vehicle you are required not to get distracted, to prevent damage or accidents.

In this way, you will avoid dangers for you, for the people travelling with you, those travelling in other vehicles, and pedestrians.

In particular, you must pay attention to pedestrians, especially children, older people, people who cannot see, or who use a wheelchair.

[Watch video]

It is forbidden for all drivers:

- ■ To drive a vehicle that gives off more noise, gases or fumes than allowed.
- ■ To keep the vehicle doors open or open them before the vehicle has completely stopped.
- ■ To open the doors and get out of the vehicle before making sure there is no danger for you or for other vehicles and pedestrians. For example, it is dangerous to open the car door without looking because at that moment a bicycle may pass in front and you can cause an accident.

■ To use headphones connected to the mobile or to another device to listen to music or any type of sound. Only the use of some specific headphones in the helmet of motorcycles and mopeds is allowed when the headphones are used as GPS sat navs.

Ver vídeo

- ■ To use the mobile phone. You can use it through hands-free devices.
- ■ To put **fuel** in the vehicle when the engine is running, the lights are on, or the radio is on. Everything must be switched off or disconnected to put fuel in the vehicle.

Ver vídeo

Fuel. Material that, when combined with oxygen, gives off heat.

Many vehicles need fuel to work. For example, petrol.

Terms related to safe driving

Defensive driving	**A way of driving in which the person is alert to anticipate what other road users (drivers and pedestrians) are going to do and react appropriately. For example, taking into account that another driver may need to change lanes and being prepared if this happens.**
Danger zone	Space in which unexpected events may arise from other drivers and pedestrians. For example, a child runs out onto the road behind a ball or a bicycle crosses your vehicle’s path suddenly. These unexpected events can arise in front, behind and to the sides of your vehicle.

Ver vídeo

Two- or three-wheeled vehicles

These vehicles are less visible, are less stable and are also more fragile than other motor vehicles. That is why their passengers are more likely to suffer injuries in the event of accidents.

Which vehicles are these?

- ■ Motorcycles and motorcycles with sidecar.
- ■ Three-wheeled vehicles, *quads* and heavy quadricycles.
- ■ Mopeds.

Whenever you travel on these vehicles as a driver or passenger you must wear the safety helmet properly fastened and fitted to your head.

When you ride a bicycle at night or when visibility is poor for another reason, you have to switch on the vehicle lights and wear a garment or object that shines and can be seen from a distance of 150 metres.

You must wear this bright garment or object if you are the rider and also if you travel as a passenger.

Some two- or three-wheeled vehicles are required to have a seat belt. In those cases, you have to fasten it.

In vehicles with a seat belt you do not need to wear a helmet.

Special vehicles

Vehicles that enter the roads to do works or provide a special service must have a yellow light switched on while they carry out the road improvement or maintenance work.

When they work on motorways or dual carriageways they must switch on the yellow light from when they enter the motorway or dual carriageway until they reach their destination.

This light is used so that other drivers know that the vehicle is there. They do not have priority to go through or overtake.

The maximum speed at which these vehicles may travel is 40 kilometres per hour.

Pedestrians’ obligations

General obligations

When walking in towns and cities

When walking on the road

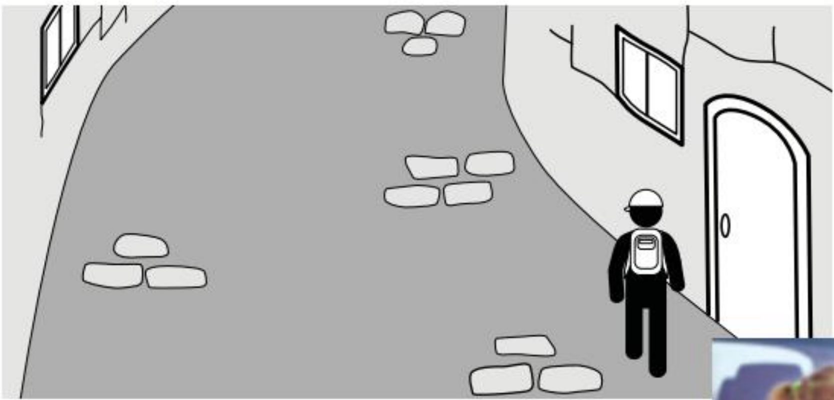
When crossing the road

When walking in towns and cities

- ■ Walk on the pavement and not on the road whenever you can. This rule must also be followed by pedestrians who use skates, skateboards or other similar devices that are not electric.
- ■ Always keep to the right, in town and on the road, when you pull or push a bicycle or a two-wheeled moped, handcarts or a similar device. People who use a wheelchair must also keep to the right.

■ People who carry a very large object or a small vehicle without an engine may walk on the carriageway if the **hard shoulder** or the pavement are narrow and they obstruct pedestrians.

Hard shoulder. Sides of the road that can be on the right and on the left. On the right one only some vehicles may travel, such as, for example, mopeds.



Ver vídeo

When walking on the road

- ■ On roads that are outside towns or cities you must always walk on the left side of the road.
    - Unless it is safer to walk on the right.
- ■ At night you must wear a luminous or reflective item that can be seen from a distance of 150 metres. For example, a reflective vest, a luminous bracelet...

■ Groups of people must walk in single file, one behind another. The people at the front must carry a white or yellow light that shines and the people at the back must carry a red light that shines as well.

This way drivers will be able to know where the line of pedestrians starts and where it ends.

Ver vídeo

When crossing the road or the street

■ Cross in a straight line without stopping until you reach the other pavement.

- ■ At pedestrian crossings, make sure that cars have stopped or are coming slowly before you start to cross.
- ■ Go around squares or roundabouts. Do not cross them on the road.

Ver vídeo

Personal mobility vehicles

Electric scooters, electric **unicycles** and other personal mobility vehicles are forbidden to travel on:

Unicycle. Vehicle that has a single wheel attached to the seat by means of a metal bar.

- ■ Pavements and pedestrian areas.
- ■ Tunnels.

- ■ Through roads.
- ■ Motorways and dual carriageways.
- ■ Roads that are outside the town or city.

What obligations do you have if you ride these vehicles?

- ■ You cannot use headphones while you are riding.
- ■ You cannot use the mobile while you are riding.
- ■ You must take alcohol and drug tests when an officer asks you to, like the rest of drivers.
- ■ You must wear bright and luminous clothing if you ride at night or in places where visibility is poor.
- ■ You must wear a helmet when the law requires it.
- ■ You cannot carry passengers.

Animals on the road

Livestock, pack animals, or animals that carry people may only use the road when there are no other routes to get from one place to another.

They must always be guided by a person over 18 years old.

Livestock and pack animals must always go on the right-hand hard shoulder. When there is no hard shoulder, they must go close to the right-hand edge of the road.

Animals that go in a herd or flock must also go on the right-hand side of the road, taking up as little space as possible.

No animal may use motorways or dual carriageways.

Livestock. Group of animals raised by people to produce meat, milk, wool, and other products.

For example, cows, sheep, goats, and pigs.

Contents

The importance of the vehicle in road traffic accidents

For a vehicle to be safe and have less risk of having accidents, it must meet two requirements:

- 1. Follow the programme of inspections and mandatory maintenance for each vehicle.
- 2. Have a good safety system. Most new vehicles have safety systems that help the vehicle be safer and have fewer accidents.

But the reality is that new vehicles have the same number of accidents as older vehicles. This can happen for two reasons:

- 1. Few drivers know what their vehicle's safety systems are for and how they work.
- 2. Drivers take more risks because they trust their vehicle's safety systems too much. They do not realise that these safety systems have limits.

Ver vídeo

A vehicle's safety systems are divided into two types:

Active safety

Passive safety

[Watch video]

Active safety

Vehicle elements designed to prevent accidents. The driver must use them for them to work. For example, brakes, wheels, and the lighting system.

Passive safety

Elements that help passengers and other road users suffer less harm in an accident. They work automatically. For example, seat belt, airbag, and head restraint.

Active safety elements

Lighting systems

These are the different lights on the vehicle. They allow you to see what is around you and allow pedestrians and drivers of other vehicles to see you when it is night-time or visibility is poor.

Thanks to the lighting system you can light up roads and streets to see nearby hazards and act in time.

It is very important to use the lights correctly by switching on the right ones and switching off the ones you do not need. Some lights can dazzle other drivers when used incorrectly.

Today's vehicles have new lighting systems for more protection.

These new lighting systems are:

Xenon and bi-xenon lamps

than other lights.

Automatic lighting activation

Adaptive lights

Xenon and bi-xenon lamps

Headlamps that light up the road with a powerful bluish-white light, more similar to natural light than the headlamps used before.

They light up the road better, allow the driver to see further ahead, and reduce eye strain. Also, they dazzle other drivers less.

Xenon. Gas used in some lighting systems.

Automatic lighting activation

System that measures the outside light and switches the lights on or off automatically so that the vehicle can be seen better.

Adaptive lights

System that adjusts the intensity of the lights and where they shine depending on the needs at each moment.

It does this taking into account: the distance to the vehicle coming in the opposite lane, the type of road you are driving on, and the speed your vehicle is travelling at.

Adaptive lights are divided into two types of lights:

1. Cornering lights.

They switch on when you turn the steering wheel to show the side your vehicle is going to turn towards.

This light helps you see better on bends. At **roundabouts** it allows other drivers to know where you are going to turn.

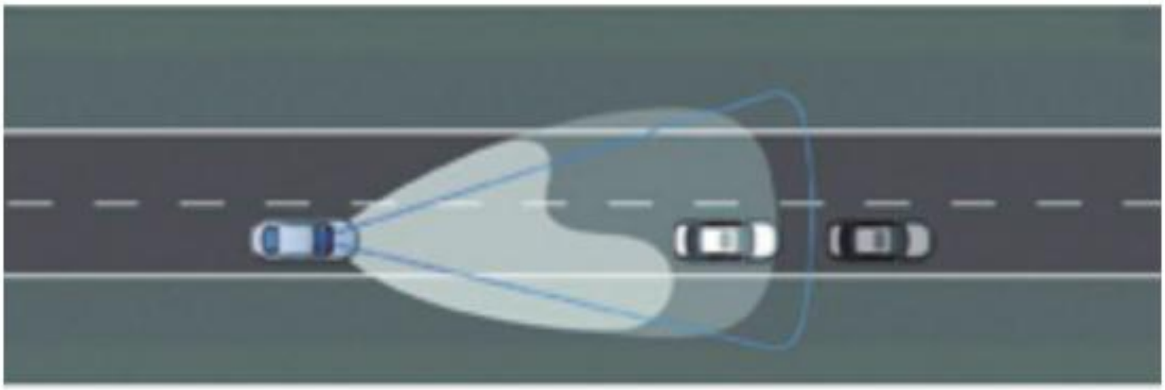
Roundabout. Circular junction where streets meet.

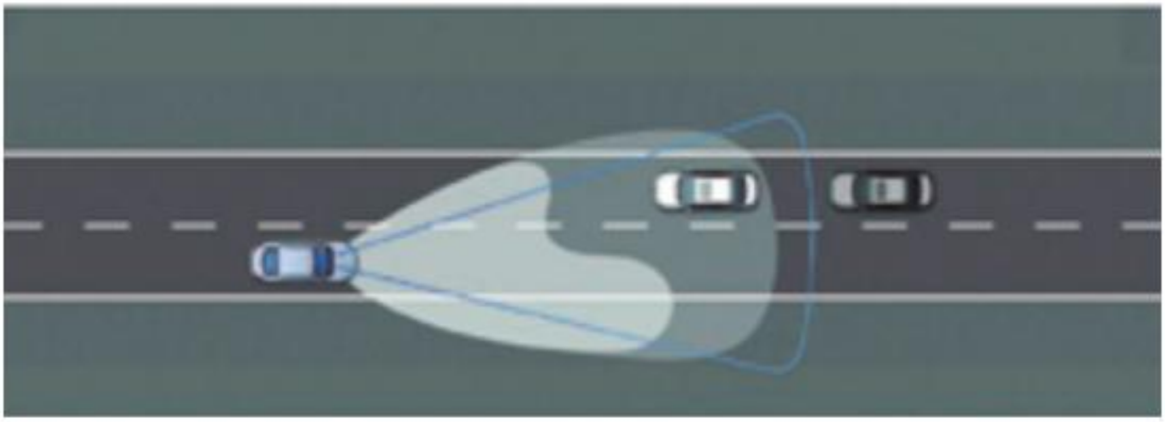
2. Automatic main-beam lights. System to switch on vehicle lights that light up more of the road when

there is little outside light.

For these lights to switch on, your vehicle must be travelling at a speed higher than 45 kilometres per hour and it must not detect another vehicle nearby.

These lights switch off when they detect another vehicle on the road coming towards you in the opposite lane.





Brakes

Brakes reduce the vehicle’s speed until it stops completely.

A vehicle’s brakes do not usually fail. But sometimes it does happen, and this can cause a serious accident.

Ver vídeo

What safety systems are there in the brakes?

Engine braking

Anti-lock braking system (ABS)

Autonomous emergency braking (AES)

Emergency brake warning (EBD)

Engine braking

System used to reduce the speed a vehicle is travelling at without using the wheel brake. It works when you stop accelerating and, in this way, the engine holds the vehicle back. If you drive in low gears (1st or 2nd) the engine slows the vehicle more.

It is recommended to use engine braking when going down long slopes.

Anti-lock braking system (ABS)

Device that prevents the wheels from locking when braking.

This system is very important because it helps you keep control of the vehicle and brake in less distance.

The more weight there is in the vehicle, the harder it is for the wheels to lock when braking. For example, it will be harder for your motorcycle wheel to lock when you are carrying a passenger.

Autonomous emergency braking (AEB)

System that calculates, through a **radar**, the distance there is and should be between your vehicle and the one in front.

If there is very little distance between the vehicles, this braking system will warn you by means of a voice and a sound.

If you ignore these signals and there is a risk of an accident, the system will carry out emergency braking.

Ver vídeo

Radar. System that can detect where an object is, for example another car, and what speed it is travelling at.

Emergency brake warning (EBD)

System that warns the driver of a vehicle that the vehicle in front has to make an emergency stop.

When the driver in front presses the brake firmly and quickly, the brake lights of their vehicle flash.

In this way, the system warns the driver behind so that they have more time to brake and try not to crash into them.

How are the brakes used?

To brake safely and in a controlled way, it is necessary to:

- 1. Brake gently, little by little, and with enough time.
- 2. Take the condition of the road into account. When it is not in good condition, you must brake more gently and with more time.
- 3. Do not use the brake too much because it will heat up and brake worse.

To brake in an emergency in a vehicle without ABS, you must press the brake pedal hard and fully until you notice that the wheel starts to lock.

Then lift your foot off the brake a little to prevent the wheels from locking. But do not stop braking.

To brake in an emergency in a vehicle with ABS, you must press the brake pedal hard and fully until the vehicle stops completely.

What to do when the brakes fail?

You can act in different ways depending on the circumstances in which the brakes fail.

Problem	Possible solution
The brakes get very hot because they have been used too much in a short time.	Release the brake pedal so that they cool down.
The brakes fail when the vehicle goes down a long and very steep slope.	Do not accelerate. Change down gears so that the engine acts as a brake.
	If you cannot change down gears, pull the handbrake lever gently.
Other occasions when the brakes fail.	Press and release the pedal several times.
	This will reduce the speed of the vehicle.

Wheels

A vehicle's wheels are made up of two parts:

- 1. Rim. Metal part shaped like a circle, which is the inner part of the wheel.
- 2. Tyre. **Elastic** rubber part that fits around the rim.

A piece of rubber is elastic when it can be stretched. When you stop stretching it, it returns to its original size.

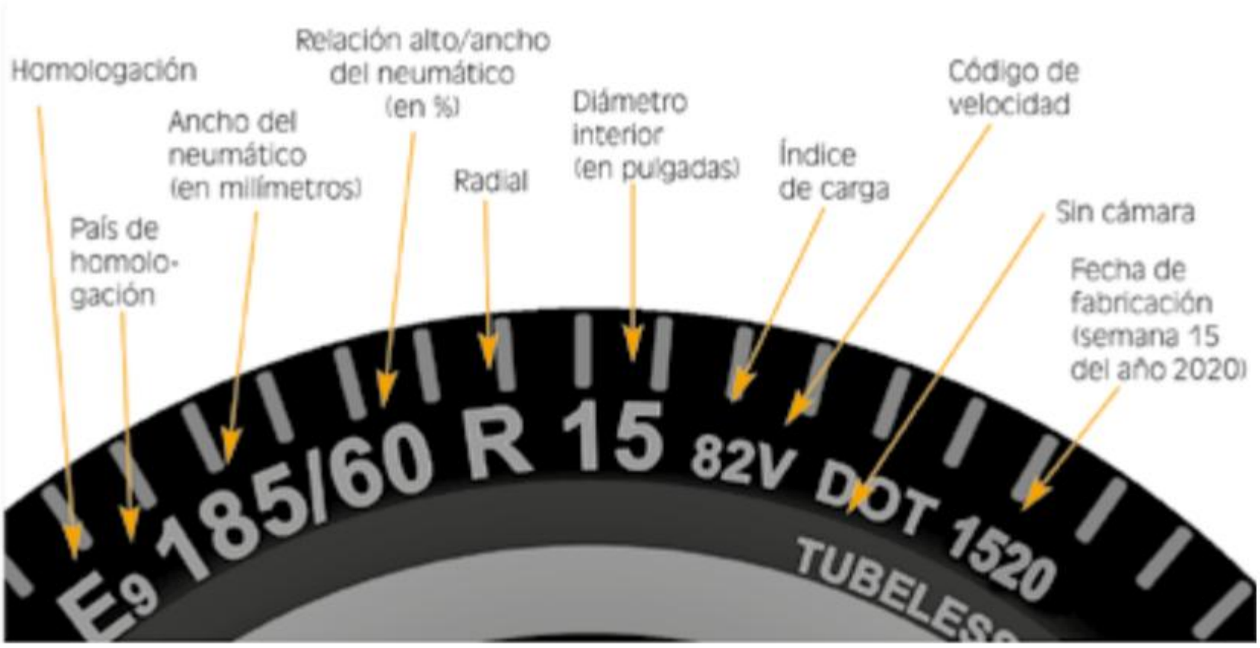
Ver vídeo

The rim and the tyre of a wheel must be compatible with each other so that the tyre fits properly on the rim.

Tyres

Tyre faults are a common cause of road traffic accidents. That is why it is very important that they meet certain quality characteristics.

On new tyres that are in good condition, you can read their characteristics on the sidewall.



Ver vídeo

Ver vídeo

They must not have blisters, deformations, or tears. None of their layers must be coming loose, and they must not have exposed cords or cracks.

The part of the tyre that is in contact with the road is called the tread.

The tread of passenger cars must have grooves at least 1.6 millimetres deep.

These grooves are used so that the tyre:

- ■ Does not get hot.
- ■ Is more flexible and rolls better on the road.
- ■ Grips the road better.
- ■ Removes the water it picks up from the road when it rains.

Ver vídeo

Inflation pressure

Tyres are inflated with air so that they are more resistant and can better support the load and the weight of the vehicle.

The manufacturer of each vehicle is the one who states how much air the tyres must have. This amount of air will be the inflation pressure.

What happens when the inflation pressure is not correct?

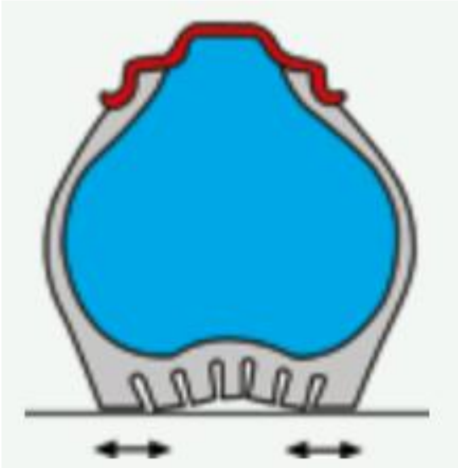
Inflation pressure lower than recommended

The tyre gets hot, deforms and wears out sooner.

More fuel is used.

The vehicle is less stable.

The vehicle has a higher risk of skidding when the road surface is wet.



There is a higher chance that the tyre will burst.

Inflation pressure higher than recommended

The tyre has less contact with the road surface.

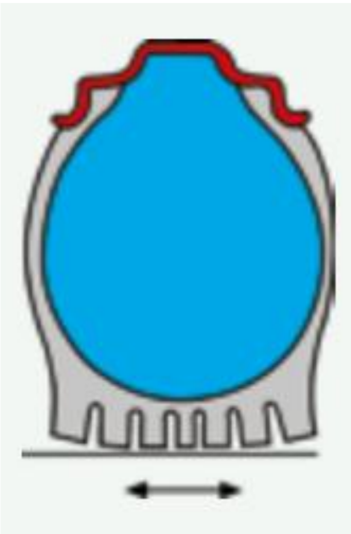
Therefore, it grips the road less.

The centre of the tyre wears more than the sides.

The vehicle vibrates more because the tyres cannot absorb small stones and other elements.

For example, potholes in the road.

The shock absorbers get damaged more.



You must check the tyre pressure of your vehicle at least once a month. You must also always carry a spare wheel with the correct inflation pressure.

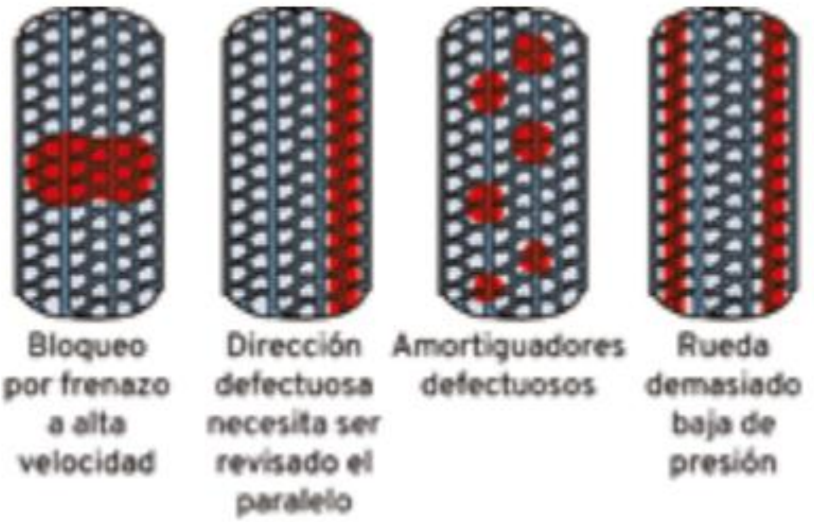
Tyre wear

The rubber of the tyres can wear out due to rubbing against the road.

For that reason, you must change the tyres of your vehicle every five years, even if they are in good condition.

Tyre rubber can wear out sooner for these reasons:

- ■ Driving in a sudden or aggressive way.
- ■ Driving very fast.
- ■ The weather.
- ■ Tyres wear more in summer.
- ■ Carrying a lot of load in the vehicle.
- ■ Not having the correct inflation pressure.
- ■ Driving on roads in poor condition.
- ■ Problems with the brakes or with other parts of the vehicle that affect the wheels.



What must you do when a tyre gets punctured?

The steps you must take if a tyre gets punctured while you are driving are:

- ■ Reduce speed slowly until you stop the vehicle. Do not stop suddenly.
- ■ Immobilise the vehicle in a safe place. Off the road and off the hard shoulder if possible.
- ■ Change the punctured wheel for the spare wheel. Some vehicles have other systems so they can keep driving, and there are vehicles that have a wheel that is only used to reach the nearest garage.

It is called a space-saver spare wheel.

With this wheel you can travel about 200 kilometres at a maximum speed of 80 kilometres per hour.

[Watch video](#) [Watch video](#)

Wheel balancing

Wheel balancing consists of putting weights on the rims so that the wheels can support the weight and the load of the vehicle. This balance is very important so that the wheels rotate properly.

Wheels can lose balance for these reasons:

- ■ Tyre change.
- ■ The rims lose the counterweights.
- ■ The rims get dented.
- ■ The wheel wears out or gets cuts.

Ver vídeo

How to know that a wheel is losing balance?

You may notice one of these things:

- ■ The vehicle makes noises and vibrates.
- ■ The tyres wear more than normal.
- ■ The wheel bolts are loose.

Other active safety elements

Traction control

Electronic stability control

Speed limiters

Cruise control

Adaptive cruise control

Traction control

Safety system that identifies if a wheel is rotating faster than the others and brakes it so that it does not skid.

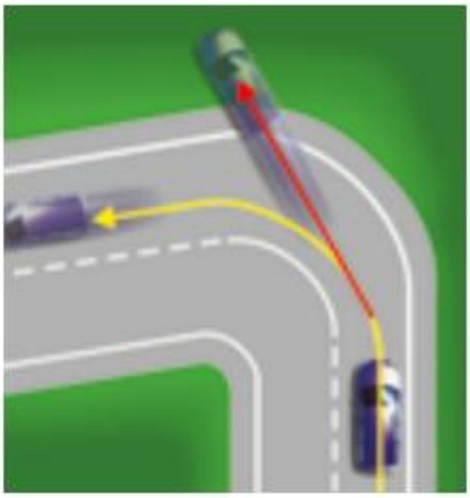
This system helps to keep the vehicle stable on bends, when going up a hill or when it is raining.

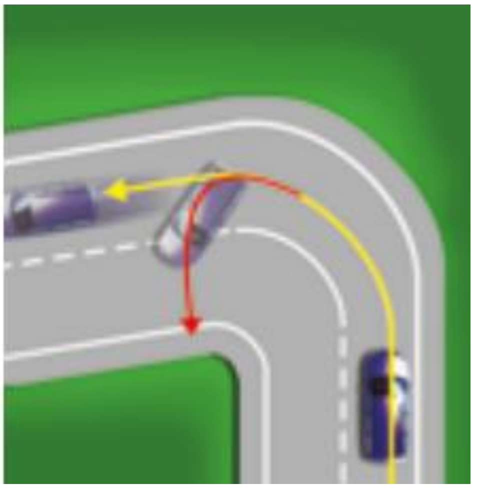
Electronic stability control

Safety system that helps the vehicle to follow the path set by the steering wheel and not deviate when it does not turn as much as the driver asks or turns too much.

This system helps you to keep control of the vehicle in dangerous situations. For example, when avoiding an obstacle

or when taking a bend.





Speed limiters

System that allows you to choose the maximum speed your vehicle can reach.

When you activate the speed limiter, the vehicle will not go above the speed chosen by the driver.

Cruise control

System that helps you to maintain the speed you choose to drive without needing to press the pedals to accelerate or reduce speed. For example, driving all the time at 100 kilometres per hour on the motorway.

This system is activated from the steering wheel. It is deactivated when you accelerate or brake. Then you have to choose the speed again and activate it.

Adaptive cruise control

As well as helping to control speed, this system helps you to keep the distance from the vehicle in front.

Your vehicle will reduce speed or brake if you do not keep that distance and you get too close to the vehicle in front.

Passive safety elements

The chassis and the bodywork

The chassis is the internal structure of the vehicle on which all the parts that make it up are fitted. It is the skeleton of the vehicle and it cannot be seen with the naked eye.

The bodywork is the external metal structure that covers the vehicle.

In the event of an accident, the chassis and the bodywork deform and protect the vehicle so that the passengers inside suffer less damage.

The seat belt

What is it for?

To protect all the people travelling in a vehicle in the event of a sudden impact or if the vehicle rolls over.

In these cases, the belt helps people not to move from their seats and not to be thrown out of the vehicle.

Wearing the seat belt correctly means that a person has double the chance of surviving an accident.

In fact, there have been fewer deaths from traffic accidents since the seat belt exists.

For a seat belt to be useful and safe it must meet quality requirements and be properly secured to the vehicle bodywork. It must be checked from time to time and taken to a garage to be repaired or replaced if it has any damage.

Who must wear the seat belt?

All people travelling in a vehicle that has seat belts installed. Drivers must do so and also passengers on all roads and streets.

There are some exceptions in which drivers are not required to wear the seat belt, although it is recommended that they always wear it.

These exceptions can only be applied when the vehicle is travelling within a town or city. Never when travelling on roads, dual carriageways or motorways.

Exceptions:

- ■ Drivers who are parking by moving the vehicle backwards.
- ■ Taxi drivers who are on duty.
- ■ Children who are less than 135 centimetres tall and travel in a taxi that does not have child safety systems. In those cases, the children will travel in the rear seats and will fasten the seat belt that is on the seat.
- ■ Delivery drivers who have to get out of the vehicle continuously to collect and deliver orders.
- ■ Drivers and passengers of vehicles in emergency services. For example, ambulances.

■ Driving school instructors who are carrying a learner and are in charge of the additional controls of the vehicle.

The only people who may travel without a seat belt in any situation or on any road are people who cannot wear it for medical reasons or disability.

These people must carry a medical certificate that explains the reasons.

Seat belts for children

Children who are less than 135 centimetres tall must use a different safety system, more suitable for them.

They are called child restraint systems and are adapted to each child's height and weight.

It is best for the child to try the child restraint system before starting to use it to check that it fits their measurements and is comfortable for them.

To fit a child restraint system in a vehicle you must take into account the following recommendations:

- ■ Do not install the child seat in a seat that has an airbag in front of it.
- ■ For small children, place the child seat facing the opposite direction to the vehicle's travel. That is, facing backwards. It is safer.
- ■ Place the child seat in the centre rear seat. This way the child will be more protected in the event of an accident from either side.

[Watch video]

It is important that child restraint systems have passed all quality tests so that they are safe.

In vehicles with nine seats or fewer, children must travel in the rear seat and have the child restraint system properly secured.

Children may only travel in the front seat when:

- ■ The vehicle has no rear seats.
- ■ All rear seats are occupied by other children.
- ■ Child restraint systems cannot be installed in the rear seats.

On buses, children who are less than 135 centimetres tall and are three years old or older must also use child restraint systems.

If there are none, they will have to fasten the seat belt on the seat, as long as it is suitable for their height and weight.

How do you fasten the seat belt?

You must wear the seat belt properly fastened and adjusted to the body. It must not be too loose or too tight so that you can move easily.

The seat belt has two straps that you must wear in the correct place so that they protect you.

Watch video Watch video

Shoulder strap

It must pass over the collarbone, between the shoulder and the neck, and go down the centre of the chest.

Placing the shoulder strap on the neck or on one breast can cause serious injuries in the event of an accident.

Placing it on the shoulder can make the seat belt slip and protect less.

Lap strap

It must be placed over the hip bones.

Always below the stomach.

If it is placed above, it can cause serious internal injuries in the event of an accident.

After fastening your seat belt, pull it slightly upwards to check that it fits you properly.

Check that it is not caught or twisted in any part.

The submarining effect

This effect happens when, in an accident, the body slides down, under the seat belt. This happens because the seat is tilted backwards and the seat belt is not positioned correctly.

To prevent this from happening you must:

- ■ Fasten your seat belt properly.
- ■ Check that the seat belt is properly fitted to the body.
- ■ Do not place towels, cushions, or covers on the seat that could make you slip.

- ■ Have a correct driving posture, without tilting the seat too far back.

Airbags

What are they?

A safety device that consists of an air bag that inflates inside the vehicle in the event of an accident to protect the passengers.

Airbags are fitted at the front of the vehicle and on the sides.

What are they for?

The main functions of the airbag in the event of an accident are:

- ■ To slow down the sudden movement of the body.
- ■ To prevent people from hitting violently against any part of the vehicle.
- ■ To protect people's face and eyes from broken glass and other parts that come loose because of the accident.

Precautions when using airbags:

- ■ Always use the seat belt so that the impact against the airbag is smaller.
- ■ Place your chest at a distance of at least 25 centimetres from the steering wheel so that the front airbag does not hit you when it inflates.
- ■ Deactivate the airbag for the front passenger seat if you are going to place a child seat on that seat.

The head restraint

A device that protects the neck and the **cervical vertebrae** in the event of a sudden impact.

It is very important to position the head restraint at the height of the passengers' heads, both in the front seats and in the rear seats.

Cervical vertebrae. Bones that are in the upper part of the spine.

The top of the head restraint must be at the same height as the top of your head.

You should try to keep the distance between your head and the head restraint to four centimetres or less.

[Watch video]

The helmet

Head injuries are the main cause of death in accidents involving two-wheeled vehicles. Three out of ten people who have an accident on a two-wheeled vehicle save their life because they are wearing a helmet.

What does the helmet do in the event of an accident?

- ■ It protects the head from impacts against the ground, other vehicles, or elements of the road.
- ■ It prevents stones, metal pieces, or other sharp objects from entering the head
- ■ It spreads the force of the impact over the whole helmet so that it does not concentrate on just one point of the head. This prevents serious injuries.
- ■ It helps prevent the face and head from being burned when sliding along the ground after the fall.

Type of helmet	**Full-face model.** **That is, one that also protects** **the lower part of the face** **and the jaw.** **Watch video**
Material	Some helmets expire after a few years and can lose properties if they are painted or if stickers are put on them.
Size	It must fit the head properly.
Strap fastening	Check that the helmet is properly fastened and does not come off even if you pull hard. Watch video
Colour	Light and bright helmets are safer.
Ventilation	It must have enough holes for air to go in and out.

Topic 5. Safety devices in the vehicle

Visor	**It is recommended to wear visors** **over the face that do not mist up** **and allow you to see well through them.** **These visors are called anti-fog.**
Approval	The helmet must have a label that explains that it has passed quality tests and is a safe helmet.
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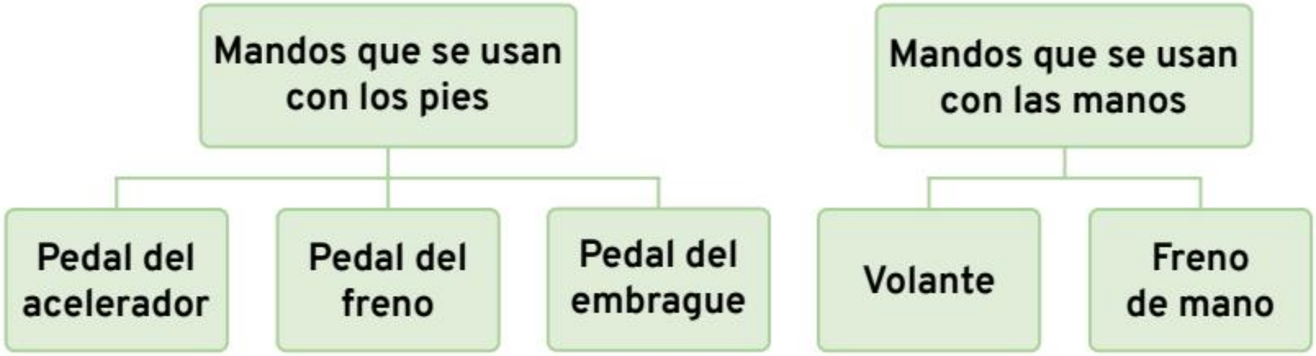
Contents

Vehicle controls

Controls of vehicles in general

Some vehicle controls are used with the feet and others with the hands.



Accelerator pedal

It is used to regulate the amount of fuel that enters the vehicle's engine.

The harder you press the accelerator, the more fuel will enter the engine and the faster the vehicle will go.

This pedal is pressed with the right foot. If you do not press it, the vehicle receives the right amount of fuel to keep running and not stop.

Ver vídeo

Brake pedal

It is used to reduce speed or stop the vehicle. The brake pedal acts on all the wheels of the car. This pedal is pressed with the right foot and it must be pressed smoothly.

Clutch pedal

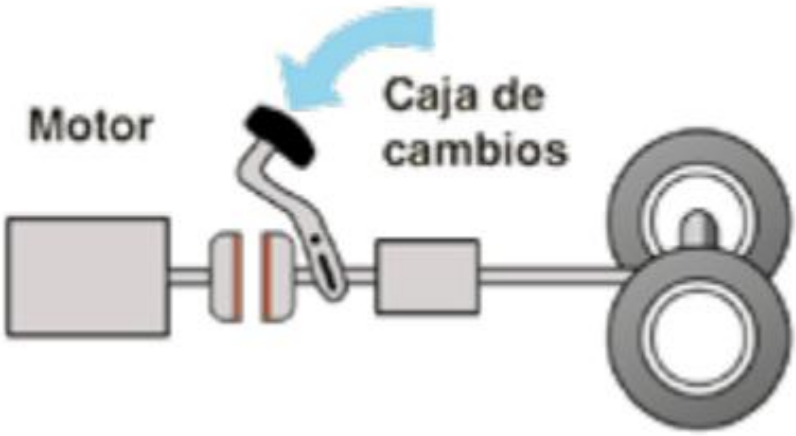
It is a mechanism that allows the **gearbox** to choose the gear you want to use and connect it to the engine.

It is used to change gear while driving and to allow the vehicle to move forwards or backwards.

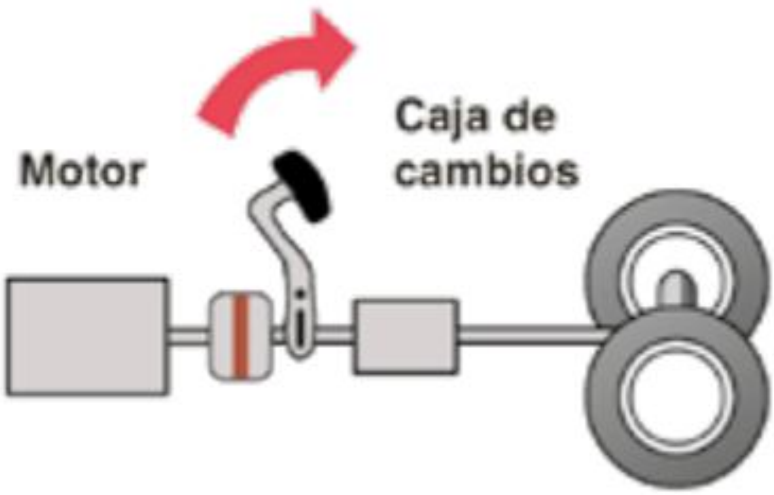
When you press the clutch pedal fully, the engine’s movement is not transmitted to the gearbox or to the wheels. Then you can change gear.

The **gearbox** is used to change gear.

Ver vídeo



When you release the clutch pedal, the engine power works again on its own so that you can continue driving.



Steering wheel

Part of the vehicle that allows you to control which direction you are going and where the wheels move.

How should you hold the steering wheel?

- ■ With both hands. You should only let go with one hand for the short time needed to operate other controls in the car.
- ■ On the outside. You must never hold the steering wheel on the inside.
- ■ Firmly, but without using too much force.
- ■ Without crossing your hands when turning the steering wheel.

Handbrake

A system that brakes the rear wheels of the vehicle and keeps the vehicle stopped. The handbrake is a lever that is used with the right hand.

Controls of motorcycles

Motorcycles have the same controls as other motor vehicles. But they are placed in a different position and are used differently.

Watch video

With the left hand	**Clutch. It works by squeezing a lever. Control to make sounds (horn).**
	Switch to turn on the lights.
With the right hand	Front brake. Lever to brake the front wheel.
	Accelerator. It is on the handlebar and is activated by turning the grip.
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With the feet Brake pedal.

It activates the brake of the rear wheel. It is usually on the right side of the motorcycle.

Gear pedal.

It is used to change gear. It is usually on the left side of the motorcycle.

Visibility when driving

It is necessary to see well everything around the vehicle for driving to be safe.

To achieve this, all the windows must be clean.

It is prohibited:

- ■ Sticking films or stickers on the windows that make an area harder to see.
- ■ Fitting coloured windows that are not approved or permitted by law.

Ver vídeo

Which elements of the vehicle help you see better?

Windscreen wipers Windscreen washers Heated rear window Rear-view mirror

Windscreen wipers

They keep the front windscreen of the vehicle clean. There are cars that also have a rear wiper to clean the rear window.

They move from side to side to clean the windows well.

They have different speeds. You should try to use the slowest one.

The windscreen wiper and the rear wiper have a blade that must be changed when you notice that it leaves marks on the glass or it does not get properly clean.

You must not use the windscreen wiper when the glass is dry because it can scratch it.

There are automatic windscreen wipers that activate by themselves when they detect water. They work faster or slower depending on the amount of rain that falls on the vehicle.

The driver can activate or deactivate the automatic windscreen wiper.

Windscreen washers

A device that sprays a jet of liquid onto the windscreen so that the windscreen wiper can clean better.

There are special liquids that work as windscreen washer fluid, although water mixed with a little detergent can be used.

It is important to check that the reservoir that holds the windscreen washer has liquid and to top it up when it is running low.

Ver vídeo

Heated rear window

Lines that can be seen on the rear window of the vehicle. They remove ice and mist that form on this window so that you can see well.

Rear-view mirrors

Mirrors that allow the driver to see better what happens to the sides and behind the vehicle.

Rear-view mirrors in cars, vans and lorries

Cars, vans and lorries that can carry up to 3,500 kilos of weight must have the following rear-view mirrors:

- ■ A mirror outside the vehicle, on the left-hand side.
- ■ A mirror inside the vehicle, in the centre, above the front windscreen.
- ■ A mirror outside the vehicle, on the right-hand side. This mirror is recommended, but it is not compulsory.

[Watch video]

Sun blinds can be fitted on the rear side windows of the vehicle only when both exterior mirrors are fitted, on the right and on the left.

Rear-view mirrors on motorcycles

Motorcycles that travel at less than 100 kilometres per hour must have one mirror on the left-hand side of the vehicle.

Motorcycles that travel at more than 100 kilometres per hour must have two mirrors. One on the left-hand side of the vehicle and another on the right-hand side.

Rear-view mirrors on two-wheeled mopeds

These vehicles must have one compulsory mirror on the left-hand side of the moped. The mirror on the right-hand side is optional.

Rules for driving comfortably and safely

Having a good driving posture helps to avoid fatigue and makes driving safer.

Sitting in a good posture in front of the steering wheel helps you respond better and faster to unexpected situations.

Driving too close to the steering wheel causes fatigue because you have to strain your body more to make movements.

Driving too far from the steering wheel makes you lean forwards to reach the controls

and to lift your back off the seat backrest. This can be dangerous.

Your head must be above the steering wheel. If this is not possible because you are not tall enough, you can use a suitable accessory firmly secured to the seat, bearing in mind that it cannot be a cushion or similar.

Rules for driving cars, vans and lorries

Before you start driving you must check that:

The seat and the backrest are well adjusted

The mirrors are correctly positioned

The seat belt is properly fastened

The seat and the backrest are well adjusted when:

- ■ You can reach the pedals well and you can press them fully without straining your ankles.
- ■ Your legs are not fully stretched out. They are slightly bent and do not rub against any part of the vehicle.
- ■ Your head is above the steering wheel so you can see over it and not through it.
- ■ The position of the seat backrest lets you reach all the controls.
    - To check it, rest your back against the backrest, stretch out your arms and check that your wrists can rest on the top of the steering wheel.

[Watch video]

■ The head restraint is at the height of your head.

The rear-view mirrors are correctly positioned when:

■ Looking at the mirror inside the vehicle, you can see the four edges of the rear window.

Ver vídeo

■ Looking at the mirrors on the sides, you can see the road, the vehicles coming from behind and those alongside you. By turning your neck a little you can see a part of the left rear of your vehicle.

If you find that the mirrors are badly positioned while you are driving, you must stop the vehicle and adjust them correctly.

To do this, try to stop in a flat and straight place.

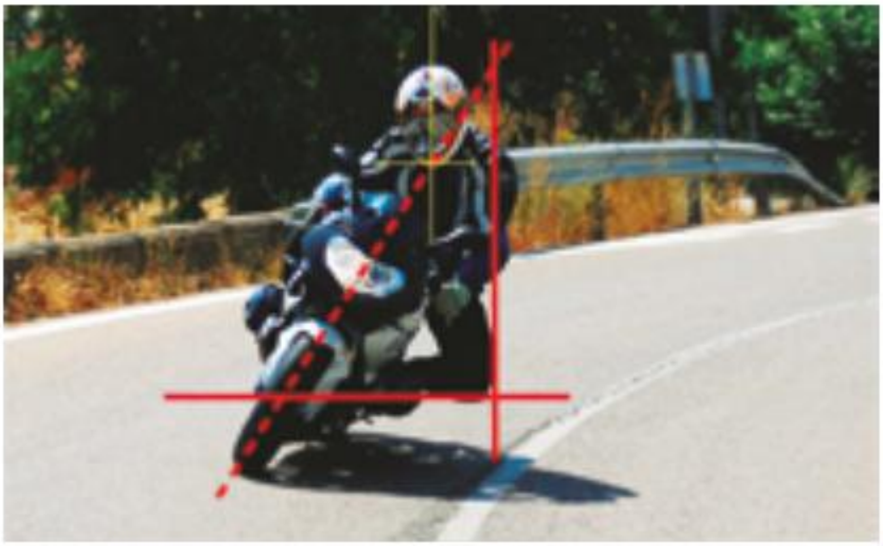
The seat belt is properly fastened

Once you have made these checks, fasten your seat belt properly before you start driving.

Rules for riding motorcycles

- ■ Keep a natural body position. Do not force postures.
- ■ Lean your body just enough to reach the handlebars.

- ■ Keep your arms and hands relaxed. This will help you avoid tiredness.
- ■ When the motorcycle starts moving, place your feet on the footrests. Do not let them hang down.
- ■ Lean your body a little to take bends. Do not lean too much, like professional riders do in races.



Ver vídeo

Which postures are not suitable for riding a motorcycle?

- ■ Leaning your body too much.
- ■ Keeping your elbows tucked inwards.
- ■ Having your arms completely straight.

These postures cause fatigue and can make it harder for you to react.

Systems that help you drive safely

Traffic sign recognition system (TSR)

It detects the speed limit signs on the road so that the person driving can reduce the vehicle’s speed if necessary.

In some vehicles the system shows the number that corresponds to the maximum speed the vehicle may travel at. This number appears on the **instrument panel.**

In other vehicles, as well as warning, the system reduces the speed by itself when the driver is going faster than they should.

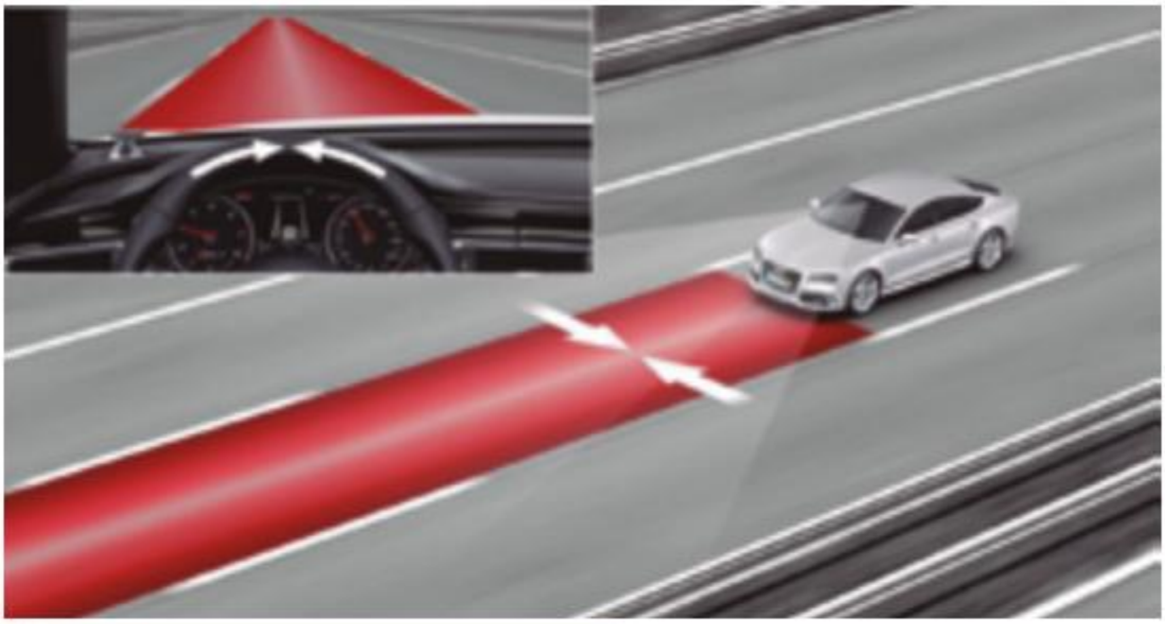
Instrument panel. Set of indicators in front of the driver that give information about the condition and operation of the vehicle.

Ver vídeo

Lane departure warning (LDW)

This system warns the driver when they make an unexpected lane change because they are distracted or because they have fallen asleep.

The system warns by means of a light on the instrument panel, a sound, or by making the driver's seat or the steering wheel vibrate.



[Watch video]

Lane keeping assist (LKA)

System that detects the white lines on the road to help the driver guide their car and not leave their lane.

It warns the driver when they leave the lane.

Ver vídeo

Reversing camera and 360-degree camera

The reversing camera is located at the rear of the vehicle.

Its function is to show the driver the obstacles behind the car when reversing. For example, when they have to reverse to park the vehicle.

What this camera sees appears on the screen at the front of the vehicle.

The 360-degree camera captures everything around the vehicle and projects it on the front screen.

These types of cameras are very useful for parking the vehicle.

Parking assistant

System to help the driver park or leave a parking space. There are different parking assistants with different functions such as:

Finding a place to park, showing what is around the vehicle, or turning the steering wheel without the driver’s help while the vehicle parks.

The driver must pay close attention to make sure these movements can be done safely

and can stop the manoeuvre at any time.

Hill start assist system

This system helps the vehicle not roll backwards when the driver moves off on a very steep slope.

Or when the driver moves their foot from the brake to the accelerator to continue driving on a slope.

Rear cross traffic alert system (RCTA)

This system warns the driver if there are other vehicles behind when reversing. For example, when leaving a parking space.

The system will make a sound when it sees that there is a vehicle behind that is too close and there may be a risk of a collision.

Ver vídeo

Contents

General rules for using the vehicle lights

When must you switch on the vehicle lights?

At night you must have the appropriate lights on at all times whenever it is night.

During the day, you must switch them on in these cases:

- ■ It is a dark day with little natural light.
- ■ You go through a tunnel.
- ■ You drive in a **reversible lane**

Reversible lane.

A lane that is sometimes open in one direction and other times in the opposite direction.

■ You drive in an **additional lane** or one that goes in the opposite direction to the one it normally has. For example, an additional lane is set up or the direction of a lane is changed for a period due to roadworks or an accident in that area.

Additional lane.

A new lane that is opened temporarily due to roadworks, queues, an accident...

If some lights break down while you are driving, you must reduce the car's speed and switch on the lights that work, even if they are dimmer.

When you reach a lit area, you must park the vehicle and not continue driving until the lighting system is repaired.

A road is considered poorly lit when:

- ■ You cannot read the number plate of the vehicle in front at a distance of 10 metres.
- ■ You cannot see a vehicle painted a dark colour at a distance of 50 metres.

Vehicle lights

- 1. Front position light
- 2. Dipped beam or passing beam
- 3. Main beam or full beam
- 4. Direction indicators
- 5. Front fog light
- 6. Daytime running lights

- 1. Rear position light
- 2. Brake light
- 3. Rear fog light
- 4. Direction indicators
- 5. Reversing light
- 6. Third brake light

Position lights

They are used so that the vehicle can be seen clearly and so that its width is known.

There are position lights at the front, at the rear and on the sides of the vehicle.

Ver vídeo

What colour are the position lights?

The front lights are white.

The rear lights are red.

The side lights are amber.

When are they used?

- ■ When you drive at night.
- ■ When going through a tunnel.
- ■ On dark days when there is little natural light for driving.

When the vehicle is moving, the position lights are always switched on together with another type of lights.

Ver vídeo

The position lights are switched on on their own, without any other type of lights, only when the car is stopped for some reason.

For example, a car that has to stop because of a breakdown on a poorly lit road.

Parking light

It is used when a vehicle has to stop in an area that is poorly lit. It can be used instead of sidelights.

They are fitted at the front and the rear of the vehicle.

They are the same colours as sidelights.

Overall width lights

They are used to clearly show the total width of the vehicle. They are two front lights and two rear lights that are fitted on the outer edges of the vehicle, in the highest area, so that they can be seen well.

They are used in the same cases as sidelights.

Overall width. Width of a vehicle

Ver vídeo

What colour are they?

The front lights are white. The rear lights are red.

Which vehicles must have them?

It is compulsory for motor vehicles, trailers and semi-trailers that are more than 2.10 metres wide.

It is optional for motor vehicles that are between 1.80 metres and 2.10 metres wide.

Main beam or full beam headlights

They are used to light a long distance in front of the vehicle travelling on the road.

This light is compulsory for all motor vehicles and optional for mopeds.

It is a powerful white light that can dazzle other vehicles.

Ver vídeo

When is it used?

On roads that are outside towns or cities.

It is compulsory to have it on:

■ When you drive on a road at night, there is little natural light and you are going at more than 40 kilometres per hour.

■ At any time of day in tunnels outside a built-up area when the tunnel is not well lit.

It is optional to switch it on when you drive at less than 40 kilometres per hour.

When is it forbidden to switch on main beam headlights?

- ■ Inside towns and cities.
- ■ When the vehicle is stopped.

Main beam headlights can be used to warn other drivers of a danger. This is done by switching the lights on and off intermittently so as not to dazzle.

Dipped beam headlights

They are used to light the road in front of the vehicle without dazzling or disturbing the drivers of other vehicles.

They are white.

Ver vídeo

It is compulsory for:

- ■ Motor vehicles: they must have two lights.
- ■ Two- and three-wheeled mopeds: they must have one or two lights.

Motorcycles, three-wheeled vehicles and heavy quadricycles may have one or two.

When is it compulsory to use it?

At night, on all types of roads, inside and outside towns and cities.

During the day, it is used when driving through tunnels or through temporary lanes that are put in place because of roadworks, accidents or other circumstances.

Ver vídeo

These lights must also be used when:

- ■ The vehicle does not have main beam headlights.

- ■ You drive at less than 40 kilometres per hour.
- ■ There is a possibility that you could dazzle the drivers of other vehicles when using main beam headlights.

Motorcycles must always have dipped beam headlights on during the day when they travel on any street or road.

[Watch video](#)

Fog lights

They are used to see the road better in case of fog, snow, heavy rain and smoke.

There are front and rear fog lights. The front lights are white or yellow. The rear lights are red

Ver vídeo

How are they used?

Front fog lights are used with sidelights.

You can also use them at the same time as main beam and dipped beam headlights.

Rear fog lights must only be used in cases of great need, when the weather and visibility conditions are very bad.

They can be switched on at the same time as main beam and dipped beam headlights and the front fog lights.

Ver vídeo

Reflector

It is a device that reflects external light from other vehicles.

It is used so that the vehicle can be seen.

This type of lights are on the front, rear and side of the vehicle.

Reflectors must be:

- ■ White at the front.
- ■ Red at the rear.
- ■ Yellow at the sides.

Ver vídeo

Trailers and semi-trailers must have them in a triangular shape at the rear.

Direction indicator light

It is used to warn that a vehicle is going to turn and move to the right or to the left.

You must switch it on whenever you are going to change direction, change direction of travel or change lane. You must switch it off when you finish that movement.

Its light is yellow and flashes. It is compulsory for all motor vehicles, trailers and semi-trailers.

Ve

[Watch video]

Hazard warning signal

It warns that the vehicle has a problem and may be a danger to other vehicles that are on the road.

To show the hazard warning signal, all the vehicle's direction indicator lights are switched on.

These lights are compulsory for motor vehicles, their trailers and semi-trailers.

[Watch video]

When are they used?

They are used in the following cases both during the day and at night.

- ■ When a vehicle has a breakdown and cannot reach the minimum speed that must be driven on that road.
- ■ When a vehicle is making an emergency journey. For example, taking a woman who is about to give birth to hospital.

- ■ To warn that another vehicle is stopped because of a problem or an emergency on any road or in a tunnel.
- ■ When picking up and dropping off passengers in school transport vehicles.

Brake light

It indicates that the vehicle is braking. The driver must warn with these lights whenever they are going to brake the vehicle, even if it is for a short time.

For example, stopping at a red traffic light.

Its light is bright red and they are fitted at the rear of the vehicle. It is compulsory for all motor vehicles, mopeds, trailers and semi-trailers.

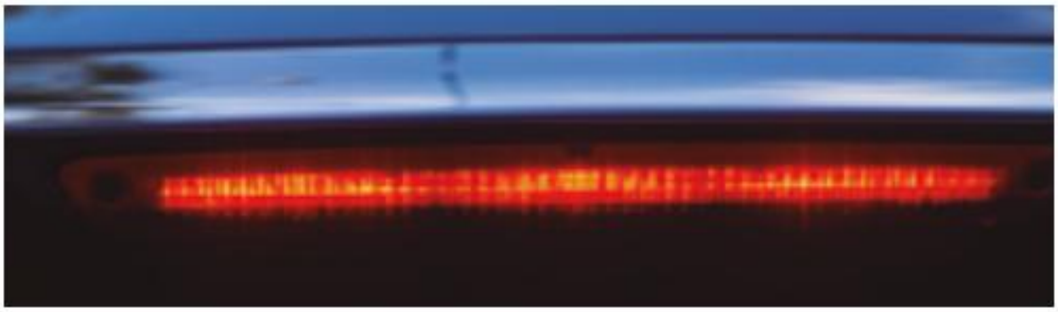
Ver vídeo

Third brake light

It is a single light that is fitted at the rear of the vehicle, above the brake lights.

It switches on at the same time as the brake lights and is the same colour.

This light is optional for motor vehicles. Motorcycles are not allowed to have it.



Ver vídeo

Reversing light

It lights the road from the rear of the vehicle to warn that the vehicle is going to travel backwards.

They are one or two white lights that switch on automatically when the vehicle starts to go backwards.

This light is compulsory for all motor vehicles, except for motorcycles, which are forbidden to have it. It is optional for three-wheeled vehicles and heavy quadricycles.

[Watch video]

Audible warning devices

They are sounds that are used to warn other drivers that a vehicle is there.

They can only be used in the following cases.

- ■ To avoid a possible accident.
- ■ On roads that are outside a town or city, to warn a driver that you are going to overtake them.

■ To warn other vehicles that you need to pass or park there because you are carrying out a priority service. For example, when you are taking a seriously injured person to hospital.

Contents

Types of signs

Vertical signs

Lines and road markings

Types of signs

General rules

- ■ It is forbidden to change road signs without a justified reason.
- ■ The instruction of each sign must be followed across the full width of the street or road. In cases where there is a different instruction for each lane, there will be road markings that indicate it.
    - ■ All drivers and pedestrians must obey the instructions of traffic signs.

[Watch video]

[Watch video]

Which traffic signs must you obey first?

1	**Signs and orders from traffic officers. of traffic.**
2	Signs that indicate that the road has been modified temporarily for some reason and signs that warn of bends and obstacles.
3	Traffic lights.
4	Vertical traffic signs.
5	Road markings and lines.

Ver vídeo

Signs on the right and left

- ■ You must obey the vertical signs and traffic lights that are on your right on the road.
- ■ When you want to turn left or go straight ahead and there are no vertical signs or traffic lights on the right, you must obey the signs that are on the left.
- ■ You must obey the signs on your left when you want to turn left or go straight ahead and there are vertical signs or traffic lights with different instructions on each side.

Signs that contradict each other

Sometimes there are signs placed together, but they give different instructions.

Different signs	Which one must you obey?
Stop sign and traffic lights on green	Traffic lights on green
Stop sign and give way sign	Stop sign
Traffic lights on green and no left turn sign	You must obey both. You can go straight on or turn right.

Traffic officers

Signals and orders from officers

You must always comply with the signals given by traffic officers.

To give instructions, they will use objects and clothing that can be clearly seen from 150 metres away.

Traffic officers will give instructions by the following means:

Arm signals Sound signals with a whistle

Signals from a vehicle

Arm signals

Arm raised vertically

All drivers approaching the officer must stop.

When this signal is made at a junction, drivers who were already inside the junction may continue.

Arm or arms extended horizontally

All drivers approaching the officer must stop.

The officer's arm or arms act as a barrier for vehicles approaching.

This order must be obeyed until the officer gives another instruction, even if they lower their arms.

Waves a red or yellow light with one arm

Drivers towards whom the officer directs the light must stop.

Extended arm moving upwards and downwards

All drivers approaching the officer from the side from which they make the arm signal must reduce the vehicle's speed.

Sound signals with a whistle

Several short, repeated whistle blasts	**Stop the vehicle.**
One long whistle blast	Move off again and continue driving.

Signals from a vehicle

Red flag	**Vehicles must not drive on that road.**
Green flag	Vehicles may drive again on that road.
Yellow flag	Drivers and pedestrians must move with great care because there is a possible danger on the road.
Arm extended downwards and held still	Requires the drivers indicated by the arm to stop on the right-hand side.
Police vehicle with a red or yellow flashing light and emitting sounds	You must stop the vehicle on the right-hand side, in front of the police vehicle and stay inside the vehicle following all the instructions from the officer.

Temporary signs

Panels with changing messages

Roadworks marking signs

Panels with changing messages

These are panels placed on roads that change the information depending on traffic circumstances.

They are used to:

- ■ Give information to drivers.
- ■ Warn of possible dangers.
- ■ Give recommendations and instructions that must be followed.

Roadworks marking signs

These are lights, signs and devices to highlight roadworks. They indicate the direction you must follow on a street or road and the obstacles you may find on them.

Topic 8. Traffic signs

Temporary direction panel	**Prohibits entry and informs which way you must go.**
Small flags and cones	Prohibit passing through them and through the space between each small flag or cone.
Fixed red light	The road is closed to traffic.
Fixed or flashing yellow lights	Prohibit passing through the space between the lights.
Permanent direction panels	Devices that indicate which way you must go in a place where there is always a possible danger.
	The number of panels warns how much danger there is in that area: ■ One panel means moderate danger. ■ Two panels mean quite a lot of danger. ■ Three panels mean
	a lot of danger.

Traffic lights

There are different types of traffic lights:

For pedestrians Circular for vehicles Lane For some vehicles

Traffic lights for pedestrians

Their instructions apply to pedestrians.

Not to drivers

Ver vídeo

Circular traffic lights for vehicles

Fixed red light	**No entry.**
One or two flashing red lights	Prohibits entry for a period of time. They are placed before a level crossing or a bridge.
Fixed amber light	Prohibits entry like the fixed red light. But it does allow vehicles to pass that cannot stop for safety reasons.
One or two flashing amber lights	Require you to give way to vehicles coming from the right and from the left. Also to pedestrians.
Fixed green light	Allows vehicles to go and also gives them priority at the junction.

Black arrow	**The vehicle may only go towards the side indicated by the arrow. Also, you must respect the meaning of the colour behind the arrow. For example, do not go if it is red.**
Green arrow	Allows vehicles to move forward in the direction indicated by the arrow. You must do so carefully, watching for pedestrians crossing the road and vehicles entering that lane.

Ver vídeo

Square traffic lights for vehicles or lane traffic lights

Only vehicles travelling in the lane where the traffic light is placed must obey it.

Meaning of their lights

Red light in the shape of a cross	**You must not use that lane. All drivers must leave it as quickly as possible.**

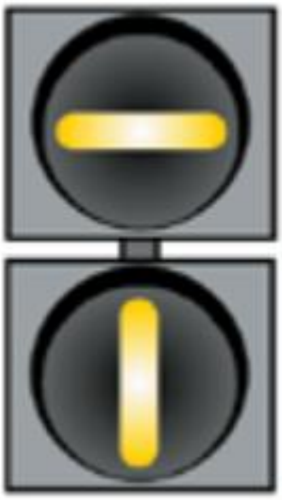
Green light in the shape of a downward arrow	**You are allowed to drive in that lane. Drivers must obey the rest of the signs there are in that lane.**
White or amber light in the shape of a downward arrow	Tells drivers that they must go to the lane indicated by the arrow because the lane they are in now is going to be closed.

Traffic lights for some vehicles Traffic lights for cycles and mopeds

A cycle is shown on the traffic light. Its instructions do not apply to the rest of the vehicles.

Traffic lights for trams, buses and other vehicles

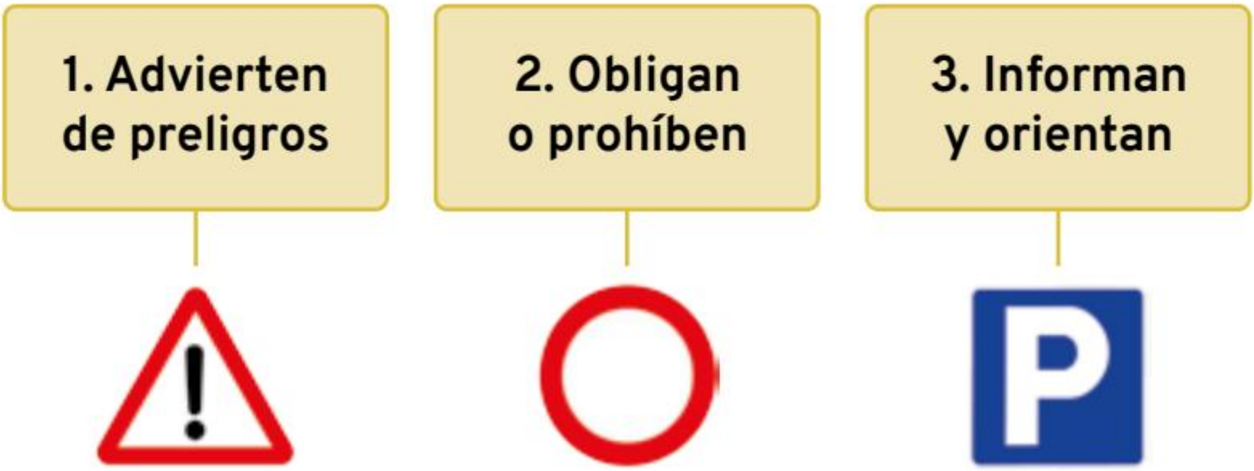
They have a white line on a black circular background. Their instructions do not apply to cars.



Vertical signs

They are plates with information that stay fixed on posts or on other structures on roads and streets.

Vertical signs depending on what their function is:



Remember...

A **road** is the place where you travel. It can be a street, a road or a track.

The **carriageway** is the part of the road where vehicles travel.

Warning signs

The name of these signs starts with a P for danger.

P-1. Priority over oncoming vehicles.

Vehicles travelling on that road have priority to go first, before vehicles coming from the side roads or streets.

P-1a Priority over vehicles coming from the road on the right.

P-1b Priority over vehicles coming from the road on the left.

P-1c Priority over vehicles that want to enter that road from the right.

P-1d Priority over vehicles that want to enter that road from the left.

P-2 Junction.

Vehicles coming from the right have priority.

P-3 Traffic lights.

Nearby there is a junction or a section of road with traffic lights to control traffic. You must drive carefully because there may be vehicles queued and stopped at the traffic lights.

P-4 Roundabout. Vehicles can only go in the direction of the arrows.

P-5 Swing bridge.

There is a bridge nearby that can be raised or turned.

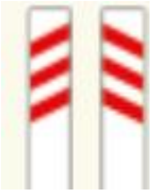
When it is raised or turned, traffic is stopped and vehicles must wait.

P-6 Tram crossing. Danger because nearby there is a junction with a tram line that has priority.

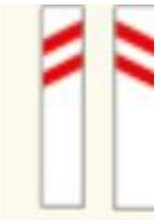
P-7 Level crossing with barriers nearby. A level crossing is the place where the railway tracks cross a path or road. On the road, before reaching the railway track, you will find a barrier.

P-8 Level crossing without barriers nearby. There will be no barrier separating the road you are travelling on and the railway track.

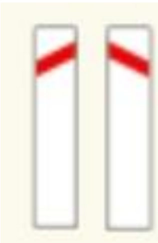
P-9a and P-10a There is a level crossing, swing bridge or quay about 300 metres away.



P-9b and P-10b There is a level crossing, swing bridge or quay about 200 metres away.

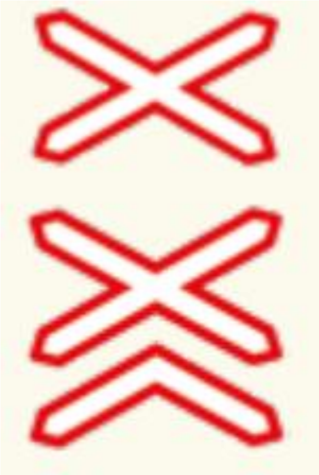


P-9c and P-10c There is a level crossing, swing bridge or quay about 100 metres away.



P-11 Level crossing without barriers at that same place.

P-11a Level crossing without barriers where there is more than one railway track. At that same place.



P-12 Airport

Danger due to unexpected noises that aircraft may cause.

P-13a Dangerous bend to the right.

P-13b Dangerous bend to the left.

P-14a Several dangerous bends nearby. The first goes to the right.

P-14b Several dangerous bends nearby. The first goes to the left.

P-15 Uneven road.

There are humps, dips, or the road is in poor condition.

Humps are raised parts of the road that stick up to force vehicles to reduce speed. Dips are also parts of the road: potholes or trenches in the road.

P-15a There are humps in the road.

P-15b There are dips in the road.

P-16a Very steep downhill slope.

P-16b Very steep uphill slope.

P-17 The carriageway becomes narrower.

P-17a The carriageway becomes narrower on the right.

P-17b The carriageway becomes narrower on the left.

P-18 Roadworks.

P-19 Slippery road.

P-20 Pedestrians.

Careful, you are approaching a place where there are usually pedestrians.

P-21 Children near this place. For example, the exit of a school.

P-22 Place where cyclists often pass or cross.

P-23 Place where domestic animals may often pass. For example, cows, sheep...

P-24 Place where animals running free may cross.

P-25 Vehicles may travel in both directions.

P-26 There may be stones or other obstacles on the road because it is an area where objects fall. For example, a road below a mountain.

P-27 The road ends at a port quay or in a watercourse.

P-28 Small stones, called loose chippings, are thrown up from the road surface.

P-29 Strong side wind.

P-30 The carriageway is at a different height on one side because there is a step.

P-31 There is heavy traffic on a section of the road.

P-32 There are vehicles that make traffic difficult due to a breakdown, accident or other causes.

P-33 There is fog, snow or smoke on the road and visibility is worse.

P-34 An area of the carriageway is very slippery due to ice or snow.

P-35 Warning of a danger different from all the previous ones.

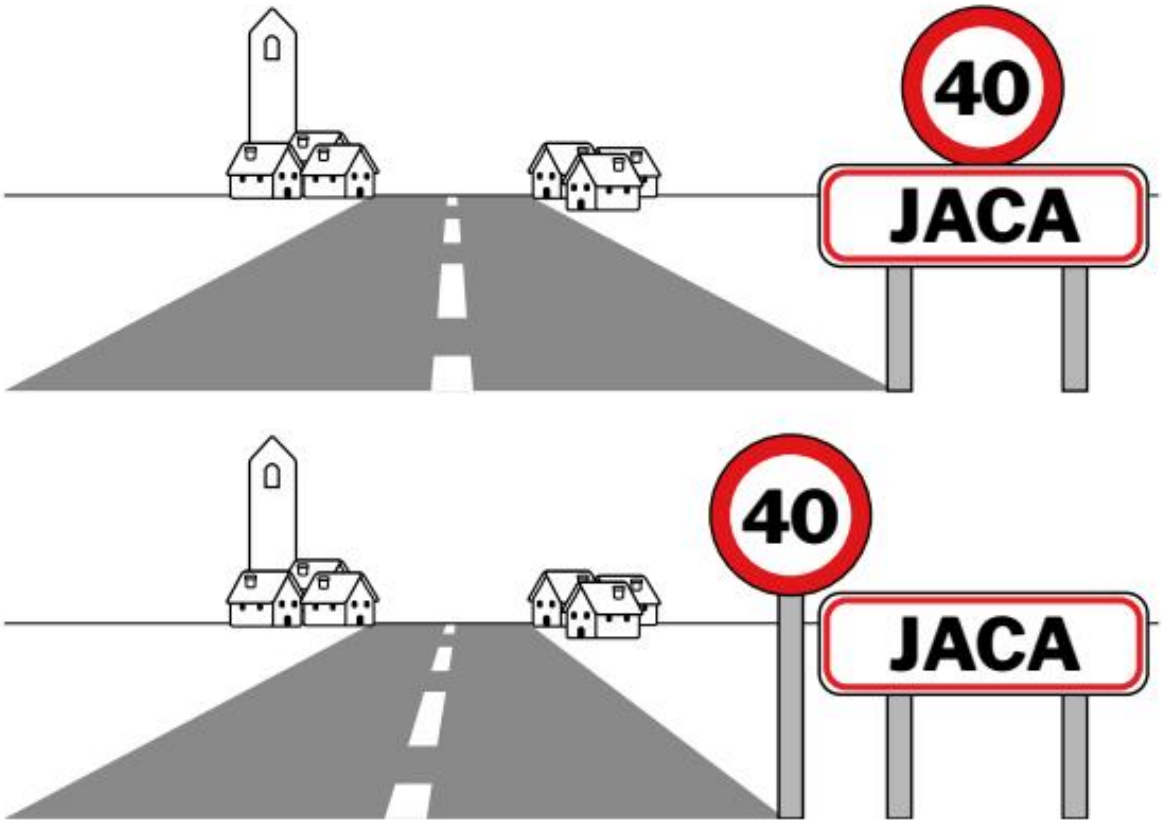
Regulatory signs

They are signs that inform drivers and pedestrians of their obligations, restrictions and prohibitions on the road.

Regulatory signs placed next to or above the sign that shows the name of the town or city mean that this rule must be followed throughout the whole town or city.

For example, a circular sign with the number 40 above the name of a town means that it is forbidden to drive at more than 40 kilometres per hour throughout the whole town.

If the circular sign is before or after, it means that you must not drive at more than 40 kilometres per hour on that section, until you find another sign.



The names of regulatory signs start with the letter R and there are different types:

Priority signs

R-1 Give way.

You must give way to all vehicles already travelling on the road you want to enter, or that are in the lane you want to go into.

R-2 Stop.

You must stop the vehicle and give way to vehicles already travelling on the road you want to enter.

R-3 Priority road. While you are on that road you have priority at junctions over drivers who reach the junction from another road.

R-4 End of priority road. The road you are travelling on no longer has more priority than other roads.

R-5 Do not enter a narrow passage if, when going through it, you would obstruct vehicles coming towards you.

R-6 You have priority to go through a narrow passage before vehicles coming in the opposite direction.

Signs that prohibit entry

R-100 No vehicles. It forbids all vehicles, in any direction.

R-101 No entry.

It forbids entry to all types of vehicles. Vehicles may be travelling in the opposite direction to you because this prohibition may apply only in one direction.

R-102 No entry for motor vehicles.

Mopeds may enter.

R-103 No entry for motor vehicles.

Two-wheeled motorcycles, without sidecar, may enter.

R-104 No entry for motorcycles.

R-105 No entry for mopeds and vehicles for persons with reduced mobility.

R-106 No entry for vehicles carrying goods, even if they are not carrying much load. For example, vans and lorries.

R-107 No entry for vehicles carrying goods and that can carry a load of tonnes greater than the number shown on the sign.

These vehicles are forbidden to enter, even if they are empty at that moment.

R-108 No entry for vehicles carrying dangerous goods.

R-109 No entry for vehicles carrying goods that can explode or catch fire.

R-110 No entry for vehicles carrying more than 1,000 litres of products that can pollute water.

R-111 No entry for tractors and other motorised agricultural machines.

R-112 No entry for motor vehicles with a trailer. Articulated vehicles and single-axle trailers may enter.

R-113 No entry for vehicles drawn by animals. For example, horse-drawn carriages.

R-114 No entry for bicycles.

R-115 No entry for handcarts.

R-116 No entry for pedestrians.

R-117 No entry for animals being ridden.

Signs that restrict passage

R-200 You must stop the vehicle at the place where it is placed, to comply with the signs that apply in each case.

For example, a toll booth on the motorway or a police checkpoint.

R-201 Vehicles carrying a load that weighs more than the number of tonnes shown on the sign are forbidden to pass.

R-202 Vehicles with an axle load greater than the number of tonnes shown on the sign are forbidden to pass.

In this case, vehicles with an axle load greater than 2.4 tonnes must not pass.

R-203 No entry for vehicles that are longer than the length shown on the sign.

R-204 No entry for vehicles that are wider than the width shown on the sign.

R-205 No entry for vehicles that are higher than the height shown on the sign.

Other prohibition or restriction signs

R-300 Minimum distance from the vehicle in front.

Obligation to keep the number of metres of distance from the vehicle in front shown on the sign.

R-301 Maximum permitted speed. It is forbidden to drive at a higher speed, in kilometres per hour, than the one shown on the sign. This applies until you see another sign for end of speed limit, end of prohibitions, or another maximum speed sign.

R-302 No right turn.

R-303 No left turn and no U-turn.

R-304 No U-turn.

You must not turn round and go the other way.

R-305 No overtaking other vehicles. You may only overtake two-wheeled motorcycles if you do not enter the oncoming lane. You must obey this sign until another one appears that indicates that you may overtake in that area.

R-306 No overtaking for lorries that can carry loads of more than 3,500 kilos. They may only overtake two-wheeled motorcycles if they do not enter the oncoming lane.

R-307 No stopping and no parking in that place.

R-308 No parking on that side of the carriageway. You may stop, but not park.

R-308a No parking on that side of the carriageway on odd days of the month. You may stop, but not park.

R-308b No parking on that side of the carriageway on even days of the month. For example, days 2, 4, 6... You may stop, but not park.

R-308c No parking on that side of the carriageway during the first 15 days of each month. You may stop, but not park.

R-308d No parking on that side of the carriageway between day 16 and the last day of each month. You may stop, but not park.

R-308e No parking in front of a dropped kerb.

Dropped kerbs are spaces in the street reserved so that some vehicles can enter their garages, homes or shops.

R-309 Limited-duration parking zone.

The driver must indicate the time when they left the vehicle parked.

R-310 Remember that you should only use the horn and sound signals with the vehicle when they are necessary to avoid accidents.

Mandatory signs

R-400a Must go to the right.

R-400b Must go to the left.

R-400c Must go straight on.

R-400d Must turn right.

R-400e Must turn left.

R-401a Must pass on the side shown by the sign.

R-401b Must pass on the side shown by the sign.

R-401c Must pass on the sides shown by the sign.

R-402 Must turn in the direction shown by the arrows.

R-403a Must turn right or go straight on.

You must not make a U-turn.

R-403b Must turn left or go straight on. You must not make a U-turn.

R-403c Must turn right or left.

o a izquierda.
No puedes hacer cambio de sentido.

R-404 Cars must use this carriageway. Motorcycles without a sidecar are not required to.

R-405 Motorcycles without a sidecar must use this carriageway.

R-406 Lorries, vans and light vans must use this carriageway.

R-407a Road reserved only for bicycles. Nobody else may use this road.

R-407b Road reserved only for mopeds. Nobody else may use this road.

R-408 Vehicles drawn by animals must use this track. Others may also use this track.

R-409 People riding an animal must use this track. Nobody else may use this track.

R-410 Pedestrians must use this track. Nobody else may use this track.

R-411 Minimum speed.

Vehicles must travel at least at the speed shown on the sign. You must not drive more slowly. You must follow this rule until you find another sign that allows you to drive at a lower speed.

R-412 Must fit snow chains on the vehicle to continue driving.

R-413 Must switch on dipped headlights.

You must keep them on until another sign tells you that you may switch them off.

R-414 Vehicles carrying dangerous goods must use this road.

R-415 Vehicles carrying more than 1,000 litres of products that can pollute water must use this road.

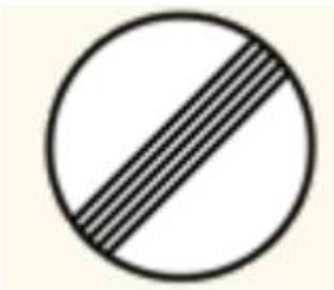
R-416 Vehicles carrying explosive material or material that can catch fire must use this road.

R-418 Lane only for vehicles that have an electronic toll device.

The electronic toll is an electronic device that is placed on the windscreen and recognises your vehicle's number plate so that the motorway barrier opens automatically.

Signs that end the prohibition or the obligation

R-500 End of all prohibitions. It indicates the place from which all prohibitions end.



R-501 End of speed limit. You may go faster.

R-502 End of no overtaking. You may overtake other vehicles.

R-503 End of no overtaking for lorries.

Lorries may overtake other vehicles.

R-504 End of limited parking zone. Vehicles may park in that place.

R-505 End of road reserved for bicycles.

R-506 End of minimum speed. You may drive more slowly than the sign indicates.

Signs that give information of interest

They give information of interest to drivers and pedestrians.

They are called information signs. There are different types of information signs.

General information signs

S-1 Place where a motorway begins.

S-1a Lugar donde comienza una autovía.

- **S-2** Place where a motorway ends.
- **S-2a** Place where a dual carriageway ends.

S-3 Start of a road reserved for cars to use.

S-4 End of a road reserved for cars.

S-5 A tunnel begins.

S-6 End of the tunnel.

S-7 Recommended maximum speed. It recommends the maximum speed at which you should always drive on that road.

S-8 End of recommended maximum speed. The stretch of road where it is recommended to drive at that speed or more slowly ends.

S-9 Recommended speeds. It recommends driving between the two speeds shown on the sign.

S-10 End of recommended speeds. It indicates the place from which it is no longer recommended to continue driving at those speeds.

S-11 One-way carriageway. They indicate the direction in which vehicles must travel on that road. They also prohibit making a U-turn (turning round).

The arrows indicate the number of lanes

S-12 Stretch of one-way carriageway. It indicates that on that stretch of street or road you must travel in the direction the arrow points. It is forbidden to do so in the other direction.

S-13 Pedestrian crossing.

S-15a No through road. Vehicles can only leave that carriageway by the same place they entered.

S-16 Emergency stopping area. It indicates an area where vehicles can pull off and stop when their brakes fail.

S-17 Place where vehicles may park.

S-18 Taxi rank.

S-19 Bus stop.

Mountain pass.

Road that crosses a mountain.

S-21 Driving through a **mountain pass**. It indicates the conditions of the mountain pass and whether you can drive through it or not. The sign has three panels and each one indicates one thing:

S-21.1 a, b, c, d and e.

Panel number 1. It can be different colours. White, with the word OPEN. All vehicles may drive through.

Green. All vehicles may drive through. But lorries that can carry more than 3,500 kilos must not overtake other vehicles.

Yellow. Cars and buses must drive at a maximum speed of 60 kilometres per hour. Lorries that can carry more than 3,500 kilos and articulated lorries must not pass.

Red. Vehicles must carry chains and drive at a maximum speed of 30 kilometres per hour. Lorries and buses must not pass.

Black, with the word CLOSED. No vehicle may pass on that road.

S-21.2 a, b, c and d.

Panel number 2. It can have the following signs:

R-306 when panel 1 is green.

R-106 and R-301 you must drive at less than 60 kilometres per hour when panel 1 is yellow.

R-107 with the inscription 3,5 t and R-412 when panel 1 is red.

S_21.3 a and b.

Panel number 3.

It may show the name of the place from which you must follow the instructions on panels 1 and 2.

S-22 You may make a U-turn.

S-23 There is a hospital nearby. It warns drivers to make little noise with their vehicles when passing in front.

S-24 You may stop using dipped headlights.

S-25 You may make a U-turn via a road that is higher or lower.

S-26 a There is a motorway, dual carriageway or road for motor vehicles exit in 300 metres.

S-26 b There is a motorway, dual carriageway or road for motor vehicles exit in 200 metres.

S-26 c There is a motorway, dual carriageway or road for motor vehicles exit in 100 metres.

S-27 There is an assistance post on the road to ask for help in case of an accident or breakdown.

S-28 Area with priority for pedestrians. You must not drive faster than 20 kilometres per hour.

S-30 Area where pedestrians may walk. You must not drive faster than 30 kilometres per hour.

S-31 End of the area with priority for pedestrians. You may drive at more than 30 kilometres per hour.

S-32 Electronic toll.

Vehicles may pay the toll by electronic toll as long as the vehicle has the necessary technical equipment installed.

S-33 There is a path reserved for pedestrians and bicycles, separated from motor traffic, in parks, gardens and forests.

S-34 There is a place where a vehicle can be parked inside a tunnel in case of emergency or breakdown.

S-34a It indicates that this place has an emergency telephone.

Signs that give information about lanes

S-50a, S-50b, S-50c, S-50d and S-50e

In the lanes marked with a number, only vehicles travelling at that speed or faster may use them.

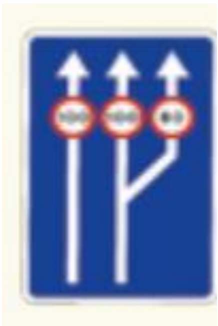
S-51 Lane reserved for buses.

S-52, S-52a and S-52b

It warns that a lane can no longer be used and indicates the lane you can continue in.

S-53c Road that goes from having two lanes to having three lanes.

It also indicates the maximum speed at which you may drive in each of them.



S-60a. On a two-lane road it indicates that the left lane is going to deviate to the left.

S-60b. On a two-lane road it indicates that the right lane is going to deviate to the right.

S-61a. On a three-lane road it indicates that the left lane is going to deviate to the left.

S-61b. On a three-lane road it indicates that the right lane is going to deviate to the right.

S-64 Cycle lane or cycle track on the road. Only cycles may use that lane.

Signs that inform about services

S-100 First-aid post where emergency treatment can be given.

S-101 Place where there are ambulances to assist and transport people injured in road traffic accidents.

S-102 Place where vehicle inspections can be carried out.

S-103 There is a vehicle repair workshop.

S-104 There is a telephone.

S-105 Place where you can refuel the vehicle.

S-106 Place where you can repair the vehicle and refuel.

S-107 Place where you can camp.	
S-108 There is a drinking water fountain.	
S-109 There is a nice place to see.	
S-110 There is a hotel or a motel.	
S-111 There is a restaurant.	
S-112 There is a bar or café.	
S-113 Caravans may park.	

S-114 You may stop to eat.

S-115 From that place you can start a walking excursion.

S-116 You may camp in that place with a tent and with a caravan.

S-117 There is a youth hostel.

S-118 There is a tourist information office.

S-119 Area of a river where special authorisation is needed to fish.

S-120 There is a national park.

S-121 There are monuments to see and visit.

S-122 Sign to indicate other services.

S-123 Rest area to stop and rest.

S-124 Area to park vehicles that connects with a train station.

S-125 Area to park vehicles that connects with an underground station.

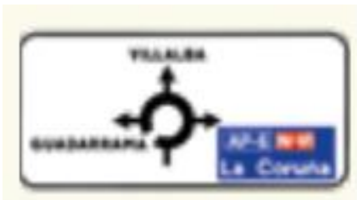
S-126 Area to park vehicles that connects with a bus station.

S-127 Service area on a motorway or dual carriageway. In service areas there are usually petrol stations, restaurants and places to rest for a while.

Direction signs

S-200 It indicates all the exits at the next roundabout. The exits shown in blue mean

that they lead to a motorway or dual carriageway.



S-222a It indicates the direction of a road and the exits that lead to a motorway or dual carriageway.

S-232 It indicates where the entrance to the motorway is and at what distance.

S-235a It indicates which is the next exit on a motorway or dual carriageway and how far away it is.

S-300 It indicates the names of towns and cities on a road and how far away that town or city is.

S-301 It indicates the names of towns and cities on a motorway or dual carriageway and how far away that town or city is.

S-322 It indicates in which direction a cycle track or cycle path is and the distance to it.

S-360 It indicates the road number, the place that road goes to, and the name of the town or city at the next exit towards another road.

S-368 It indicates the motorway or dual carriageway number, where they go, and the name of the town or city at the next exit towards another road.

Signs to classify roads

S-400 European road. Name given to that road in Europe.

S-410 Motorway or dual carriageway.

S-410a Toll motorway.

S-420 National road, of the Spanish State.

S-430 Most important road of an Autonomous Community. They are called first-level regional roads.

S-440 Roads that connect towns within an Autonomous Community or are used to reach first-level roads. They are called second-level regional roads.

C-241 Roads that connect small towns.

They are called third-level regional roads.

Signs that indicate where you are

S-500 Entrance to a town or city.

S-510 Exit from a town or city.

S-574 It indicates the kilometre where you are on a motorway or dual carriageway, and you will see them every 10 kilometres. That is, from the start of the motorway or dual carriageway it marks kilometre 10, kilometre 20, kilometre 30, until the end.

S-574a It indicates the kilometre where you are on a road, and you will see them every 10 kilometres, the same as on the motorway and dual carriageway.

S-574b It indicates the kilometre where you are on a toll motorway, and you will see them every 10 kilometres, the same as the rest.

S-575 It indicates the kilometre where you are on a regional road, and you will also see them every 10 kilometres. The colour corresponds to the level of importance of the road.

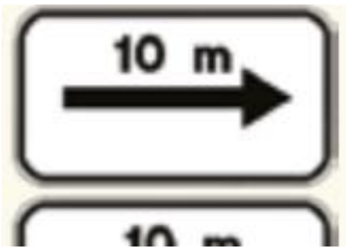
Supplementary plates

S-800 It indicates the distance from the sign to a hazard or warning.

S-810 It indicates how long the hazardous section is.

For how many metres or kilometres there is danger.

S-820 and **S-821** These signs are placed below a prohibition sign. They indicate how many metres that prohibition lasts, following the arrow.



S-850 to **S-853** It indicates in which direction and sense you may drive with priority. It is placed next to sign R-3, which means priority road.

S-840 It is placed below the Give way sign.

S-870 It is placed below another sign. It indicates that the prohibition or warning on the other sign only applies to the lane or slip road it points to.

It indicates the distance at which you must stop.

S-880 It is placed below another sign. It indicates that the prohibition or warning on the other sign only has to be obeyed by the vehicles shown on this sign.

S-890 It is placed below another sign. It indicates that the prohibition or warning on the other sign must be obeyed when there is snow, rain or fog.

S-960 There is an emergency telephone.

S-980 There is an emergency exit.

S-990 It indicates where the emergency exit is in tunnels.

Lines and road markings

Lines and white markings

Continuous line

This line prohibits drivers from:

- ■ Crossing the line.
- ■ Driving on it.

- ■ Driving to the left of the line when the road is two-way.

When the line is slightly wider than normal it indicates that there is a special lane.

For example, a lane that only some vehicles may use.

Broken line

This line forbids drivers to drive over it.

You may only drive over it when the lane is less than three metres wide and it is necessary.

When the gap between the broken lines is shorter than normal, it means that a continuous line or a dangerous situation is near. For example, a bend with poor visibility.

When the gap between the lines is wider

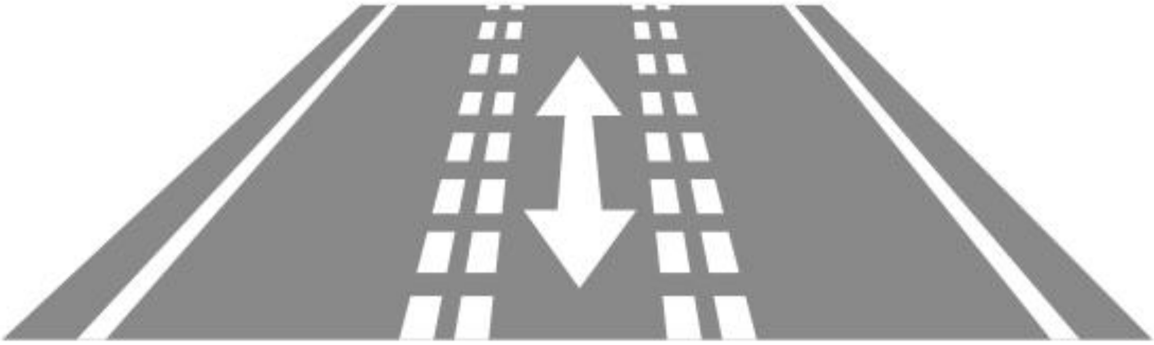
than normal, it means that a special lane is near.

Broken line. Line made up of many smaller lines in a row, with empty spaces between them.

Double broken lines

Double broken lines on both sides of a lane mean that in this lane sometimes you can drive in one direction and other times in the other.

There will be traffic lights in that lane or other means to indicate in which direction you may drive and to avoid accidents.

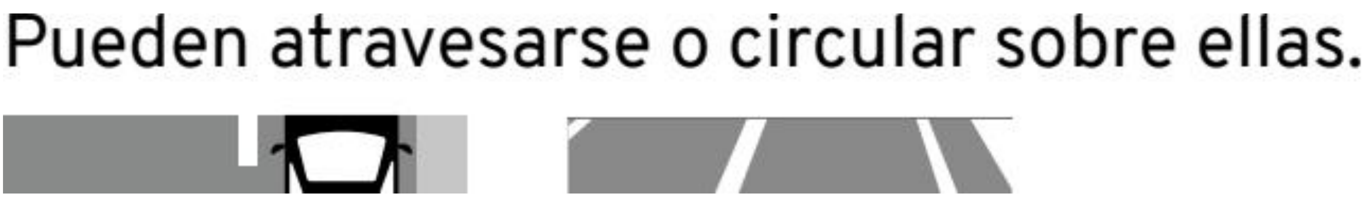


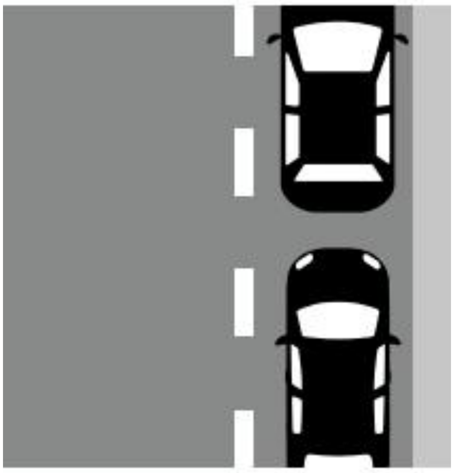
Continuous and broken lines together

In this case, each driver must only take into account the line that is closer to the side they are driving on.

Edge and parking lines

Lines that mark where the road ends or places where you can park.

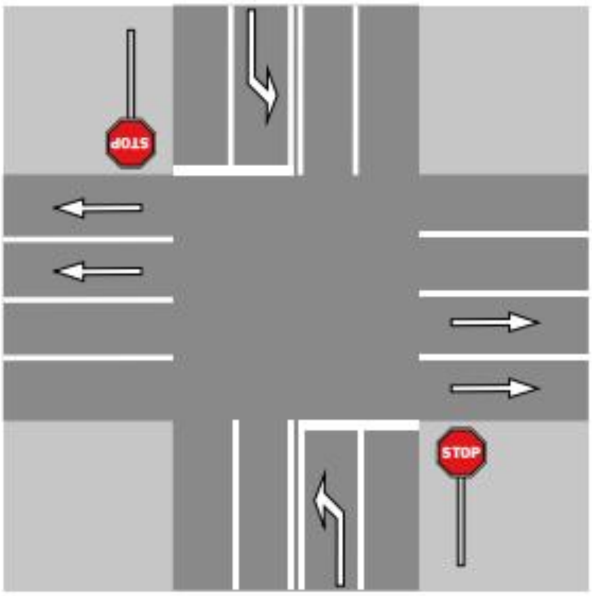




Continuous transverse line

All vehicles must stop at this type of line when the following signs indicate it: the signs that indicate that stopping is compulsory.

- ■ Pedestrian crossings.
- ■ Traffic lights.
- ■ Instructions from traffic officers.
- ■ Signals at a level crossing or movable bridge.



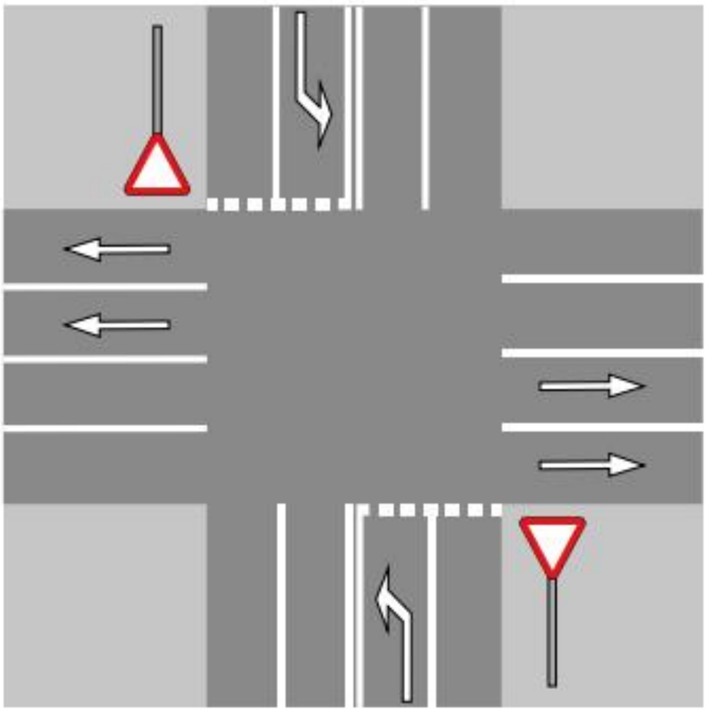
In any case, the marking does not by itself impose an obligation.

Transverse line. A line that crosses the road across its width, instead of along it.

Broken transverse line

Vehicles must not cross it if they must give way to other vehicles, following the right-of-way rules and obeying the indications shown by these signs:

- ■ Give way sign.
- ■ Green turning arrow of a traffic light.



Pedestrian crossing

Wide lines on the carriageway that indicate that drivers must give way to pedestrians.

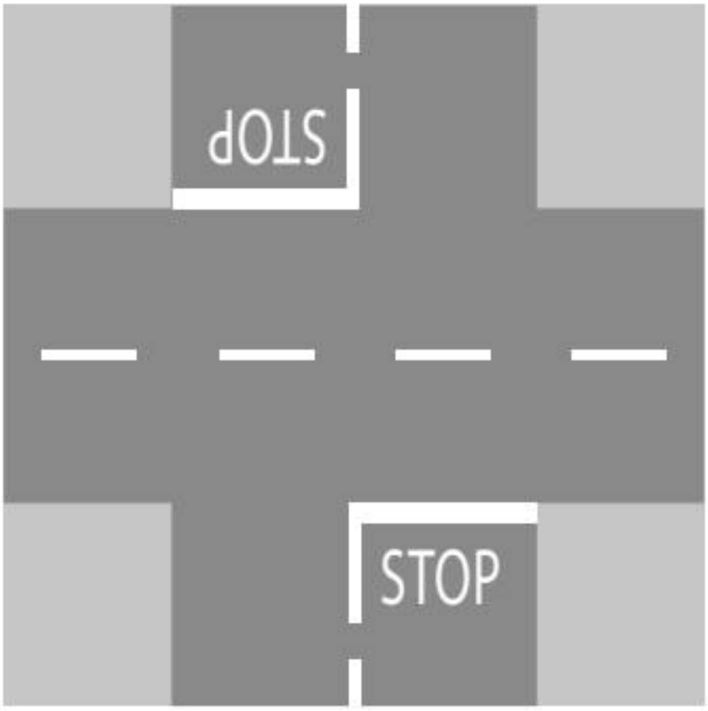
Ver vídeo

Cyclist crossing

Broken and parallel lines on the carriageway that indicate that cyclists have priority to travel through that place.

STOP sign written on the carriageway

The driver must stop their vehicle before the stop line to give way to drivers travelling on the carriageway they want to enter.



Speed limit sign written on the carriageway

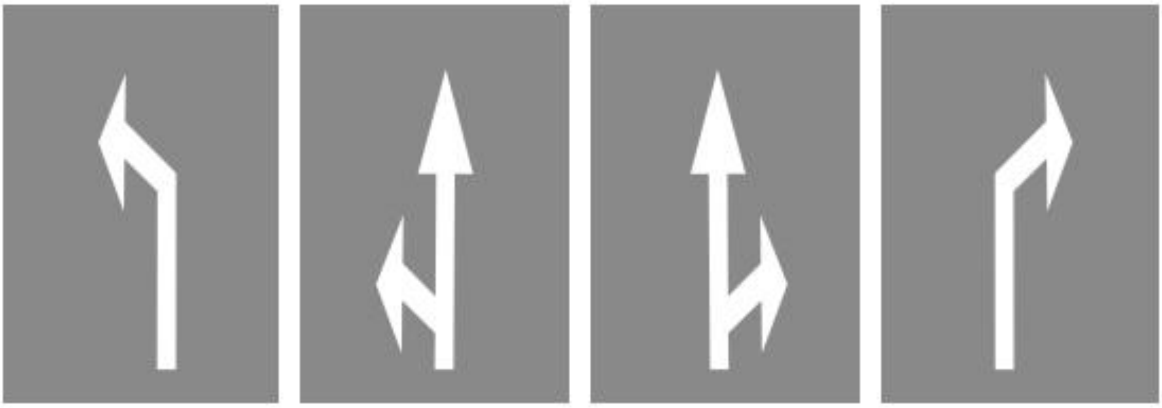
No vehicle must go at more kilometres per hour than the number shown by the sign in that lane.

You must follow that indication until another sign says that you may drive at another speed.

Arrow to choose a lane

All drivers must follow the direction, or one of the directions, shown by the arrows in the lane they are travelling in.

If the signs allow it, you may also change lane.

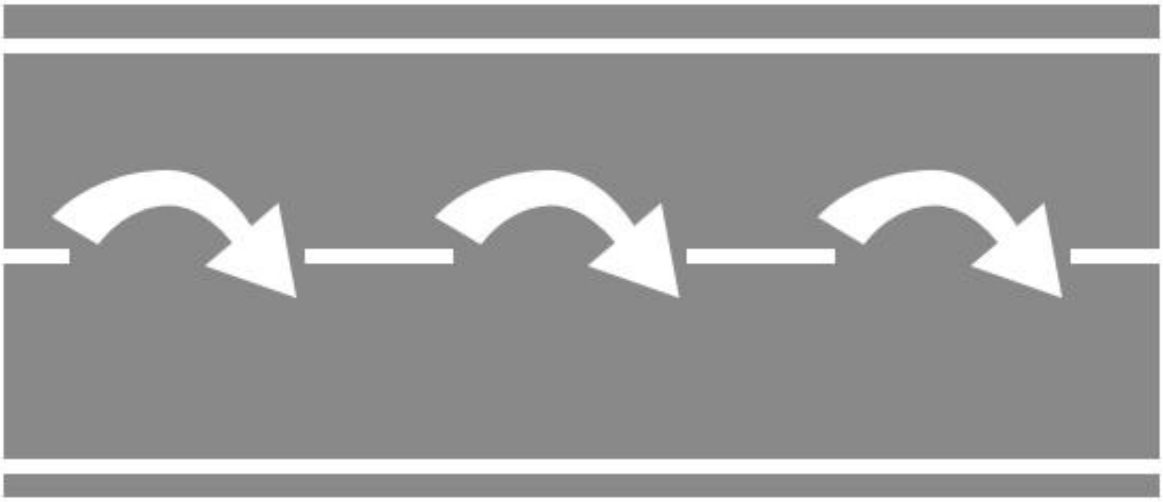


End-of-lane arrow

It warns that the lane you are in is ending and tells you where you must go.

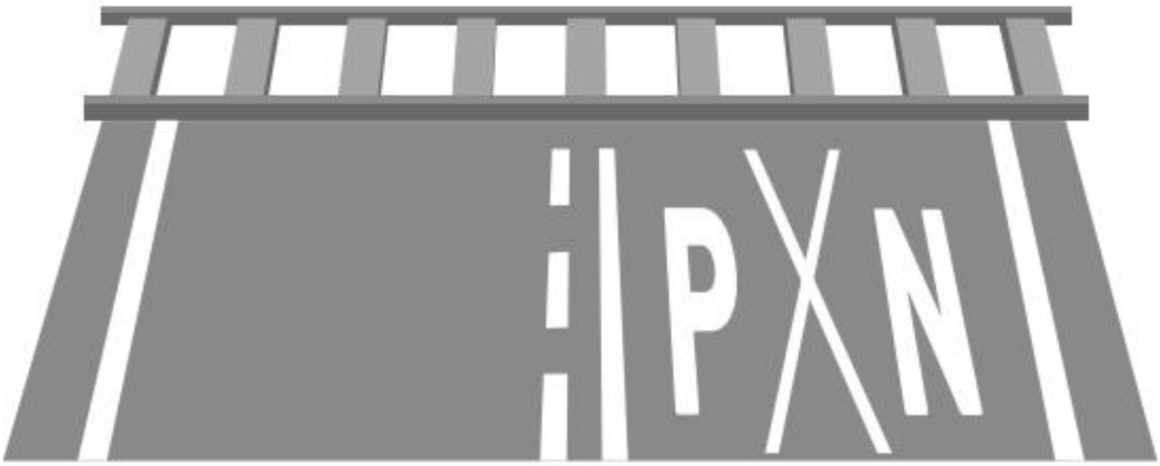
Return-to-lane arrow

It warns that a continuous line is coming and indicates to drivers that they must move as soon as possible to the right of the lane.



Level crossing marking

The letters P and N written on the ground with two cross-shaped lines indicate that a level crossing is near.



Reserved lane or area

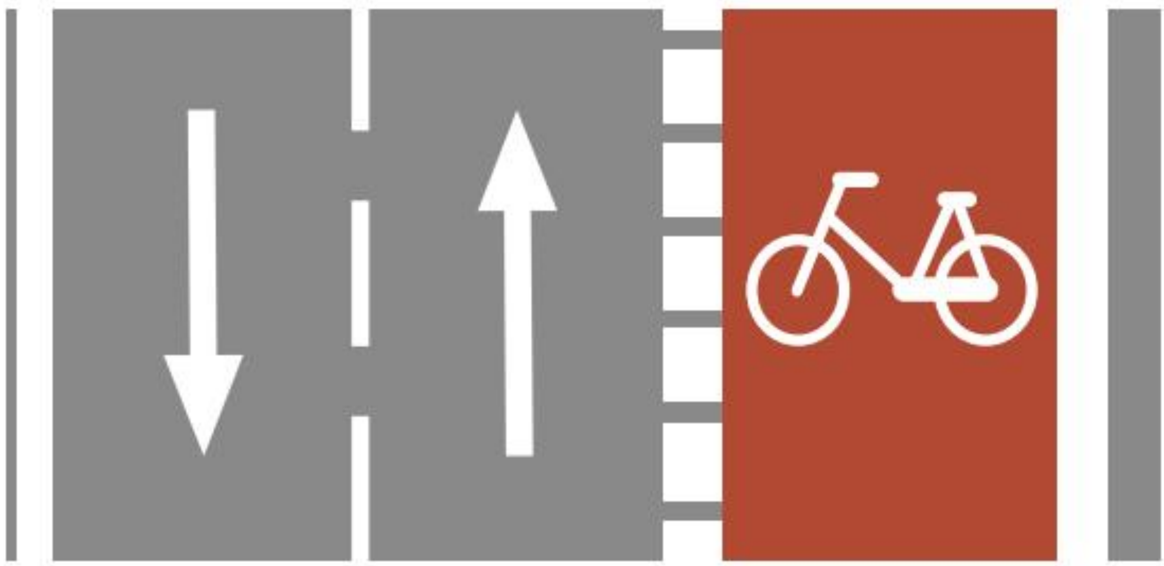
It indicates that that area or lane is reserved for certain vehicles to travel or stop. For example, buses and taxis.

Start of reserved lane marking

It indicates where the lane reserved for some vehicles begins.**BUS**

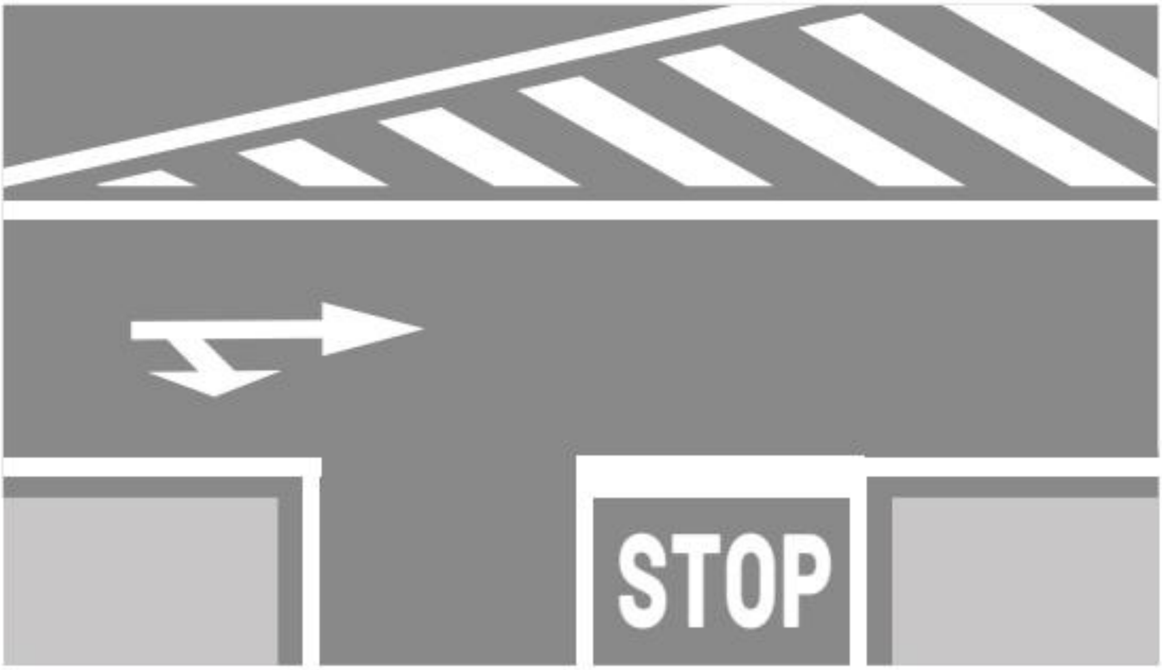
Cycle lane or cycle track marking

It indicates that that lane is reserved for bicycles to travel.



Zebra markings

It forbids vehicles to travel in that area. Only vehicles that are obliged to travel on the hard shoulder may travel in that space.



Coloured lines and markings

Yellow line with zigzag markings

It indicates that parking is prohibited in that area.

Continuous yellow line

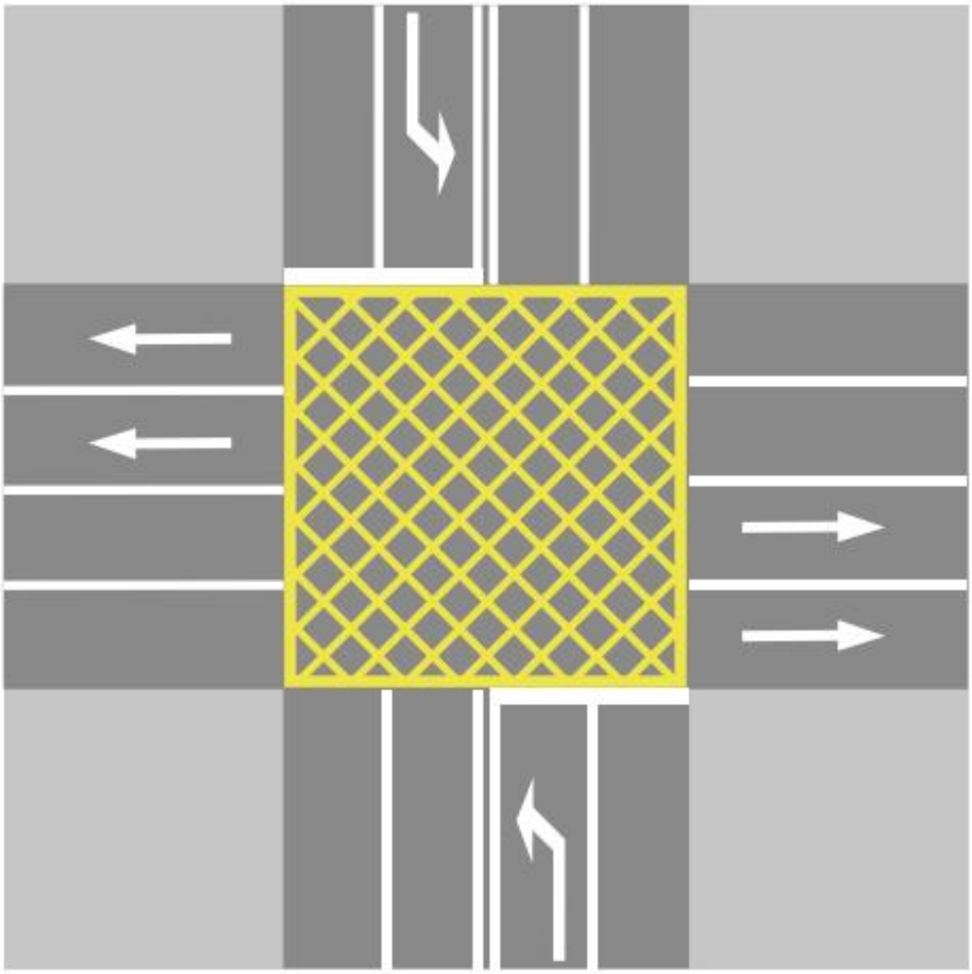
It indicates that stopping and parking are prohibited in that area.

Broken yellow line

It indicates that parking is prohibited in that area.

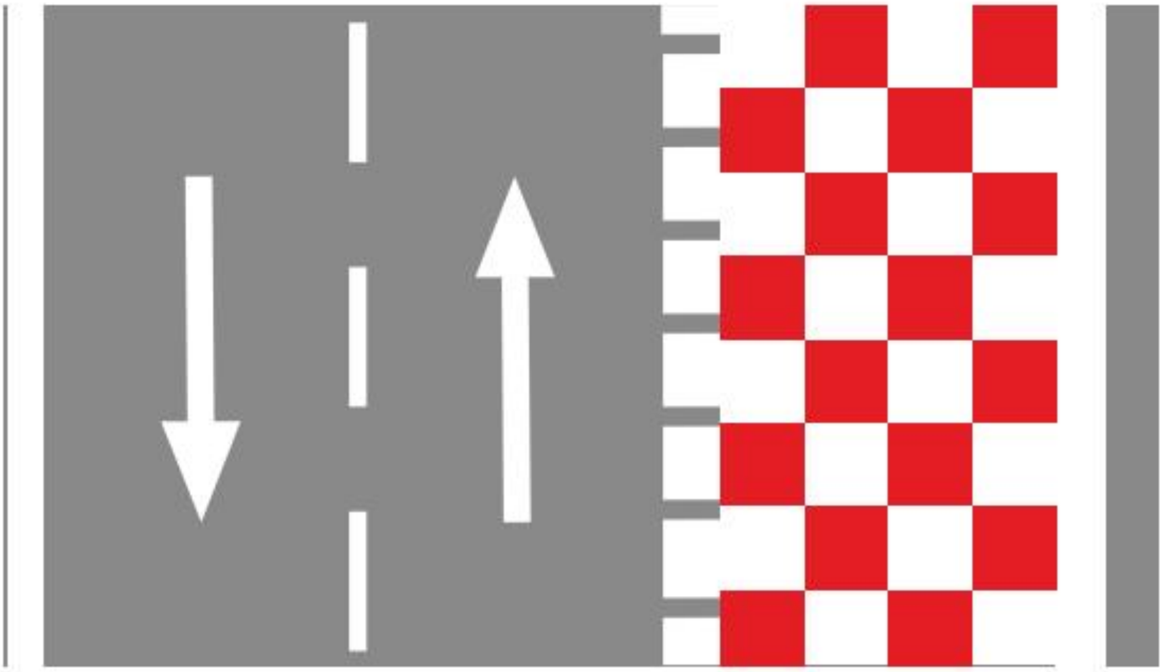
Marking made up of yellow squares

It indicates to drivers that entering that area is prohibited if they could end up stopped in it, obstructing traffic.



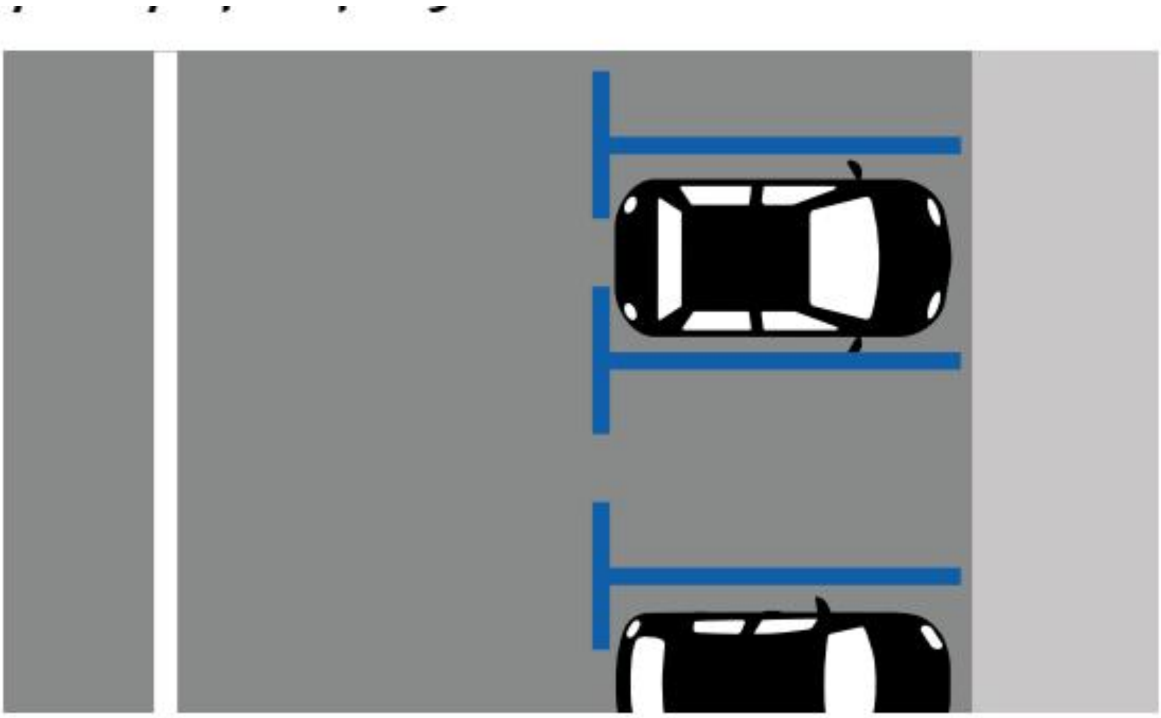
White and red squares

Area for emergency braking. This is the only reason why a vehicle may enter that area.



Blue parking markings

At some times of the day you may only park for a limited time and you have to pay.



Contents

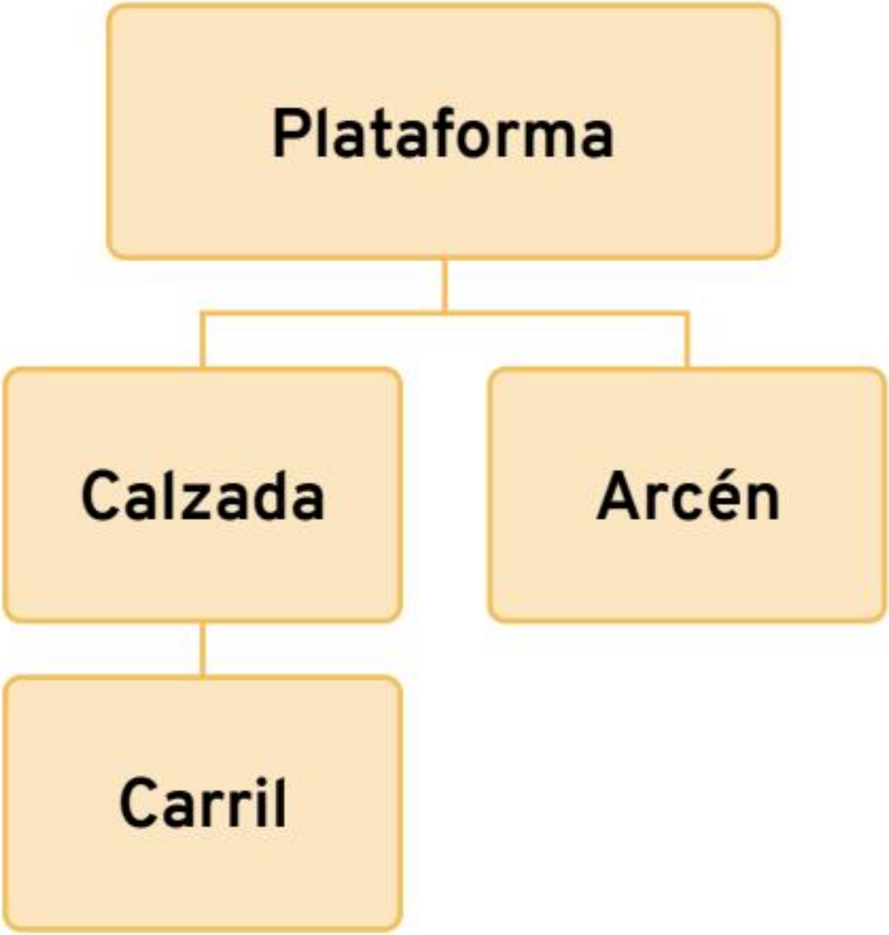
The road for vehicles and pedestrians

What is a road?

A road is each street, road and track, public and private, where vehicles and pedestrians may travel.

Parts of the road for vehicles

The parts of the road that matter to the driver are:



Roadway

It is the whole area of the road that vehicles can use to travel and to stop. Within the roadway are the carriageway and the hard shoulder.

Topic 9. The road

Carriageway	**Part of the road** **where vehicles travel.** **The same road may have several carriageways.** **A narrow carriageway** **is one that measures** **less than 6.5 metres.**
Hard shoulder	Paved area that is on both sides of the carriageway where most vehicles do not travel. Some roads do not have a hard shoulder.

A road may have several roadways.

Lane

It is one of the parts into which the carriageway may be divided. Its width must allow a line of cars to travel.

On the same carriageway there may be several lanes, depending on how wide it is. They are usually separated by a white line.

When the lane is less than 3 metres wide, it is called a narrow lane.

Ver vídeo

Other areas of the road Straight

Section of road that does not change direction.

Bend

Section of road that changes direction to the right or to the left.

In some bends you cannot see the full width of the road. In that case it is said to be a bend with reduced visibility.

[Watch video]

Gradient

It is the slope of the road. A change of gradient means that a section of the road changes its slope.

cambia de inclinación.

There are changes of gradient with reduced visibility where the road is very steep and you cannot see the vehicles in front of you or coming from the opposite direction.

[Watch video]

Central reservation

Space between two separate roadways where vehicles do not travel.

Lay-by

Part of the carriageway that widens so that vehicles that need it can stop without affecting the rest of the vehicles travelling on that carriageway.

Emergency braking area

Part of the road prepared for vehicles with brake failure to stop.

When entering that area, the vehicle stops even if the brakes do not respond.

Junction

Place where several roads, streets or tracks cross.

Roundabout

Junction where there is a circular construction in the centre and vehicles have to drive around that construction. You cannot go through the centre.

Level crossing

Place where a road or track and the railway tracks cross.

Traffic island

Slightly raised or painted area of the carriageway used to guide traffic. They are usually placed at junctions. The parallel white lines that form the traffic island are called **zebra markings**.

Cycle track

Road prepared for cycles to travel.

There are several types of cycle track:

Cycle lane	**It is next to the carriageway. It can operate in two directions or in one direction only.**
Protected cycle lane	It is separated from the carriageway or the pavement by physical elements to better protect the people who use it.
Cycle pavement	It is marked within the pavement.
Cycle track	There is a space separating the cycle track and the road.
Cycle path	Road located in parks, gardens and woods where only pedestrians and cycles may travel.

[Watch video]()

Pedestrian zone

Part of the road reserved for pedestrians. The pavement, the promenade and the refuge are considered a pedestrian zone.

The refuge is a pedestrian zone located on the carriageway that vehicles are not allowed to enter.

For example, an area to stop between two pedestrian crossings.

Built-up area

Areas where there are buildings. That is, towns and cities.

On the roads entering and leaving built-up areas there are signs with their name written on them.

Entrada

Salida

Ver vídeo

Direction and traffic flow

Direction

A straight or curved line that connects two places.

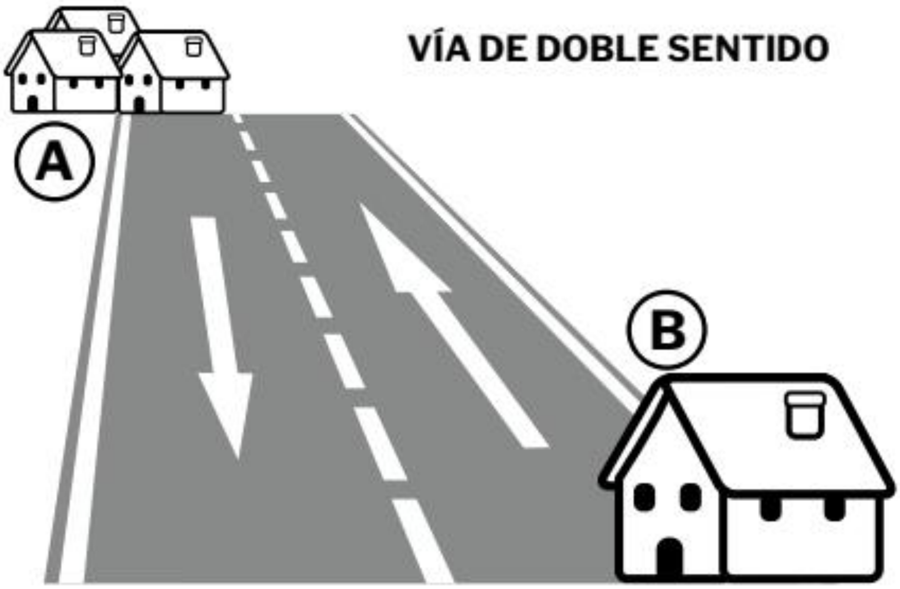
Traffic flow

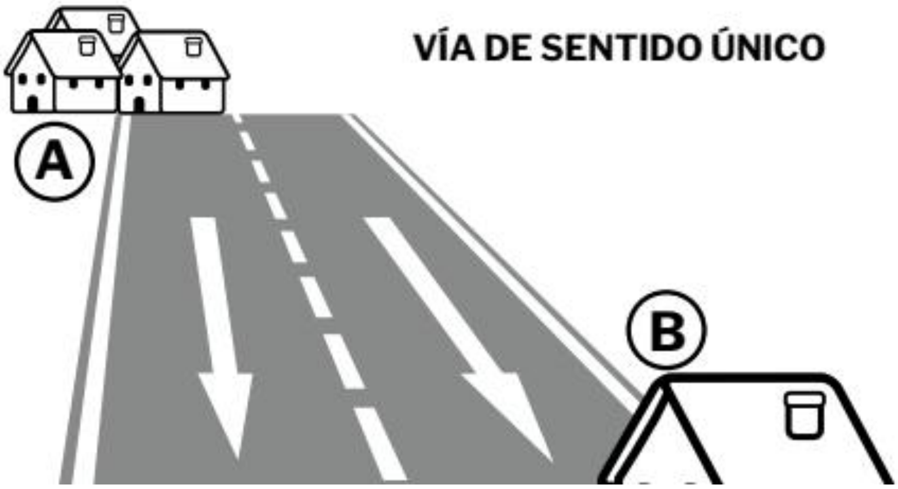
The two possibilities, outbound and return, that can be used to travel in the same direction.

For example, two cars travelling on the same road, one in the outbound lane and the other in the return lane, are travelling in the same direction, but in a different traffic flow.

There are one-way roads and others where you can drive in both directions, in different lanes.

Topic 9. The road





Types of road

Depending on where it is

Urban road	**Streets and tracks within the built-up area.**
Interurban road	Roads and tracks outside the built-up area.
Through road	Road that passes through a built-up area.

Depending on its characteristics

Motorway

It is a road where only motor vehicles may drive and it must meet the following characteristics:

- ■ You cannot enter it from any land or property next to the motorway.
- ■ You can only enter via prepared and authorised access points.
- ■ No railway line, tramway or path, nor any other road, crosses it.
- ■ It has separate carriageways so that vehicles travel in one direction or the other.

Motorways can be toll roads. That is, you have to pay to drive on them.

Dual carriageway

A road that has the same characteristics as a motorway, with two main differences:

- ■ You can enter them from some properties next to the dual carriageway.
- ■ It has more access roads.
- ■ You do not have to pay to drive on it.

Road for motor vehicles

A road where only motor vehicles may drive.

It has a single carriageway. As on motorways, you cannot enter it from any land or property next to it.

It is signed with signs S-3 and S-4.

Conventional road

These are all roads that do not meet the characteristics of motorways, dual carriageways and roads for motor vehicles.

Service road or service lane

It is a road that runs parallel to the main road and connects this road with houses, petrol stations and other properties.

Colours that indicate the condition of the road

White	**You can drive normally.**
Green	You cannot reach the maximum speed allowed on that road.
Yellow	There are stops and queues of vehicles or traffic is slow on some sections.
Red	There are too many vehicles and there are many stops and queues.
Black	The road is closed and you cannot drive.

Lanes

Where must vehicles drive?

They must drive on the right and as close as possible to the edge of the carriageway, especially on bends and at crests with reduced visibility.

Ver vídeo

You must always keep free the part of the carriageway that corresponds to the opposite direction.

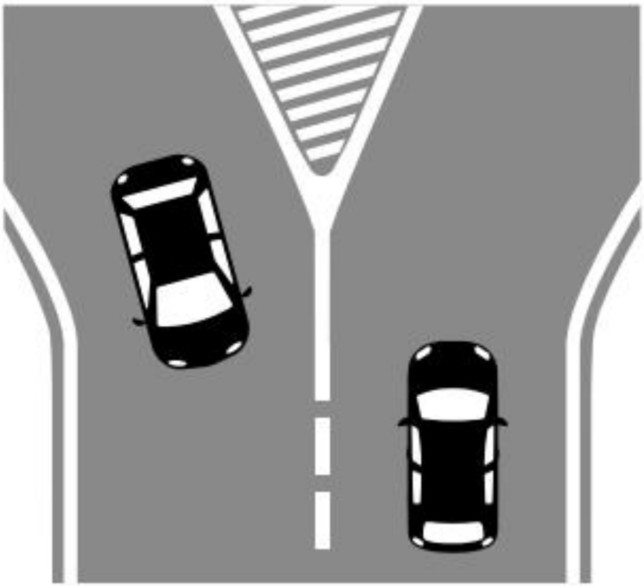
On roads with two carriageways, vehicles must use the carriageway on their right.

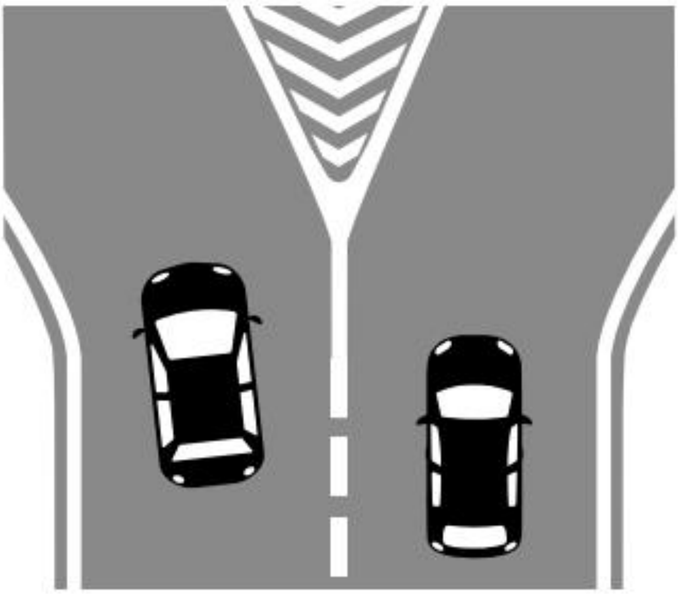
On roads with three carriageways, the middle one may have one or two directions and the side ones a single direction.

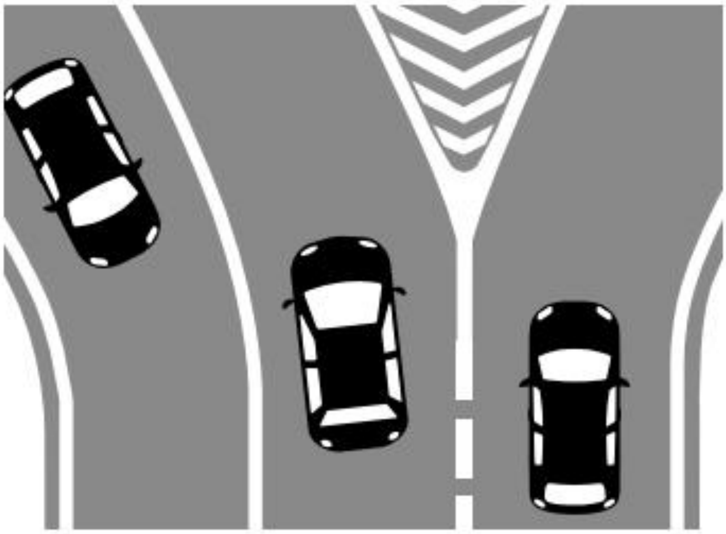
[Watch video]

Topic 9. The road

When you find refuges or traffic islands on the road, you must drive on the right-hand side of the refuge or traffic island. If the road is one-way you can drive on either side of the refuge or traffic island.







Motor vehicles normally must not drive on the hard shoulder, except in the event of a breakdown or some other unforeseen event.

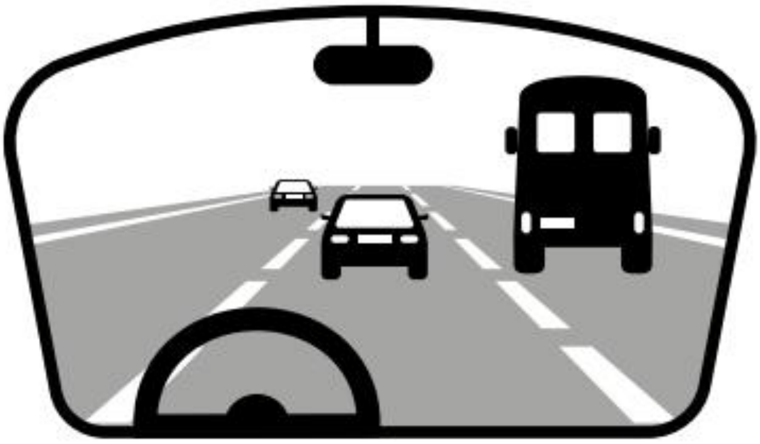
Ver vídeo

Rules for using lanes

General rules

Type of road	Where must you drive?
Two-way with two lanes	On the right.
Two-way with three lanes	On the right. Never use the left lane. The centre lane is only used to overtake and to change direction to the left.

[Watch video]



Within towns or cities

Motor vehicles and special vehicles may drive in the lane they prefer on roads and streets with two lanes going in the same direction and separated by a white line.

Ver vídeo

In these cases you must take into account that:

- ■ You should only leave that lane to change direction, park or overtake another vehicle.

- ■ You must not block the way or be an obstacle for other vehicles.

When the lanes are not separated by a white line, all drivers must drive on the right.

The rest of the vehicles, such as cycles, mopeds or vehicles for persons with reduced mobility, must always drive on the right, even if there is a separation line between lanes.

Outside towns or cities

On roads with two lanes going in the same direction, motor vehicles and special vehicles that with load can weigh more than 3,500 kilos will drive in the lane on their right.

They may use the lane on their left when the circumstances of the road or traffic advise it and provided that they do not hinder other drivers.

Ver vídeo

On roads with three or more lanes going in the same direction, some vehicles are obliged to always use the right-hand lane and are forbidden to use other lanes.

These vehicles that must drive in the right-hand lane may use the one next to it, not being allowed to use any more, and under the same conditions as the previous point. These vehicles are:

- ■ Lorries, vans and special vehicles that with load can weigh more than 3,500 kilos.
- ■ Vehicle combinations that are more than seven metres long.

Reserved lanes

Bus and taxi

For carrying out manoeuvres

High-occupancy vehicles (HOV)

Lanes reserved for certain vehicles

Some lanes are reserved for a particular type of vehicle and the rest of the vehicles cannot use them.

These lanes are:

Lane reserved for the bus

Driving in that lane is prohibited for the rest of the vehicles.

Taxis may drive in it when the word TAXI is written in the lane.

This lane will be separated from the rest of the lanes by a wide white line.

Ver vídeo

Lane for high-occupancy vehicles (HOV)

For a motor vehicle to be a high-occupancy vehicle it must meet three requirements:

- 1. It may only carry people.
- 2. It must not carry more than 3,500 kilos.
- 3. The number of people travelling in the vehicle is the one indicated on the HOV lane signs.

The following vehicles may also drive in this lane:

- ■ Motorcycles, passenger cars or adaptable mixed-use vehicles when they meet the three requirements needed for HOV motor vehicles (see previous paragraph).
- ■ Vehicles for persons with disabilities even if only the driver is travelling.
- ■ Buses (that weigh more than 3500 kilos).
- ■ Vehicles providing emergency services.
- ■ Vehicles carrying out road works.

Lanes reserved for some manoeuvres

Manoeuvre. Movement or action that is done when driving a vehicle.

[Watch video]

Entry lane (acceleration)	For vehicles that want to enter a road.
Exit lane (deceleration)	For vehicles that want to leave a road. You must take a series of precautions when entering this lane: ■ Move into the lane closest to the exit lane. ■ Enter the exit lane as soon as possible. ■ Drive more slowly within this lane. ■ Pay attention to the conditions of the new road you are joining. For example, when changing from a dual carriageway to another road where you must drive more slowly.

Special cases for using lanes

Reversible

In the opposite direction to the usual one

Additional

Reversible lanes

They are lanes where you can drive in one direction or the other, depending on the circumstances. They are marked with broken white lines on both sides of the lane.

All drivers must use dipped headlights when driving in this lane, by day and by night.

[Watch video]

Lanes that go in the opposite direction to the usual one

They can be put in place when there are many vehicles that want to travel in the same direction on the road.

This helps to reduce traffic jams and vehicles can flow better.

Only motorcycles and cars may use these lanes.

How must you drive in these lanes?

- ■ With dipped headlights on, both by day and by night.
- ■ At a speed between 60 and 80 kilometres per hour.
- ■ Without changing into other lanes. Not even to overtake.

Vehicles that are in the lane next to it, in the normal direction of the road, must take the same precautions.

Lanes in the opposite direction to the normal one can also be put in place when roadworks are being carried out.

In that case, all vehicles authorised to travel on a road with roadworks may use that lane.

Additional lanes

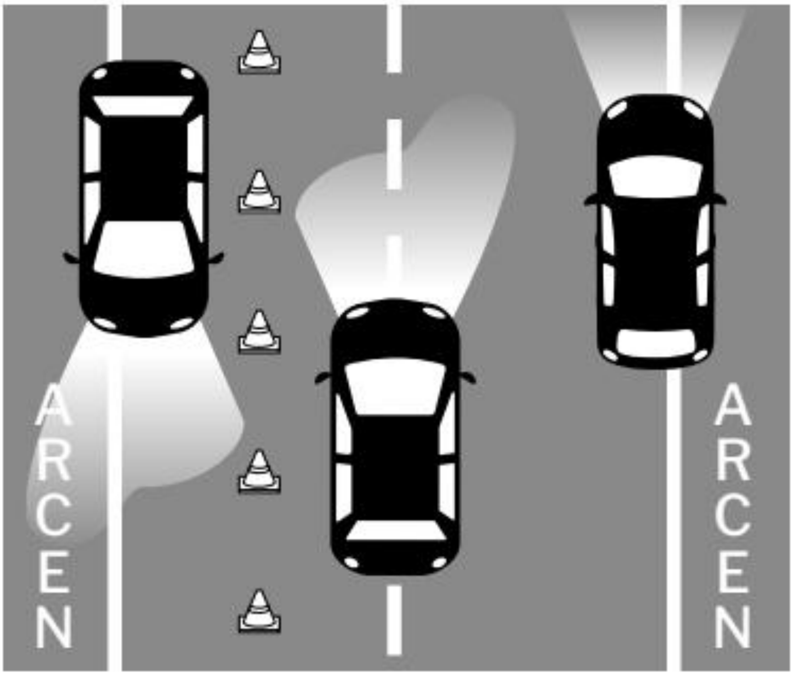
On carriageways with two directions of traffic, using the hard shoulders, they are sometimes put in place when there are many vehicles on the same road so that there is one more lane to drive in.

They are marked with beaconing signs.

How must you drive in these lanes?

- ■ Carefully, so as not to move or drive over the beaconing signs.
- ■ At a speed between 60 and 80 kilometres per hour.
    - Or more slowly if the signs indicate it.
- ■ With dipped headlights on, both by day and by night.

■ Without changing into other lanes. Not even to overtake.



The hard shoulder

If there is no road or part of it intended for them to travel on, the following vehicles must travel on the hard shoulder:

- ■ Cycles.
- ■ Vehicles following cyclists.
- ■ Mopeds.
- ■ Animal-drawn vehicles and ridden animals.
- ■ Special vehicles that, when loaded, do not weigh more than 3,500 kilos.
- ■ Vehicles for people with difficulty moving.

When the road has no hard shoulder or it is not possible to travel on it, these vehicles may use only the essential part of the lane.

Cyclists may leave the hard shoulder and travel on the right-hand side of the lane on downhill slopes with bends.

Ver vídeo

All vehicles travelling on the hard shoulder must do so in single file, one behind the other.

Except cyclists, who may ride two abreast in the same line.

But on stretches with no visibility, and when there is heavy traffic, they must also ride in single file, one behind the other.

Vehicles required to travel on the hard shoulder may not overtake other vehicles when the overtaking:

■ Lasts more than 15 seconds.

■ Needs a distance greater than 200 metres to overtake.

Cyclists may overtake other vehicles without complying with these two rules.

Driving on motorways and dual carriageways

The following may not travel on motorways or dual carriageways:

- ■ Pedestrians.
- ■ Animals.
- ■ Bicycles.
- ■ Mopeds.
- ■ Vehicles for people with reduced mobility.
- ■ Personal mobility vehicles.

Cyclists who are over 14 years old may travel on the hard shoulder of the dual carriageway, unless there is a sign that prohibits it.

On toll motorways you must go through the booths set up to collect the ticket to enter the motorway or to pay when exiting.

These booths have a traffic light or green arrow when they are open and a traffic light or red cross when they are closed.

Ver vídeo

Emergencies on the motorway and dual carriageway

Vehicles that have to travel more slowly on the motorway or dual carriageway due to a breakdown must leave this road at the first exit they come to.

A vehicle that has to stop due to an emergency must do so on the hard shoulder or on the central reservation.

To ask for help you can use the nearest emergency telephone. People travelling in the broken-down or crashed vehicle must not walk on the road.

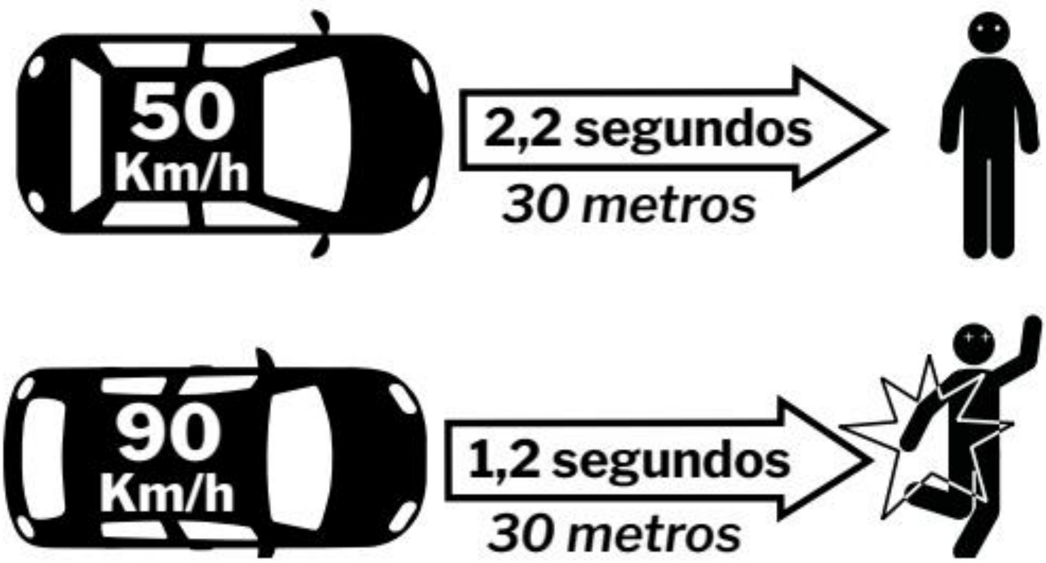
Topic 9. The road

When a vehicle has an accident or a breakdown, it must be removed from the road by another vehicle that is authorised to do so. For example, a tow truck.

Contents

Types of speed

It is very important to drive at the appropriate speed to avoid dangers and traffic accidents.



There are different types of speed when driving:

Maximum speed

Minimum speed

Inappropriate speed Appropriate speed

Maximum speed

Maximum permitted speed that a vehicle may reach on the road it is travelling on. When the vehicle goes faster than the maximum permitted speed, it is speeding.

For example, it is speeding to travel at a speed of 100 kilometres per hour on a road where the maximum permitted speed is 90 kilometres per hour.

Minimum speed

Minimum speed at which a vehicle must travel on the road it is travelling on. When a vehicle travels at a speed lower than the permitted one, it is travelling at an abnormally reduced speed.

For example, it is an abnormally reduced speed to drive at 40 kilometres per hour on a motorway where the minimum permitted speed is 60 kilometres per hour.

Inappropriate speed

Speed that is within the permitted limits but is not appropriate due to the driver's conditions, the weather, the condition of the road, or the circumstances of the vehicle.

For example, driving at a speed of 70 kilometres per hour on a road where there are patches of ice and the vehicle may skid.

That speed would be appropriate in normal circumstances. But in that case it is an excessive speed because there is ice on the road.

Driving at an inappropriate or excessive speed is one of the main causes of traffic accidents.

Appropriate speed

Speed that is within the permitted limits and that is appropriate for the weather conditions, the road, the circumstances of the vehicle and the driver's condition.

Appropriate speed makes it easier to control the vehicle in unexpected situations.

People are more likely to die in a traffic accident when the vehicle is travelling at an excessive speed than when it is travelling at an appropriate speed.

What must you take into account to travel at an appropriate speed?

You must always respect the speed limits.

But, in addition, you must take into account the circumstances that occur at each moment.

These circumstances are:

■ Your physical and psychological condition. For example, if you are very tired.

- ■ The characteristics of the vehicle and the load you are carrying. It is better to drive more slowly when you are carrying a lot of weight in the vehicle.
- ■ The condition of the road. You must go more slowly if the road has speed humps or is poorly surfaced.
- ■ The traffic situation. You must drive more slowly when there is heavy traffic.
- ■ Weather conditions. You must be more careful when it rains, snows, there is fog or there is ice on the road.

Situations in which you must drive at low speed

You must drive slowly and even stop the vehicle, in the following cases:

■ When there are pedestrians on the road or they may cross it. Especially when there are children, older people, people who cannot see or with another type of physical disability.

- ■ Near routes reserved for cyclists and in all places where cyclists travel.
- ■ At pedestrian crossings where there is no traffic light or traffic officer.

■ Near markets, schools and other places where there may be children.

Ver vídeo

■ On roads or tracks where there are animals or they may appear.

■ On stretches where there are buildings right next to the road. People or animals may come out of those buildings.

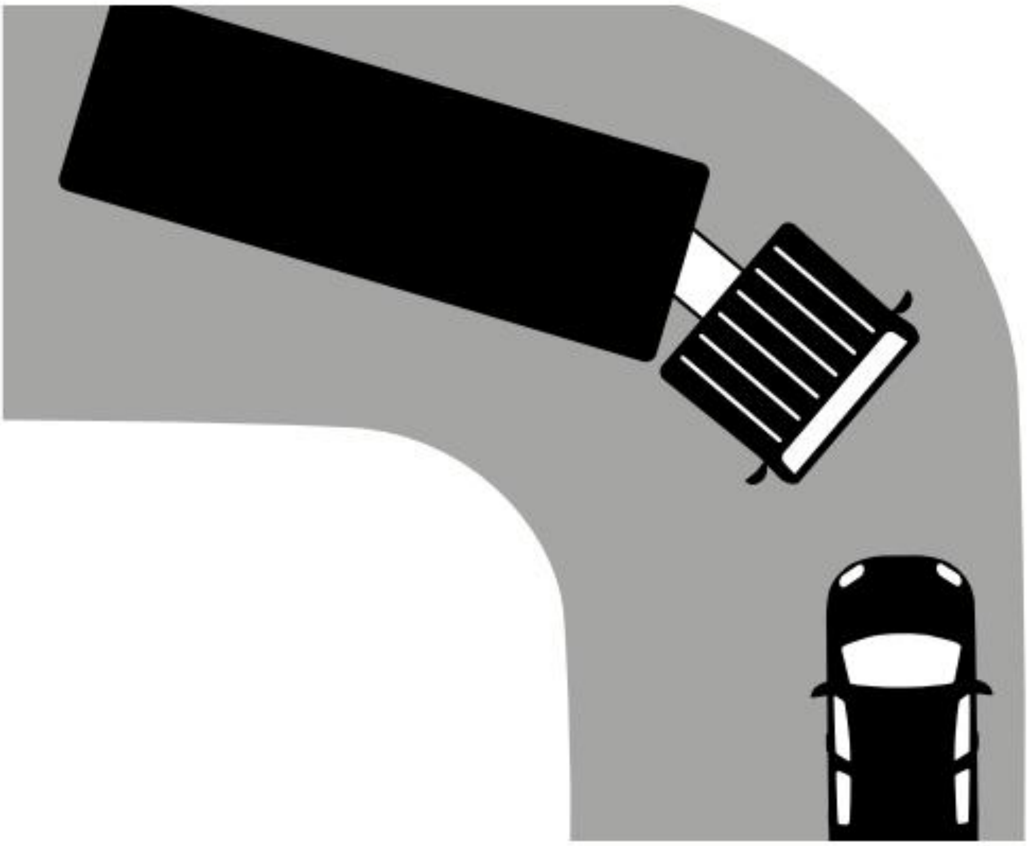
■ When approaching a bus that is stopped. Especially if it is a bus that carries children.

- ■ When approaching any vehicle stopped on the road, emergency service vehicles and bicycles travelling in your lane or on the hard shoulder.
- ■ When the road is slippery or there is water, gravel or other materials on it.

■ When approaching level crossings, roundabouts or junctions where you do not have priority. In these cases, the maximum speed must be 50 kilometres per hour.

Ver vídeo

- ■ When approaching narrow places or places where visibility is poor.
- ■ When passing an oncoming vehicle when the circumstances do not allow it to be done very safely. For example, when you meet a lorry on a bend on a narrow road.



- ■ When you are dazzled by the lights of another vehicle.
- ■ When there is thick fog, rain, snow or smoke.

Ver vídeo

General speed limits

What is it?

Speed limit that each type of vehicle must comply with on each road.

There are general maximum and minimum speeds.

Speed limits outside towns and cities Vehicle type

■ **Cars.**
■ Motorcycles.
■ Three-wheeled vehicles.
■ Motor caravans that can carry loads less than 3,500 kilos.
■ Pick up.

Motorway **and dual carriageway**		**Roads** **120** **100** **120** **90** **100**		**Tracks** **90** **80** **70** **80** **70** **50**	
Speed 80 70 maximum	Speed 50 minimum	Speed 45 40 maximum	Speed 45 30 120 100 minimum	Speed 40 30 25 20 90 80 maximum	Speed 25 20 70 60 minimum
25 20120 120 30 25 45 45	100 60 90 100 15 40 45 30 40 35 45 40 40	80 90 70 80 45 40 On some 25 30 20 25 roads the limit 30 35 25 30 may be 100.	45 35 40 50 70 45 50 40 20 45 60 40 60 15 25 15	35 30 30 25 35 30	30 25 25 15 20 25

Type of vehicle

- ■ Buses.
- ■ Car-derived vehicles.
- ■ Adaptable mixed vehicles.

Motorway and dual carriageway		**Roads 120 100 120 100 90**		**Tracks 90 80 70 80 70 50**	
Speed 80 70 maximum	Speed 50 minimum	Speed 45 40 maximum	Speed 45 120 30 100 minimum	Speed 40 30 25 90 20 80 maximum	Speed 25 20 70 60 minimum
25 20120 100	90 60 80 100	70 90 50 80 45 40	45 35 40 70 45 50 40	35 30 30 25	30 25 25 15 20

Type of vehicle

- ■ Lorries.
- ■ Tractor units.
- ■ Vans.
- ■ Motor caravans that can carry loads over 3,500 kilos.
- ■ Articulated vehicles.
- ■ Vehicles with a trailer.

Motorway **and dual carriageway**		**Roads** **120** **100** **120** **100** **90**		**Tracks** **90** **80** **70** **50** **80** **70** **50**	
Speed 80 70 maximum	Speed 50 minimum	Speed 45 45 40 maximum	Speed 40 120 30 100 minimum	Speed 30 25 25 90 20 80 maximum	Speed 20 70 60 60 minimum
25 12020 90 80	100 60 70 90	50 80 70 45 45 40	45 35 40 50 40	35 30 30 30 25	25 15 25 15 20

Type of vehicle

- 40 15 40 15 ■ Three-wheeled vehicles that are not motorcycles.
    - ■ Heavy quadricycles.
    - ■ Special vehicles that can reach 60 kilometres per hour on level ground.

Motorway **and dual carriageway**		**Roads** **120** **100** **120** **100**	**90** **90** **80**	**Tracks** **80** **70** **70**	**50** **50**
Speed 80 70 maximum	Speed 50 minimum	Speed 45 40 45 40 maximum	Speed 120 30 100 30 minimum	Speed 25 90 20 80 25 20 maximum	Speed 70 60 60 minimum
25 20 120 70 100 50	90 60 80	70 50 45 40 45 40	45 35 40 35 30	30 30 25 25	25 15 15 20

Type of vehicle

- ■ Special vehicles without brake lights.
- ■ Special vehicles towing a trailer.

- ■ Motor cultivators.

Motorway and dual carriageway	**Roads**	**Tracks**
120 100 90	Maximum speed 80 120 70 100 50 90 and minimum	Maximum speed 80 70 50 and minimum
Cannot 45 40 30 use	25 45 20 40 30 60	25 20 60

45 40 15 35 Types of vehicle

■ Other special vehicles

Motorway and dual carriageway	**Roads**	**Tracks**
120	Maximum speed 120 100 100 90 80 and minimum	Maximum speed 90 80 70 70 50 and minimum
Cannot 45 use	45 40 40 30 25	30 25 20 20 60

45 40 15 Types of vehicle

■ Cycles

Motorway and dual carriageway	Roads	Tracks
Maximum speed 90 120 100	120 100 Maximum speed 80 70 50 90 120 100	90 80 70 Maximum speed 80 70 50
45 40 30 on a dual carriageway. On a motorway they cannot 35 45 40 use.	45 40 25 45 20 40 30 60 30 25 15 35 45 40 45 40	30 25 20 25 20 60 35 30 25 30 25 15

Bicycles may exceed these speeds if circumstances allow.

Type of vehicle

- ■ Two- and three-wheeled mopeds.
- ■ Light quadricycles.
- ■ Vehicles for people with reduced mobility.

Motorway and dual carriageway	**Roads**	**Tracks**
	120 100 Maximum speed 120 100 90	90 80 70 Maximum speed 80 70 50
Cannot use	45 40 45 40 30	30 25 20 25 20 60

For vehicles that carry out school transport with children or that carry dangerous goods, the maximum speed limit is 10 kilometres less than for the other vehicles.

For example, the speed limit on a road for a bus is 90 kilometres per hour. But for a bus that takes children to school, the speed limit is 80 kilometres per hour.

Maximum speed limit within towns and cities

Type of vehicle

- All vehicles in general

100 90 80	**Streets without kerbs, where the carriageway and the pavement are 70 50 120 100 at the same level**	**Streets with a single lane in each direction 90 80 70**	**Streets with several lanes in each direction 50**
40 30 25	20 45 120 40 100 60	30 90 25 80 20 70	50 60

45 40 15 45 40 15 45 Type of vehicle

- 45 40 15 35 30 25 ■ Vehicles carrying dangerous goods.
- ■ Special vehicles that cannot reach a speed of more than 60 kilometres per hour.

100 90 80	**Streets without kerbs, where the carriageway and the pavement are 70 50 120 100 at the same level**	**Streets with a single lane in each direction 90 80 70 120**	**Streets with several lanes in each direction 50 100 90 80**
40 30 25	20 45 40 60	30 25 20 45	40 30 25 60

Type of vehicle

- ■ Two- or three-wheeled mopeds.
- ■ Light quadricycles.
- ■ Vehicles for people with reduced mobility.
- ■ Cycles.

100 90 80	**Streets without kerbs, where the carriageway and the pavement are 70 50 120 100 at the same height**	**Streets with one lane in each direction 90 80 70**	**Streets with several lanes in each direction 50 120 90**
40 30 25	20 45 40 60	30 25 20	45 40 60

45 40 15 45 40 15 Type of vehicle

- ■ Personal mobility vehicles.
- ■ Special vehicles with a trailer or semi-trailer.

- ■ Vehicles without brake lights.

100 90 80	Streets without kerbs, where the carriageway and the pavement are 70 120 50 100 90 at the same height	Streets with one lane in each direction 80 120 70 100 50 90	Streets with several lanes in each direction 80 70 50
40 30 25	20 45 40 30 60	25 45 20 40 30 60	25 20 60

The maximum speed for all vehicles on motorways and dual carriageways that are within a town or city is 80 kilometres per hour, if it is not signposted otherwise.

Minimum speed limits inside and outside towns and cities

- ■ On motorways and dual carriageways the minimum permitted speed is 60 kilometres per hour.
- ■ On the rest of the roads the minimum permitted speed depends on each vehicle. For example, on a road where the maximum permitted speed for a car is 90 kilometres per hour, the minimum permitted speed will be 45 kilometres per hour.

It is forbidden to drive below that speed, even if there are no other vehicles on the road.

The only cases in which you may drive more slowly than the minimum permitted speed are:

- ■ When there is heavy traffic, the vehicle has a breakdown, or the road is in poor condition.
- ■ When the vehicle is a cycle, is being pulled by animals, or is a special vehicle.
- ■ In the case of vehicles that escort other vehicles. For example, vehicles that escort cyclists in a competition.

If your vehicle cannot reach the minimum speed and there is a risk of an accident, you must switch on the hazard warning lights. For example, if your vehicle has a breakdown and you have to drive more slowly than permitted.

Why are speed limits necessary?

Speed limits are set so that all vehicles can travel safely and in an easy and comfortable way.

One of the conditions taken into account when setting the speed is the type of road and its conditions.

That is, the maximum speed at which you can drive safely on that road.

Within towns and cities you must drive at less than 50 kilometres per hour.

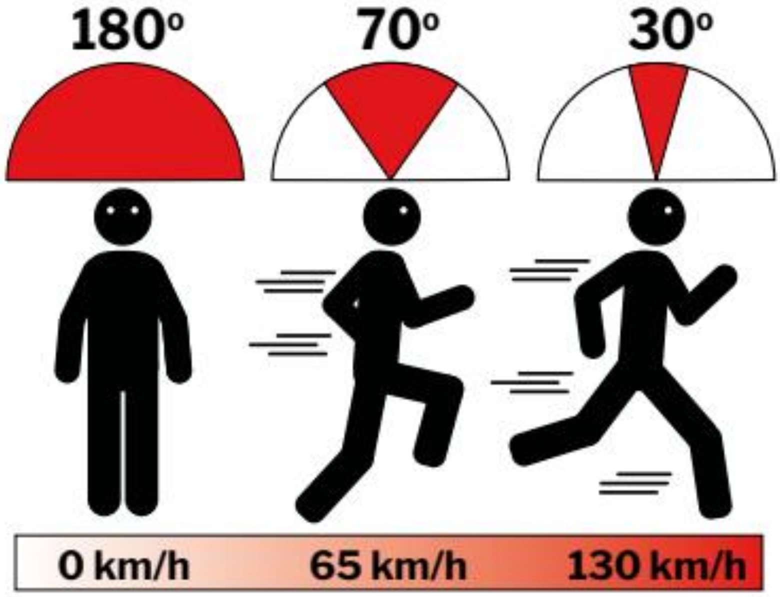
If you run over a pedestrian, they will have a better chance of surviving if the vehicle is travelling at a low speed.

On roads that are not a motorway or dual carriageway you must not drive at more than 90 kilometres per hour so that accidents are less serious.

On a motorway and dual carriageway there is a better chance of surviving an accident when the vehicle is travelling at less than 120 kilometres per hour.

Things that can happen if you drive very fast

- ■ It is harder to react to unexpected events. This means many mistakes are made that can cost people their lives.
- ■ You have less ability to see what is happening at the sides. This effect is called tunnel vision because you only see what is in front of you, as if you were going through a tunnel.



- ■ Driving fast for a long time can make you feel fatigue and aggression because you drive with more tension.
- ■ Driving very fast on a road in good condition can make you think you are going at a lower speed than you really are.

It is forbidden to hold speed competitions on any road, unless the authorities authorise them and take the necessary measures.

A person who takes part in races that are not authorised will lose points on their driving licence.

Types of distance

Reaction distance

Braking distance

Stopping distance

Lateral separation

Safety distance

Reaction distance

The distance you travel with the vehicle from when you detect an unexpected event, such as an obstacle, a sign or a noise, until you can react to the unexpected event.

For example, the time that passes from when you see a red traffic light until you press the brake.

A person's normal reaction time to an unexpected event is usually 0.75 seconds, almost one second. Although this depends on their reflexes, their physical and psychological state, and the environment they are in.

The faster a vehicle is travelling, the less reaction distance it will have because it will cover more distance in less time. Therefore, it will reach the danger sooner.

Braking distance

The distance the vehicle travels from when you press the brake until it stops completely.

This distance can change for the following reasons:

- ■ Speed. The faster the vehicle is travelling, the more space it will need to brake.
- ■ The load. A heavily loaded vehicle takes longer to stop.
- ■ Technical condition of the vehicle. Condition of its brakes and other parts of the vehicle, such as the tyres.
- ■ The weather. On a wet surface the vehicle may need a longer braking distance.
- ■ The condition of the road.
- ■ Characteristics of the driver. For example, age, physical or psychological state.

Stopping distance

The distance you travel with the vehicle from when you detect an obstacle until you stop the vehicle completely.

For example, the time that passes from when you see a red traffic light until you stop the vehicle completely.

Stopping distance is the sum of reaction distance and braking distance.

Lateral separation

The separation distance needed between two vehicles that pass each other or that are travelling side by side. There must always be enough separation between them to avoid any danger.

You must keep a greater lateral separation distance from other vehicles when:

- ■ You are driving fast.
- ■ The road is in poor condition.
- ■ Many vehicles pass yours.
- ■ There is rain, snow, fog, wind or smoke.

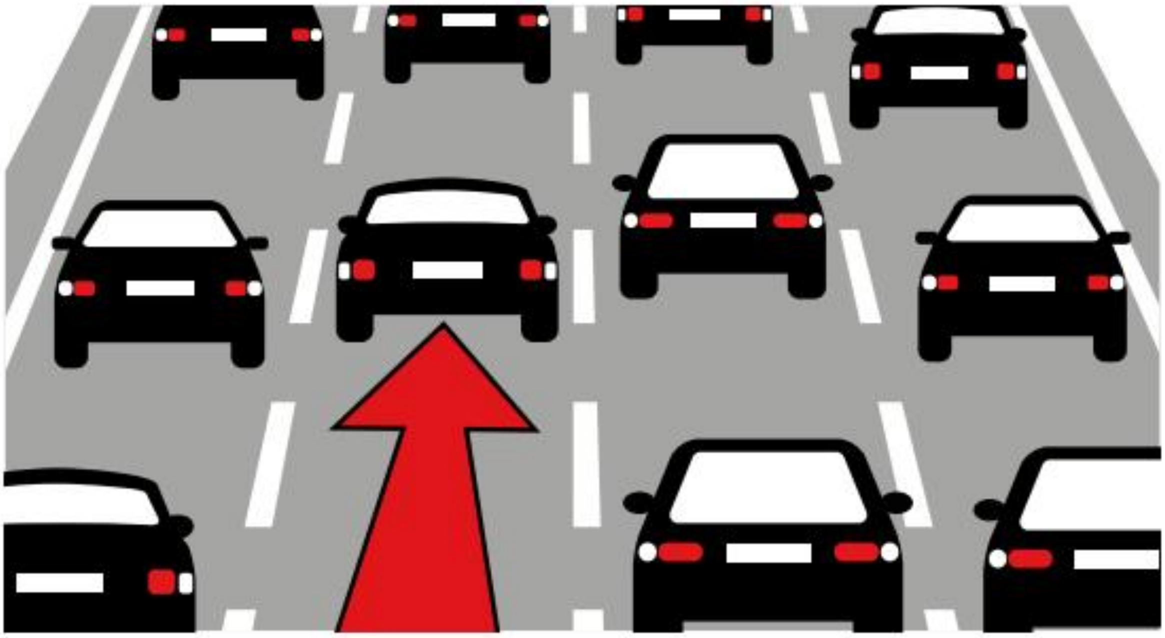
Ver vídeo

Safety distance

The minimum distance you must leave from the vehicle in front so you do not crash in the event of sudden and unexpected braking.

You must leave a greater safety distance from the driver in front when:

- ■ You increase speed.
- ■ The road is hard to see.
- ■ The vehicle does not grip the road well.
- ■ You are not in good physical or psychological condition.



You must keep a distance from other drivers that allows you to stop in the event of sudden braking in the following cases:

- ■ Within a town or city.
- ■ In areas where overtaking is forbidden.
- ■ Where there is more than one lane in the same direction.
- ■ When you cannot overtake because there are many vehicles.
- ■ When another vehicle signals that it is going to overtake.

In places where you are allowed to overtake other vehicles, you must leave enough distance to overtake or to allow another vehicle to overtake you comfortably.

Vehicles that can carry more than 3,500 kilos and combinations of vehicles that are more than 10 metres long must follow these rules and also leave a minimum separation of 50 metres from the rest of the vehicles.

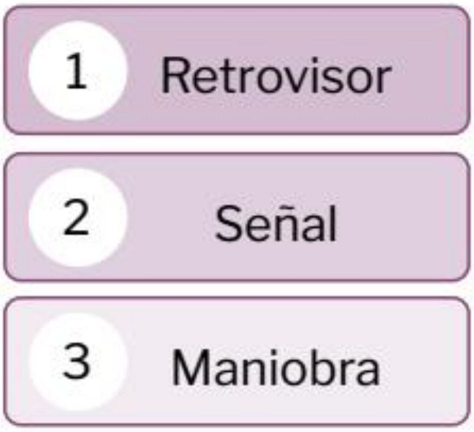
Bicycles are the only vehicles that may travel without keeping the safety distance between cyclist and cyclist.

Contents

R.S.M. safety rule

What is it?

The set of rules and steps you must follow when you carry out any manoeuvre with the vehicle:



This rule is divided into three steps.

Steps of the R.S.M. safety rule

Observe the road Mirror Warn of the manoeuvre Signal

Carry out the manoeuvre

Observe the road

It means looking carefully at the traffic and the road directly, and by using the rear-view mirrors, before carrying out the manoeuvre.

This way you will make sure you can make the movement at that moment.

Warn of the manoeuvre

After checking that there is no danger in carrying out that manoeuvre, you must warn the other drivers of what you are going to do.

You can warn them with the vehicle's lights or with your arm.

The signals you make with your arm are more valid than those you make with the lights, as long as you do them correctly and other drivers can see them.

When you signal with the vehicle's lights, these lights must be on for the whole time the manoeuvre lasts and you must switch them off the moment you finish it.

When you signal with your arm, you must make the signal just before starting the manoeuvre, with enough time for other drivers to see it.

How must you indicate the manoeuvre with your arm?

Manoeuvre	Arm movement
Lane change, change of direction or U-turn	To move the vehicle to the left: arm horizontal with the hand extended downwards. To move the vehicle to the right: arm bent upwards with the hand extended also upwards.
Reversing	Arm extended horizontally with the palm of the hand facing backwards.
Braking	Arm movements up and down with short and quick movements.

How must you indicate the manoeuvre with the lights?

Manoeuvre	Lights
Lane change, change of direction or U-turn	Switch on the direction indicator on the side you are going to move to.
Reversing	Switch on the reversing light.
Braking	Switch on the brake lights several times.

Doing the manoeuvre

After observing and signalling, you can now do the manoeuvre. You must do it correctly, at the right speed, and without putting other vehicles or pedestrians in danger.

Safety rule when joining a road

Ver vídeo

It is very important to follow the steps set out by the R.S.M. safety rule when joining a road with the vehicle.

You must observe the road, always make sure that joining that road does not create a danger for other drivers, and warn of your manoeuvre with your arm or the lights.

When doing the manoeuvre you have to:

- ■ Give way to other vehicles without causing them danger.
- ■ Not be an obstacle for vehicles approaching you.
- ■ Travel at the right speed.

When you have to give way to another vehicle while you are in the acceleration lane to join a road, stop at the beginning of the lane until the vehicle that is already on the road passes by.

Ver vídeo

Then join the lane that applies to you, adapting to the speed of the other vehicles.

All drivers travelling on a road have the obligation to allow other vehicles to join that road and, if they can, they must make the joining manoeuvre easier for them.

Above all, for large vehicles carrying many people and that are at a marked stop. For example, a bus that is at its stop picking up passengers and must rejoin the road.

To make it easier for these vehicles to join, vehicles that are already travelling must:

- ■ Move to one side to leave them more space, when possible.
- ■ Reduce speed and even stop to let the vehicle leave the marked stop, when this happens within a town or city.

Precautions when changing lanes

Ver vídeo

To change lanes safely, you must take the following precautions:

- ■ Start the lane change at a sufficient distance from other vehicles or any other obstacle.
- ■ Do the manoeuvre little by little, without sudden movements.

■ Do not hinder vehicles travelling in that lane or cut in front of them. They have priority because they were already in that lane.

Ver vídeo

Overtaking other vehicles

Overtaking is the manoeuvre that consists of passing other vehicles that are travelling more slowly.

On which side do vehicles overtake?

You overtake on the left side of the vehicle you want to overtake in prohibited areas.

There are some exceptions in which you can overtake on the right side.

- ■ To overtake a tram that is travelling in the central area of a two-way road.
- ■ When the driver you want to overtake

is clearly indicating that they want to change direction to the left or stop on that side.

Ver vídeo

You can also overtake on the right within a town or city when the carriageway has at least two lanes going in the same direction and they are separated by a white line painted on the road.

There are some situations that are not considered overtaking, even if you pass the other vehicle. These situations are allowed and are:

- ■ Roads with traffic jams, full of vehicles. Drivers in one lane move faster than those in another lane and their speed depends on the movement of the vehicles in front. In these situations it is forbidden to change lanes to overtake.
- ■ Travelling faster in the entry and exit lanes to the road than the vehicles that are already on it.

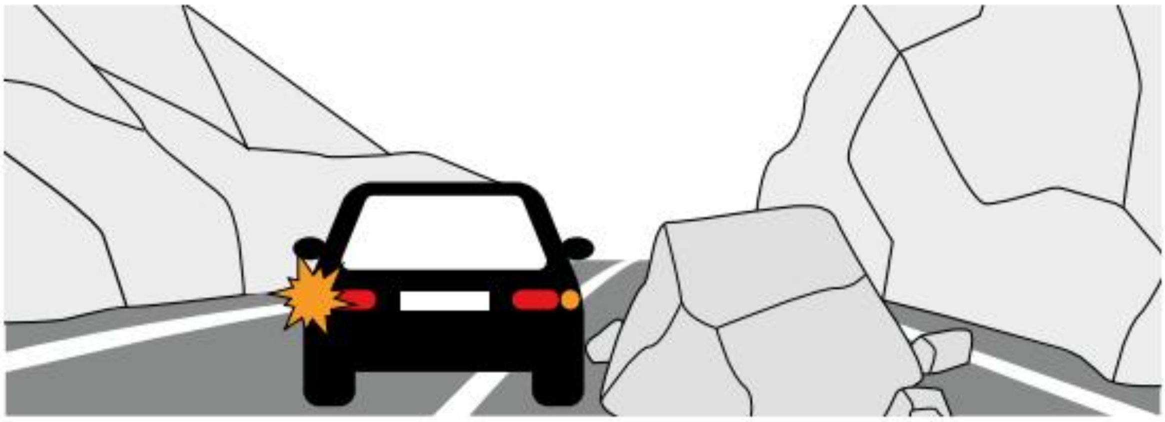
- ■ Vehicles that travel faster in lanes that are reserved only for them. For example, a bus that goes in the lane reserved for that vehicle can travel faster than the vehicles in the lane to its left.
- ■ Cyclists travelling in a group and overtaking each other.

Watch video

■ Overtake a vehicle that is stopped on the road due to a breakdown or accident.

Ver vídeo

■ Overtake an obstacle on the road, even if you have to move into the opposite lane to pass it.



Special cases of overtaking

Situation	How to act?
Two-way roads with three lanes separated by broken white lines	Overtaking is done in the centre lane as long as it is not occupied by another driver travelling in the opposite direction.
Roads with two, or more, lanes in the same direction	You can use the lane on the left to overtake. The driver can continue their journey in the lane on the left if they keep overtaking. But they must return to the one on the right if another vehicle comes that is travelling faster than them.

Steps to follow to overtake another vehicle

Preparation Checks Ask to pass (if necessary) Overtake End of overtaking

Preparation

■ Keep a suitable distance from the vehicle you want to overtake.

- ■ Assess the distance of vehicles coming in the opposite lane and the speed at which they are approaching you.
- ■ Take into account the speed limits allowed on that road.

Checks before overtaking

You must check that:

- ■ The driver you are going to overtake has or has not signalled with the lights or the arm that they are going to move to the side you are going to overtake on. If they have signalled it, you must wait for them to do their manoeuvre before overtaking them.
- ■ You can return to your lane after overtaking without risk to other vehicles.
- ■ The lane you are going to use to overtake is not occupied by another vehicle that also wants to overtake.

Ask to pass to overtake (if it is considered necessary)

- ■ Give light signals with the vehicle.
- ■ Give audible signals with the vehicle. This can only be done outside towns and cities.

Overtake

To overtake you must increase the speed of the vehicle. But you must not exceed the maximum permitted speed limit.

To overtake a moped or a cycle, within or outside built-up areas, you must:

- ■ Keep a separation of at least one and a half metres from the moped or the cycle.
- ■ Move into the lane to your left to overtake. Do not overtake in the same lane in which the moped or cycle is travelling.

On roads outside built-up areas, you must also leave a separation of at least one and a half metres in these cases:

- ■ When you are driving a two-wheeled vehicle and you want to overtake any other vehicle.
- ■ When you are driving any vehicle and you want to overtake people, animals, motorcycles, vehicles stopped on the road and vehicles that are carrying out assistance work. For example, ambulances or breakdown trucks at least one and a half metres, on interurban roads.

In the rest of the cases, you must leave enough space between your vehicle and the one you want to overtake. The space will depend on the speed and the road conditions.

You must stop overtaking if you see that another vehicle is coming in the opposite direction or that the vehicle you want to overtake suddenly accelerates.

In those cases you have to slow down and return to the lane you were driving in.

End of overtaking

When you have finished overtaking, you must switch on the appropriate lights to indicate that you are going to return to the lane you were driving in.

Then you have to return to your lane as soon as possible and without forcing other drivers to change their speed.

Obligations of the driver who is being overtaken by another vehicle

■ Allow the other driver to overtake you and make the manoeuvre easier. It is forbidden to increase your speed at that moment.

Ver vídeo

- ■ Move your vehicle to the right-hand edge of the lane without going onto the hard shoulder.
- ■ Reduce your speed if any dangerous situation arises while the other vehicle is overtaking you.
- ■ Allow the vehicle that has overtaken to return to its lane.
- ■ Drivers of very large or heavy vehicles that cannot move to the right of the lane must reduce speed and indicate to the driver behind that they can overtake.

This indication can be made with the arm extended and moving the palm of the hand backwards and forwards.

It can also be made by switching on the vehicle’s right indicator.

When is overtaking forbidden?

- ■ When you cannot see the whole road ahead clearly. Except if the lanes are marked and you do not have to enter the oncoming lane to overtake, for example:
  - ■ On bends where you cannot see well.
  - ■ When the road has crests and there is not good visibility.
  - ■ When there is fog, heavy rain, or the sun dazzles you and does not let you see well.
  - ■ Behind a vehicle that is also overtaking and does not let you see the road ahead.

- ■ Several vehicles at the same time. This can only be done when you can return to the right at any time without hindering the vehicles you have overtaken.
- ■ A vehicle that is already overtaking another, if you have to enter the oncoming lane to overtake.
- ■ When you could endanger cyclists travelling in the oncoming lane.
- ■ At pedestrian crossings, at junctions with cycle tracks, and at level crossings and near them.

At level crossings you may overtake two-wheeled vehicles that allow good visibility because they are small, as long as we warn with audible or light signals.

At pedestrian crossings you may overtake:

- ■ When you do it very slowly, so that if a pedestrian appears we can stop the vehicle.
- ■ Two-wheeled vehicles.

■ In tunnels with traffic in both directions when the vehicle you are going to overtake has only one lane going in its direction.

- ■ At junctions and near them. You may overtake at a junction when:
    - ■ it is a roundabout,
    - ■ you overtake on the right,
    - ■ you overtake a two-wheeled vehicle,
    - ■ there is a sign at the junction that gives you priority.

You may overtake on any track or road:

- ■ Pedestrians.

- ■ Bicycles.
- ■ Cycles.
- ■ Mopeds.
- ■ Animals.
- ■ Animal-drawn vehicles.

Before overtaking them, you must make sure there is no danger for them or for other drivers.

Changing direction and turning round

Changing direction

To change direction with the vehicle, you must make sure that vehicles approaching from the opposite direction are far away and are travelling at a speed that allows you to change direction without danger.

When they are very close or are coming very fast, you cannot change direction.

If the change of direction is to the left, but you cannot see well, you cannot do it either.

If there is a suitable place on the road, such as a **turning bay** or similar element, the change must be made there, but if there is a sign, you must follow what the sign indicates.

How must you change direction?

Ver vídeo

When the change of direction is to the right you must move as close as possible to the edge of the carriageway.

When the change of direction is to the left you must position yourself:

■ As close as possible to the left-hand edge of the carriageway when this carriageway is one-way.

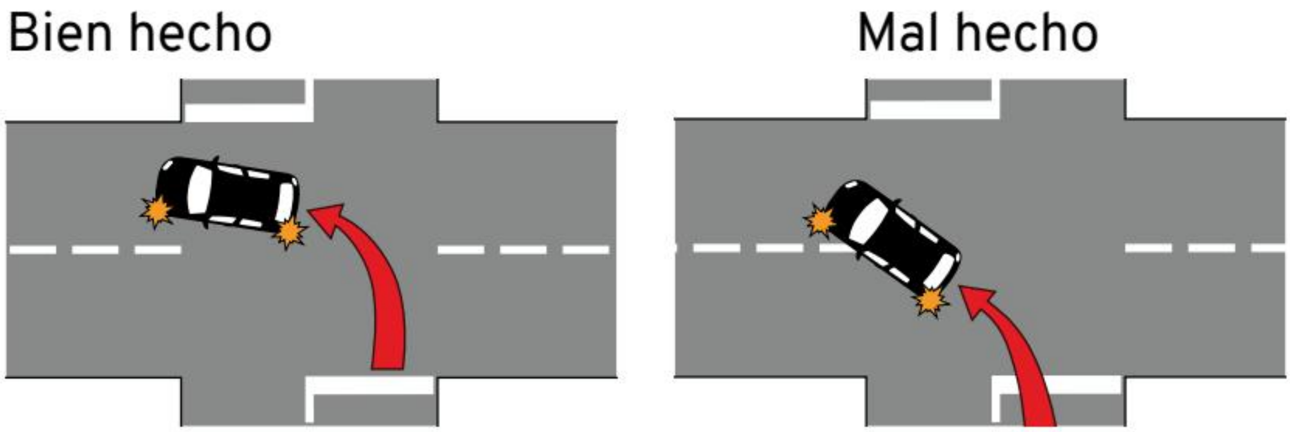
■ Next to the white line separating lanes when the carriageway is two-way. When there is no white separation line you must position yourself as close as possible to the oncoming lane, but without crossing into it.

■ In the centre lane when the road is two-way and has three lanes separated by white lines.

When making the turn to change direction, you must pass through the centre of the junction and leave it on your left.

Ver vídeo

You must not cross it diagonally.



Ver vídeo

On interurban roads, two-wheeled cycles and mopeds that want to turn left to change direction must position themselves on the right of the lane and off the carriageway if possible, and wait until it is safe to make the turn. They must also pass through the centre of the junction.

Turning round

Ver vídeo

Turning round consists of making a U-turn to continue travelling on the same road or track, but in the opposite direction.

Turning round can be done at a roundabout or **turning bay** on the road.

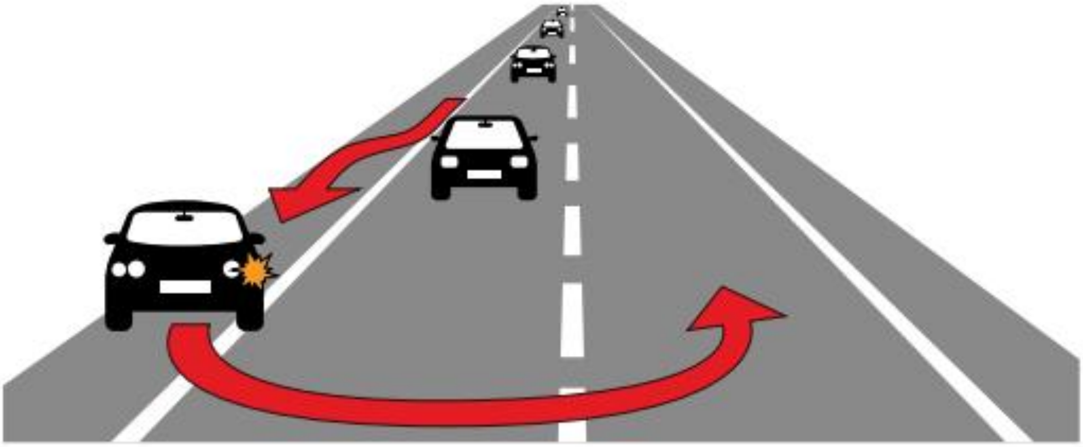
Turning bay. A half-circle-shaped diversion on the road to change direction or to turn round.

The turning-round manoeuvre must be done with a single turn of the vehicle and without using reverse gear.

Reverse gear may only be used to turn round in circumstances where nothing else can be done. For example, to get out of a street closed due to roadworks.

You must start the U-turn next to the white line on the road that separates lanes going in opposite directions.

When it is not possible to do it from there, you must position yourself close to the right-hand edge to start the turn from there.



You cannot make a U-turn if you force drivers coming behind you or coming in the opposite direction to reduce speed, or you could be a danger to them.

In those cases, you must stop on the hard shoulder on your right and wait until it is safe to make the turn to turn round.

If there is not enough hard shoulder or it is not a safe place, you must continue driving until you find a place where you can turn round.

Situations in which turning round is forbidden

- ■ Bends and crests where you cannot see well.
- ■ When there is fog or heavy rain.
- ■ At level crossings.
- ■ In tunnels.
- ■ On motorways and dual carriageways. You may do it in places prepared for it.
- ■ On one-way carriageways and tracks.

■ In all places where overtaking is forbidden, except where there is a sign indicating that you may turn round.

Reversing

Ver vídeo

It is forbidden to drive in reverse on any road or track.

You may only drive in reverse in the following cases:

■ When manoeuvring to park the vehicle.

■ When it is not possible to drive forwards or to change direction or turn round. For example, to get out of a street closed due to roadworks.

In these two cases you must not reverse more than 15 metres, and you must not enter a junction while reversing. You must drive at a very low speed while reversing.

Ver vídeo

Before you start reversing you must make sure there is no danger for other drivers and pedestrians.

You have to stop the vehicle and stop reversing in any dangerous situation. For example:

- ■ Someone gives you audible signals with their vehicle’s horn.
- ■ You notice another vehicle, a person, or an animal approaching.
- ■ On motorways and dual carriageways reversing is always forbidden.

Stopping the vehicle

Ver vídeo

It may be necessary to stop the vehicle while driving for the following reasons.

- ■ An emergency. For example, an accident, a breakdown, or one of the passengers feels unwell.
- ■ There are many vehicles on the road and traffic jams occur.
- ■ Indication from signs or traffic officers asking you to stop.

On motorways, dual carriageways, and in enclosed places or places with poor visibility, you must switch on the hazard warning lights and sidelights whenever you have to stop the vehicle.

Stopping the vehicle due to an emergency

Vehicles that have an accident or breakdown can be seen in the following situations.

Situation	What to do?
The vehicle continues to work, but cannot reach the necessary speed on that road and obstructs traffic.	If the vehicle weighs less than 3,500 kilos, drive on the right hard shoulder. If there is no hard shoulder, place the vehicle as far as possible to the right of the road. If you are on a motorway or dual carriageway, take the first exit.
The vehicle works, but you need a breakdown service	Leave the road at the first exit using the right hard shoulder.
The vehicle cannot continue driving	Park the vehicle on the right hard shoulder of the road or in the place where it hinders other drivers the least. (For example, the left hard shoulder or the central reservation).

[Watch video]

People travelling in a vehicle that cannot continue driving must get out of the vehicle and go to a safe place.

Before getting out of the vehicle, you must put on the yellow high-visibility vests that all drivers must carry in their vehicles.

If there is no safe place, you must stay inside the vehicle with the seat belt fastened.

You must switch on the hazard warning lights to show that there is a vehicle stopped on the road.

It is also compulsory to place the emergency warning light (orange light) on top of the car.

If you want, you can place the warning triangles. They are placed 50 metres from the vehicle. One in front and one behind, on the right-hand side of the road, and they must be visible from 100 metres away.

Vehicles that pick up and tow broken-down vehicles must be prepared for roadside assistance (for example, recovery vehicles). Not just any vehicle can do it.

Stopping and parking

Difference between stopping and parking

Stopping

Leaving the vehicle stationary for less than two minutes. When stopping, the driver does not get out of the vehicle. And if they get out, they stay close to it.

Parking

The vehicle stays without moving for more than two minutes. The driver can get out of the vehicle and go to another place.

Where can you stop and park?

Ver vídeo

On roads outside towns and cities, you must stop and park on the right-hand side of the road, leaving the hard shoulder free, as far as possible.

On roads and streets within towns and cities you can park on the carriageway and on the hard shoulder. When the road is two-way, the vehicle must stop or park on the right.

When the road is one-way you can do it on the right or on the left.

How should the vehicle be positioned?

As a general rule, you must stop and park the vehicle in a line parallel to the edge of the carriageway. You must always check that your vehicle allows other vehicles to use the rest of the space.

What must you do before leaving the vehicle?

Drivers of a motor vehicle or moped must:

- ■ Stop the engine and switch off the system that allows the vehicle to move.
- ■ Apply the parking brake.
- ■ Leave first gear engaged if parking on an uphill slope.
- ■ Leave reverse gear engaged if parking on a downhill slope.
- ■ Select the parking position if the vehicle is automatic.

Drivers of vehicle combinations, in addition, must leave their vehicle properly secured when they park on a slope.

Ver vídeo

They can do it in 2 ways:

1. By placing the appropriate **wheel chocks**. Stones or other objects must not be used.

Wheel chock. Wedge placed between the vehicle and the road so that the vehicle does not move.

2. By resting one of the front wheels against the kerb.

On uphill slopes, the wheel turns towards the centre of the carriageway. On downhill slopes, the wheel turns outwards.

Dangerous stops and parking

There are different situations in which it is dangerous to stop the vehicle or park it.

What are these situations?

■ When a parked vehicle does not allow other vehicles to pass.

When a vehicle is less than three metres from the opposite side of the road or from the continuous line that separates the directions. Some vehicles will not be able to pass through that space.

- ■ When a parked vehicle does not allow another vehicle that is stopped or parked to rejoin the road.
- ■ When people or animals cannot enter or leave their homes or any other place because a vehicle prevents it.
- ■ When vehicles cannot use a signposted vehicle crossing.
- ■ When a vehicle is an obstacle so that people with physical disabilities cannot enter or leave the road using the areas prepared for this.

When a vehicle stops or parks in places used to regulate traffic. For example, traffic islands.

When a vehicle prevents another vehicle from turning where the sign indicates.

Parking is considered dangerous when:

- ■ A vehicle is parked in a loading and unloading area at times when it is not allowed.
- ■ A vehicle is parked in double parking and the driver has left.
- ■ A vehicle parks at a public transport stop. For example, a bus stop.

- ■ A vehicle parks in places where there is a sign that prohibits parking.
- ■ A vehicle parks in a place reserved for emergency and security services. For example, ambulances.
- ■ A vehicle parks in the middle of the carriageway.

Where is stopping and parking prohibited? It is prohibited to stop and park in:

■ Bends and changes of gradient where visibility is poor.

- ■ Tunnels.
- ■ Level crossings, pedestrian crossings and cyclist crossings.
- ■ Lanes or parts of the road reserved for other vehicles.
- ■ Junctions or near them when you do not allow other vehicles to turn.
- ■ On tram tracks or very close to them.
- ■ Places where the parked vehicle does not allow the signs to be seen.

■ Motorways or dual carriageways. You may only stop or park in rest areas or service areas.

- ■ Lanes and areas reserved for buses, taxis or bicycles.
- ■ Areas reserved for people with disabilities.

You may stop, but not park:

- ■ In loading and unloading areas.
- ■ On pavements, promenades and other areas where pedestrians pass. For two-wheeled vehicles, provided it is regulated by the municipality and they do not obstruct pedestrians.
- ■ In front of vehicle crossings where there is a vehicle crossing sign.
- ■ In double parking.
- ■ In places where a permit is needed to park at certain times or for a certain period. You will be able to park if you have the authorisation that allows it.

Contents

Crossing level crossings and movable bridges

Crossing tunnels and underpasses

- ■ Rules for stopping the vehicle inside a tunnel
- ■ Emergencies inside a tunnel

Giving way to other vehicles

General rules

To give way to another vehicle that has priority to go, you must:

- ■ Reduce speed gradually so that the driver of the other vehicle realises that you are giving way.
- ■ Stop or drive slowly until the other driver has passed and you can drive on without danger.

Rules for giving way in specific places

Junctions without signs

Junctions with signs Roundabout

Junctions without signs

At junctions without signs you must give way to vehicles coming from your right, even if they come from a narrow road or one in poor condition.

Ver vídeo

At junctions without signs, there are some exceptions you must take into account.

They have right of way:

- ■ Vehicles running on rails before those using the road. For example, a tram has priority over a car.
- ■ Vehicles travelling on a paved road before vehicles travelling on an unpaved road.

To pave. To cover the surface of roads and streets with asphalt and other materials that allow vehicles and people to pass more safely.

- ■ Vehicles already in a roundabout before those who want to enter the roundabout.
- ■ Vehicles already on a motorway before those who want to enter that motorway.

Junctions with signs

At junctions with signs you must always follow the instructions shown by that sign.

When there are no lines showing where the entry to that junction is, you must wait and give way from the place where you can best see the junction and the vehicles approaching it.

You must never enter a junction, a pedestrian crossing or a cyclist crossing if you think your vehicle will get trapped in the middle of the junction or crossing, interrupting traffic.

For example, you must not enter a pedestrian crossing when there are vehicles just in front that will not let you pass. In that case, you must wait before the pedestrian crossing.

If you are stopped at a junction with traffic lights and your vehicle is an obstacle for other drivers, you must leave the junction by whatever way is possible, to continue along the route you wanted to take, provided that no vehicles are coming from the opposite direction.

Roundabouts

You must drive in the same way as on the rest of the roads, depending on whether they are urban with marked lanes or not, interurban, etc.

Ver vídeo

Ver vídeo

Right of way for cyclists, pedestrians and animals

Cyclists

Cyclists have right of way in the following situations:

■ When they are travelling on a cycle lane, a cyclist crossing or a well-signposted hard shoulder.

- ■ When another vehicle wants to turn right or left and there are cyclists nearby.
- ■ When cyclists are travelling in a group and one of them has already entered a junction. Other vehicles must wait until the whole group of cyclists has passed.

Pedestrians

Pedestrians have right of way in the following situations.

- ■ At pedestrian crossings, on pavements and in other pedestrian areas.
- ■ When a vehicle is going to turn to enter another road where pedestrians are crossing.
- ■ When a vehicle crosses a hard shoulder where pedestrians are walking because they have nowhere else to go because there are no pavements.
- ■ When a vehicle needs to cross a pedestrian area. For example, the pavement that a car must cross when leaving a garage.

Drivers must also give way to:

■ An organised group of people who are all going together for a purpose. For example, a group of children on a school trip.

■ People getting on or off public transport at the stop. For example, people getting off the bus, up to the nearest pedestrian area.

Animals

Animals have right of way in the following situations.

■ On drovers' roads where there is a "Domestic animals crossing" sign. And below it a sign that says drovers' road.

Drovers' road. Path created so that animals can pass along it.

- ■ When a vehicle is going to turn to enter another road where animals are crossing.
- ■ When a vehicle crosses a hard shoulder where animals are moving and they have no other place to go because there is no drove road.

Right of way for emergency service vehicles

Which vehicles are prepared to provide emergency services?

- ■ Police cars.
- ■ Fire engines.

- ■ Civil protection and rescue vehicles.
- ■ Ambulances and other medical assistance vehicles.

When these vehicles are on an emergency service, they must warn of their arrival by switching on the siren and the lights provided for that purpose.

In these cases, these vehicles have right of way on all roads (streets and roads). All other vehicles and pedestrians must give way to them.

The following vehicles also have right of way:

- ■ Maintenance teams that repair the road.
- ■ Roadside assistance vehicles when they are going to help vehicles that have broken down or had an accident.

Drivers of vehicles prepared to provide emergency services may drive faster than the permitted speed and are not obliged to obey traffic signs.

The only signs they must obey are those given by traffic officers.

They must make sure they do not endanger pedestrians or vehicles when passing through a junction or going through a red traffic light.

On the motorway and dual carriageway they may change direction, reverse direction, drive in reverse, and enter the central reservation when they can ensure there is no danger to other vehicles.

How should you act when faced with vehicles providing emergency services?

All vehicles must make it easier for them to pass as soon as they hear the siren or see the lights. They will move to the right and stop if necessary. Pedestrians will keep the road clear and wait on the pavement.

Any vehicle providing an emergency service

Ver vídeo

In some circumstances, drivers of vehicles that are not prepared to provide emergency services must request priority from other vehicles because of some circumstance.

For example, they are taking a very ill person to hospital or a woman who is about to give birth.

In these cases, the driver of the vehicle can warn of the emergency situation in the following ways:

■ Sounding the vehicle horn intermittently.

- ■ Switching on the vehicle hazard warning lights.
- ■ Waving a handkerchief through the window.

The driver must obey the traffic rules. Especially at junctions.

Other drivers must let them pass.

Right of way in narrow sections

Narrow sections with signs

You must always follow the rules indicated by vertical signs, traffic lights, or traffic officers when passing along a very narrow road or track.

Narrow sections without signs

If there are no signs for passing through a narrow section, the vehicle that entered the narrow section first has right of way.

Ver vídeo

If there is doubt about which vehicle entered first, vehicles that have more difficulty manoeuvring will have priority.

Which vehicles have priority to pass through a narrow section?

The order of priority of vehicles is as follows:

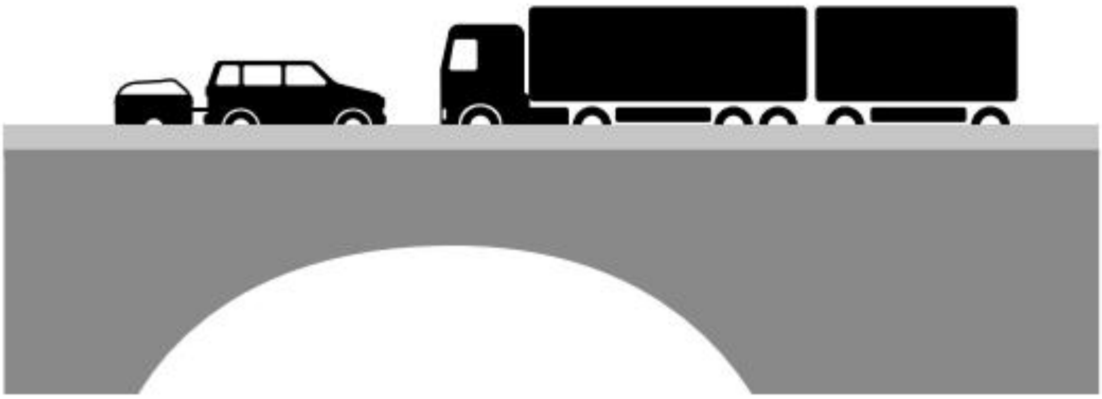
1. Special vehicles that exceed the weight and dimensions set by the rules that regulate vehicles.
2. Vehicle combinations.
3. Animal-drawn vehicles.
4. Motor caravans and cars towing a trailer that weighs less than 750 kilos.
5. Buses.

- 6. Lorries, articulated lorries and vans.
- 7. Cars and car-derived vehicles.
- 8. Heavy quadricycles, light quadricycles and special vehicles that have the weight and dimensions set by the rules that regulate vehicles.
- 9. Three-wheeled mopeds, motorcycles with sidecar and other three-wheeled vehicles.
- 10. Motorcycles, two-wheeled mopeds and bicycles.

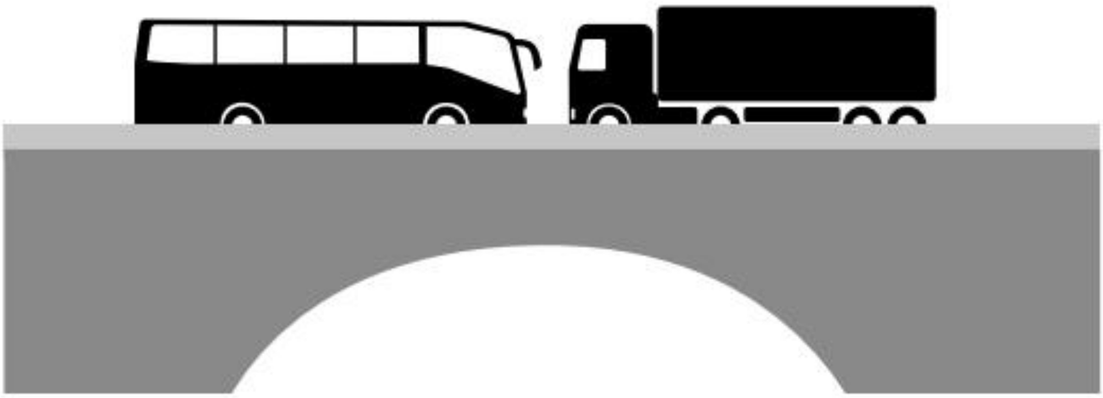
When they are vehicles of the same type or there are doubts about which one should pass, the following has priority:

- ■ The vehicle that has to reverse for a longer distance.
- ■ When the reversing distance is the same, the vehicle that is wider, longer, or can carry more load will have priority to pass.

The lorry can go first. The car has to reverse.



The bus can go first. The lorry has to reverse.



Narrow sections on a slope

On steep slopes, the vehicle travelling uphill has priority to pass, unless it has a safe place to stop closer than the other vehicle.

If in doubt, the same rule will be followed as in narrow sections that are not on a slope.

The car has priority. The lorry must reverse.

Crossing level crossings and movable bridges

You must reduce speed and drive more carefully when you approach a level crossing or a movable bridge.

You must not cross the level crossing or movable bridge when:

- ■ It is closed.
- ■ Its barriers are moving to open or close the crossing.
- ■ There is a traffic light indicating that you must stop.

In those cases, all vehicles must wait in their lane, one behind another, until the crossing is clear.

Once the crossing is clear, you must cross quickly. Make sure beforehand that there is no risk of being trapped inside the level crossing.

If there are no barriers or traffic lights, you must check that no train or tram is coming before crossing.

When a vehicle is trapped inside a level crossing or a movable bridge, all the people travelling in it, except the driver, must get out of the vehicle.

The driver will try to start the vehicle once the rest of the passengers have got out.

If they do not manage it, they will also get out of the vehicle and try to warn any trains or trams that may pass and the drivers of other vehicles approaching the area .

Crossing tunnels and underpasses

No vehicle may enter a tunnel when at the tunnel entrance there is a traffic light that prohibits passage.

Ver vídeo

Inside the tunnel you must keep a distance of at least 100 metres from the vehicle in front (or 4 seconds).

Vehicles that can carry a weight greater than 3,500 kilos must keep a distance of 150 metres from the vehicle in front (or 6 seconds).

Rules for stopping the vehicle inside a tunnel

When there is heavy traffic and vehicles cannot move forward inside a tunnel, all passengers must stay inside the vehicle.

The driver must switch off the engine

and leave the position lights on. When braking, they will switch on the hazard warning lights for a moment so that other drivers can see them.

Emergencies inside a tunnel

When a driver has to stop the vehicle inside a tunnel because of an emergency, the steps they must follow are:

- ■ Switch off the engine, leave the position lights and the hazard warning lights on so that other drivers can see the vehicle.
- ■ Take the vehicle to the nearest emergency area. If there is no emergency area, they must move it as close as possible to the right-hand edge of the road.
- ■ Switch on and place the warning light, if you have one, or otherwise place the warning triangles on the carriageway.
- ■ Ask for help through the nearest emergency call post inside the tunnel and follow the instructions you are given.
- ■ All the people travelling in the vehicle must get out and go to the nearest refuge or exit.
- ■ When the vehicle can be moved, despite the breakdown, drive until you leave the tunnel or reach the nearest emergency area.

If there is a fire inside a tunnel, drivers of vehicles must follow these steps:

- ■ Move the vehicle to the right to let emergency vehicles pass.
- ■ Switch off the engine.
- ■ Leave the key in and the vehicle doors open. That is, not locked.
- ■ All the people travelling in the vehicle must get out and go to the nearest refuge or exit. Always in the opposite direction to the fire.

Contents

Rules for carrying people, animals and loads

General rules

Weight limit

All vehicles have a maximum number of kilos they can carry, depending on their characteristics.

It is prohibited for vehicles to carry more load than they can, taking into account the weight of passengers, luggage and other materials or loads.

When a vehicle carries more weight than it should, some of its parts get damaged, such as: the tyres, the acceleration systems and the braking systems.

Carrying animals

Animals must travel in the back of the vehicle and be secured to the seat. When possible, a separation net or another device will be placed between the part where the animals travel and the part where the driver travels.

Animals must never travel loose in the vehicle.

Carrying people

General rules Carrying people on a bicycle

Carrying people on a moped and motorcycle

General rules

The number of people who can travel in a vehicle depends on the number of seats that vehicle has.

For example, in a car with five seats, six people cannot travel.

Ver vídeo

Each person must travel in their seat throughout the journey without moving to other spaces in the vehicle.

Ver vídeo

However, people may travel in the parts of vehicles intended for carrying loads when the vehicle has the necessary authorisation.

The driver must distribute the passengers in the vehicle and place the load so that they have enough space to drive and can see the road well from all sides of the vehicle.

The driver must pay special attention to:

- ■ Being comfortable in their seat.
- ■ Making sure the rest of the passengers occupy their seats and do not move from them.
- ■ Placing the objects they are carrying properly so that they do not get in the way.

All passengers will get in and out of the vehicle when it is stopped and on the side closest to the pavement or the hard shoulder.

Carrying people on a bicycle

On bicycles designed for one person, only the rider may travel. However, when the rider is of legal age, they may carry as a passenger a child under seven years old.

The child will travel in an approved additional seat. This seat will be fitted behind the seat of the adult who is riding.

Carrying people on mopeds and motorcycles

Ver vídeo

On mopeds and motorcycles, one person may travel with the rider when the person meets the following requirements:

- ■ They are over 12 years old.
- ■ They sit behind the rider.
- ■ They sit correctly and place their feet on the footrests on the sides of the vehicle.
- ■ They wear the helmet correctly fastened.

Ver vídeo

As an exception, children who are over seven years old may travel on a motorcycle or moped when they meet two requirements.

- ■ They travel with one of their parents or with an adult who takes responsibility for them.
- ■ They follow all the safety rules that other passengers must follow.

Carrying loads

A load is any object carried in the vehicle. It can be luggage, goods, or anything else.

In vehicles designed to carry people, luggage and other types of loads may be carried as long as they meet these requirements:

- ■ The load is suitable for the characteristics of the vehicle. For example, it does not exceed the weight that the vehicle can carry.
- ■ The load is well distributed and secured so that the vehicle does not lose stability.
- ■ The driver of the vehicle indicates that they are carrying that load, when necessary.
- ■ The load does not cover the lights or the warning signals of the vehicle. It also allows other vehicles to clearly see the signals the driver makes with their hand.

Objects carried in a vehicle must be placed in the boot.

When it is necessary to place an object elsewhere in the vehicle, it must be ensured that the object will not move in the event of a crash or when braking. The driver must also ensure that the object allows them to see the whole road clearly.

It is prohibited for the loads carried by a vehicle to:

- ■ Move around inside the vehicle.
- ■ Fall off.
- ■ Drag along the road.
- ■ Make noise, give off dust, or smoke.

The transport of loads that may fall or that give off dust must always be done in special vehicles designed to transport these materials.

Motorcycles, three-wheeled vehicles, mopeds, cycles and bicycles may tow a trailer or semi-trailer when it meets the following characteristics:

■ The trailer weighs at most half of what the vehicle weighs.

- ■ It travels during the day and is clearly visible.
- ■ The vehicle travels more slowly than the maximum speed permitted for that vehicle.

- ■ No people travel in the trailer.

Permitted dimensions for vehicles and loads

Permitted dimensions for vehicles Width

The maximum permitted width for a vehicle is 2.55 metres, including its load if it is carrying one.

Height

Vehicle	Maximum permitted height (Including the load)
Vehicles in general	4 m 4 metres
Buses	4.20 metres
Recovery vehicles that remove vehicles	4.50 metres

Length

Vehicle		Maximum permitted length (Including the load)
Motor vehicles, except buses	12 metres	12 m
Trailer only	12 metres	12 m
Vehicles with trailer	18.75 metres	18.75 m
Articulated vehicles, carrying a semi-trailer	16.50 metres	16.50 m
Combination of vehicles in euromodular configuration	25.25 metres	25.25 m

Watch video

Permitted dimensions for loads

As a general rule, the load cannot be wider, higher, or longer than the vehicle carrying it. That is, it cannot project beyond the vehicle. However, a load placed on the roof rack of the vehicle may project.

Roof rack. The top part of the vehicle where luggage and other objects can be placed.

In cases where the load has to project because there is no other way to transport the object, vehicles must meet different conditions depending on the type of vehicle.

Vehicles that carry loads

Vehicles that carry passengers

Vehicles that only carry loads

In vehicles used to transport goods, loads that cannot be folded or divided may project when they meet certain requirements.

Some examples of these loads can be: pipes, beams, or posts.

Type of vehicle	How far may the load project?
Vehicles that are 5 metres or less in length	One third of the metres that the vehicle measures. For example, if the vehicle is 3 metres long, the load may project 1 metre. The load may project to the front and to the rear 1/3 Maximum 1/3 Maximum
Vehicles that are more than 5 metres in length	The load may project 2 metres to the front and 3 metres to the rear. Maximum 2m Maximum 3m
Vehicles that are at most 2.55 metres	The load may project 0.40 metres on each side of the vehicle.
wide when carrying the load	NOT PERMITTED It is not permitted to place the load like this. The panels cannot be placed transversely Dimension because they take up more. greater
	PERMITTED It is permitted to place Greater dimension the load like this. Smaller dimension

Combinations of vehicles in euromodular configuration

The load cannot be longer than the vehicle.

Vehicles that also carry passengers

The load cannot project to the front or to the sides of the vehicle.

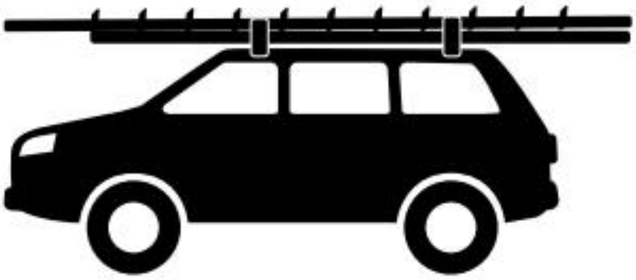
The load may project to the rear of the vehicle when it meets these characteristics.

■ Loads that can be divided into smaller loads may project, at most, 10 per cent of the vehicle's length at the rear of the vehicle.

For example, in a vehicle that is three metres long, a bicycle placed at the rear may project 30 centimetres at most.

■ Loads that cannot be divided into smaller loads may project, at most, 15 per cent at the rear of the vehicle.

For example, in a vehicle that is 3 metres long, a board placed on top may project 45 centimetres to the rear at most.



- ■ In vehicles that are less than one metre wide, such as motorcycles, the load:
  - ■ Cannot project to the front.
  - ■ May project 0.25 metres (25 centimetres) to the rear.
  - ■ May project 0.50 metres (50 centimetres) on each side from the centre of the vehicle.

Whenever the load projects beyond the vehicle, all necessary measures must be taken to prevent accidents or damage to other people and vehicles.

Marking a projecting load

Loads projecting to the front

- ■ During the day they are not marked.
- ■ At night or on days with poor light they are marked with a white light.

Loads projecting to the rear

- ■ They are marked during the day and at night.
- ■ To mark them, a plate with red and white diagonal stripes is fitted at the rear of the load.
- ■ Two plates with red and white diagonal stripes are fitted at the rear of the vehicle when the load is as wide as the vehicle.

Each plate is fitted at one end of the projecting load.

Loads projecting to the rear must be lit with a red light when the vehicle is travelling at night or on a day with poor light.

Loads projecting to the sides

Loads that project more than 40 centimetres beyond the sides of the vehicle must have a light switched on at the ends of the load when it is night-time or on a day with poor light.

The lights marking the load at the front of the vehicle will be white, and those marking the load at the rear will be red.

Loading and unloading operations

Loading and unloading operations must always be carried out off the road.

When circumstances make it necessary to do it on the road, the following precautions will be taken:

- ■ Do not cause damage to other vehicles or pedestrians travelling in that area.
- ■ Respect the rules on the places where stopping and parking are allowed and the times when it is permitted.
- ■ Stop the vehicle on the side closest to the pavement or the hard shoulder.
- ■ Take as little time as possible to load or unload.
- ■ Avoid unnecessary noise and disturbance.

It is prohibited to leave loads on the road, the hard shoulder, or in pedestrian areas.

Vehicle plates and signs

Number plate

All motor vehicles, except motorcycles, must display two number plates. One at the front and one at the rear.

Motorcycles and mopeds must display only one plate, at the rear.

Trailers and semi-trailers that can carry more than 750 kilos must have their number plate at the back and, in addition, the number plate of the vehicle towing them.

Trailers and semi-trailers that can carry less than 750 kilos will only have the number plate of the vehicle towing them at the back.

Priority vehicle signal

Light signal made up of one or more blue lights.

It is carried by vehicles that provide emergency services.

These vehicles are:

police cars, fire engines, civil protection vehicles, rescue vehicles and ambulances.

These vehicles can use the light signal at the same time as the siren to make sounds.

Speed limit plate

It indicates that the vehicle carrying it must not travel at more kilometres per hour than the number shown on the plate. It is placed at the back of the vehicle.

Slow vehicle plate

It indicates that the vehicle carrying it must not travel faster than 40 kilometres per hour.

It is placed at the back of the vehicle.

Long vehicle plate

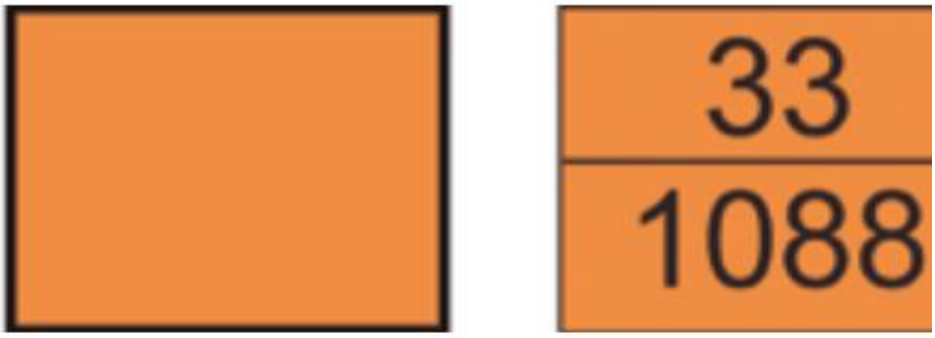
It indicates that the vehicle carrying it is more than 12 metres long.

This plate is placed at the back of the vehicle. It is rectangular, yellow, and with red edges.

Plate for a vehicle carrying dangerous goods

These plates may have numbers. The numbers at the top give information about the type of danger that the material can cause. For example, if it is toxic material or if it can catch fire.

The numbers at the bottom indicate the material the vehicle is carrying.



New driver plate

It indicates that the driving licence of the person driving the vehicle is less than one year old.

This sign is placed on the rear window of the vehicle, in a place where it can be seen clearly.

Signal to indicate danger

It indicates that the vehicle is stopped on the road due to any emergency, due to a breakdown, or that the load it is carrying has fallen onto the road surface.

It is a yellow signal that is placed on the highest part of the vehicle so that it can be seen clearly.

Vehicle roadworthiness inspection signal

Sticker that indicates that the vehicle has passed the roadworthiness inspection and is in good condition to drive.

It also indicates the date when it must pass the next inspection.

This sticker is placed on the right-hand side of the front windscreen of motor vehicles. On trailers and semi-trailers it is placed in a place where it can be seen clearly.

Warning sign for escorting special transport

Sign that a vehicle carries on the top to indicate that a special transport vehicle is travelling nearby.

For example, a combine harvester or an excavator.

Warning sign for escorting cyclists Sign that a vehicle carries on the top to warn that there are cyclists travelling nearby.

Contents

The road

On some stretches of road you must be more careful than on others when driving because more difficulties may appear.

These places are:

Bends

Roadworks area

Bends

Bends are dangerous stretches of road where you must drive more carefully. The reason is that, when taking a bend at speed, a force is created that can push the vehicle out of the bend and send it towards the side it must not go to.

Bends are more dangerous when:

- ■ The bend is very tight.
- ■ The vehicle is carrying a lot of weight.
- ■ The vehicle is travelling very fast. In those cases, the vehicle may continue straight on, as if there were no bend. For this reason, it may leave the road or enter the oncoming lane.

Steps to take a bend properly

Before entering the bend you must:

- ■ Reduce speed or brake if necessary.
- ■ Move as close as possible to the right-hand edge of the carriageway.

In the bend you must:

- ■ Turn the steering wheel smoothly.
- ■ Do not accelerate or brake suddenly.
- ■ Accelerate little by little.

When leaving the bend you must:

- ■ Turn the steering wheel smoothly to drive straight again.
- ■ Increase speed little by little.

Skidding on bends

Skidding happens mainly on bends. The reason is that the force that pushes vehicles on bends can make their tyres lose grip on the road, slip, and lose control.

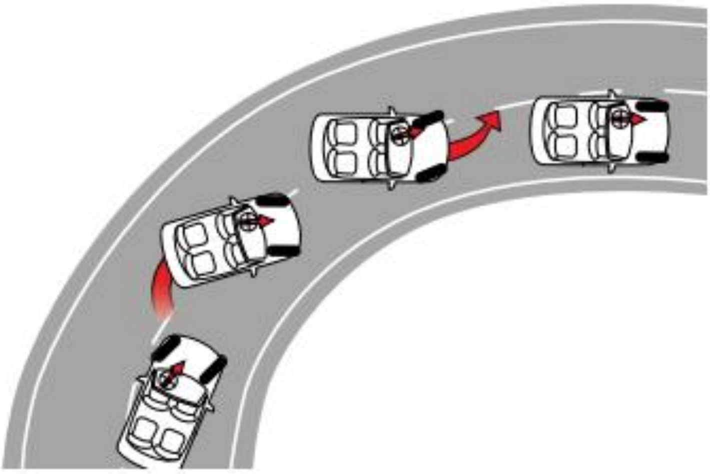
Skid. To slide or slip on the road. When a vehicle skids, it moves away from the direction it was going and goes to another side.

A skid can be caused by:

- ■ Driving very fast.
- ■ Making a sudden turn with the steering wheel.
- ■ Pressing the brake pedal very hard.
- ■ Having tyres or shock absorbers in poor condition.
- ■ Distributing the load badly in the vehicle.

How can you make the vehicle stop skidding?

Type of vehicle	Which wheels skid?	What must you do?
Front-wheel drive. The engine power goes to the front wheels	Rear	Do not brake. Turn the steering wheel towards the side the wheels are moving to. Accelerate
Rear-wheel drive.	Rear	smoothly. Do not brake.
The engine power goes to the rear wheels		Stop accelerating smoothly. Turn the steering wheel towards the side the rear wheels are moving to.
Rear-wheel drive	Front	Stop accelerating. Straighten the steering wheel until the wheels stop skidding.



Roadworks area

Roadworks can be a danger. Whenever you drive on a road with roadworks, you must follow the instructions of the roadworks staff.

To show that a road is under roadworks, the following signs are used.

- ■ Vertical warning signs and signs that inform you of the rules you must follow. These signs will have a yellow background.
- ■ Road markings, in yellow.
- ■ Other signs that are only placed when there are roadworks.

Driving at night

Driving at night is more dangerous than driving during the day.

Ver vídeo

The reasons are:

- ■ The road is less well lit.
- ■ Distances, people, objects and vehicles are harder to see.
- ■ Other vehicles can dazzle you with their lights.

You must pay special attention when going from an area that is well lit to another that is poorly lit. It takes the eyes a few seconds to get used to the change in light.

When driving at night you must take special care with:

Speed Dazzle Overtaking Bends

Speed

You must respect the speed limits and drive more slowly if you cannot see the road well. In this way it will be easier to stop the vehicle if there is a danger or something unexpected.

Dazzle

When a vehicle dazzles you, you cannot see the road well because too much light enters your eyes.

Ver vídeo

What can you do to avoid dazzling other drivers?

- ■ Keep the lights properly adjusted. Dipped beam may bother others because it is not properly adjusted.
- ■ Distribute the weight you are carrying in the vehicle properly. Dipped beam may be too high and dazzle because there is too much weight at the back of the vehicle.

■ Switch off main beam and switch on dipped beam when another vehicle is coming towards you from any direction.

When a vehicle dazzles you, reduce speed or even stop the car, taking the necessary safety precautions.

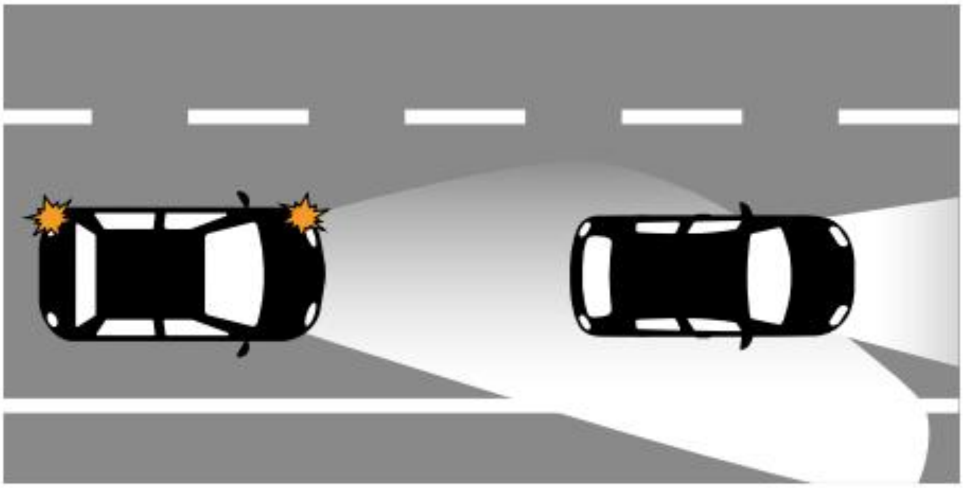
Do not move into other lanes when reducing speed or stopping. You can guide yourself by the line at the right-hand edge.

Do not use dark or sunglasses at night. Other vehicles may dazzle you less, but you will see the road much worse.

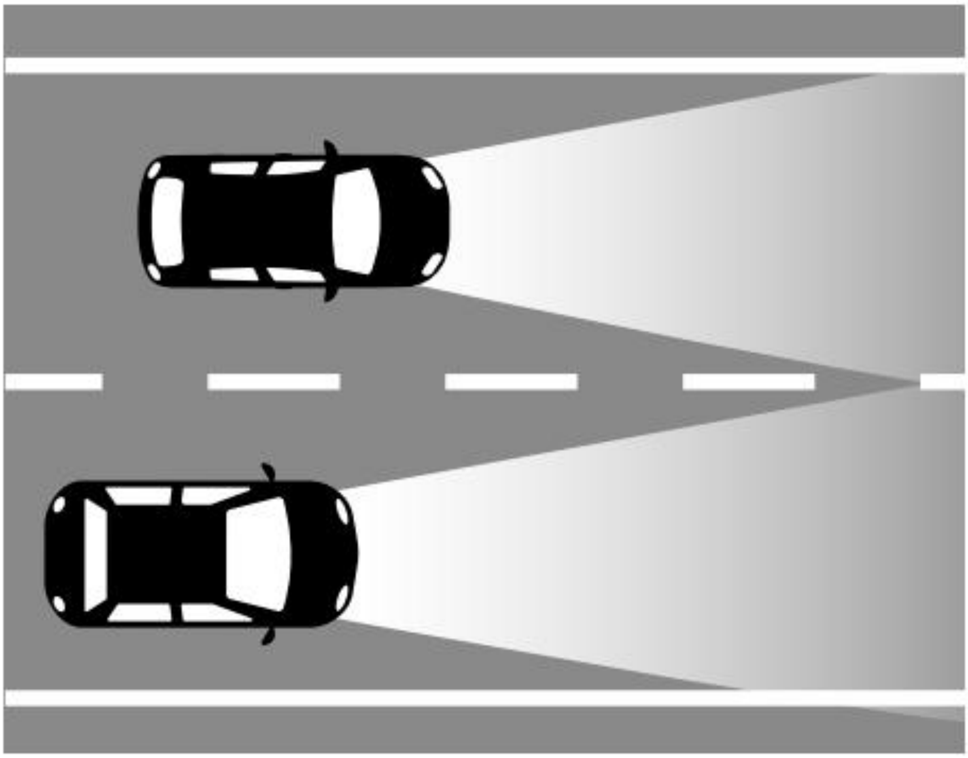
Overtaking

When you are going to overtake another vehicle at night, you must switch off main beam and switch on dipped beam.

Main beam can dazzle the other driver through the rear-view mirrors.

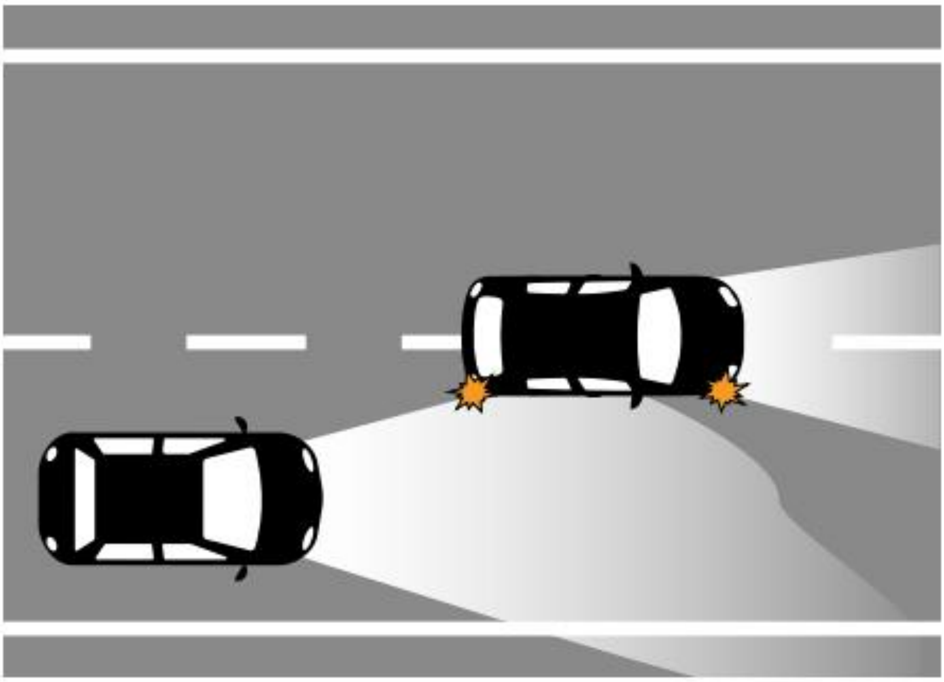


When you are already overtaking, switch main beam back on as soon as possible. That is, when you can no longer dazzle the other driver.



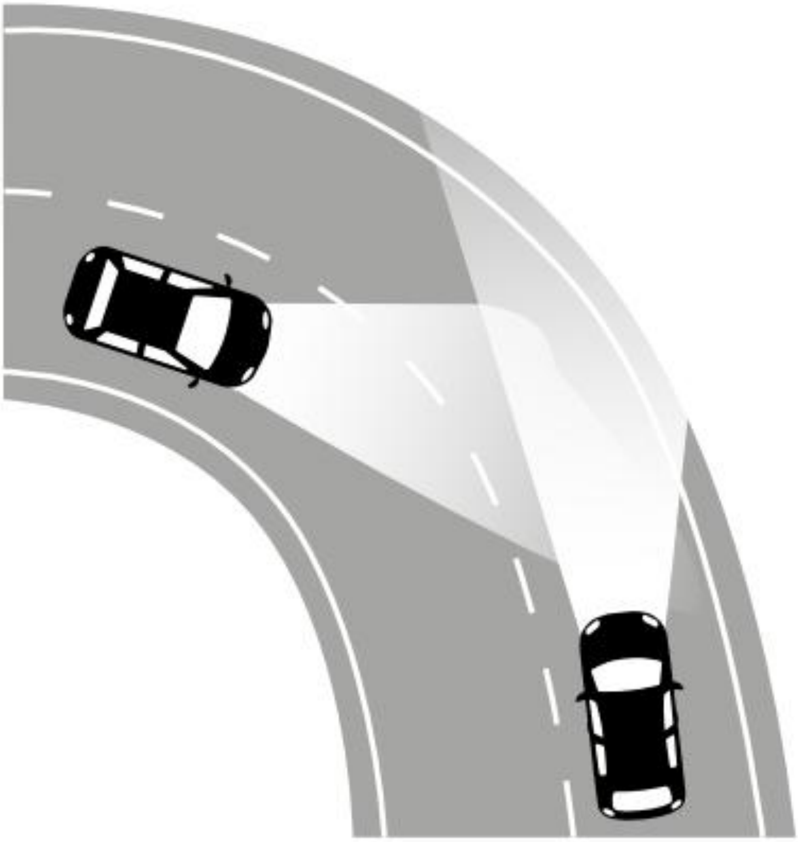
If another vehicle is overtaking you, keep main beam on while they overtake you.

Those lights will light up the road for both of you during the overtaking.



Bends

When two vehicles travelling in opposite directions pass each other at night on a bend, the vehicle travelling on the inside of the bend is the one that must switch off main beam and switch on dipped beam.



The reason is that its lights are the ones that light the road directly and can dazzle the other driver.

The driver travelling on the outside of the bend can keep main beam on because their lights shine off the road. They cannot dazzle other drivers.

They must only change to dipped beam if they see that at any moment they are dazzling another driver.

The weather

Driving in rain

When it rains heavily it can be more difficult to drive for the following reasons:

- ■ The road is harder to see.
- ■ The tyres have less grip on the road. When this happens, the vehicle needs more space to brake.

The precautions you must take to drive in rain are:

- ■ Keep the tyres in good condition.
- ■ Check that the windscreen wipers work well.
- ■ Brake gently so that the wheels have more time to stop.
- ■ Check that the brakes work well after going through a puddle.
- ■ Keep a greater distance from the vehicle in front.
- ■ Reduce speed.

Ver vídeo

You must be especially careful when the first drops of water start to fall. These drops mix with dust, grease, and other dirt on the road, forming mud that can make the vehicle skid.

When the wheels skid, you must lift your foot off the accelerator, but without braking.

Motorcyclists must pay special attention to the road markings when it rains because they can slip on them.

Aquaplaning

What is it?

Losing control of the vehicle because the tyre cannot clear all the water it picks up from the road and it skids.

It is easier to aquaplane and lose control when the vehicle is travelling at high speed and when the tyres are very wide or very worn.

Therefore, the best way to prevent aquaplaning is to drive slowly in areas where there is water.

After passing through that area, you must check that the brakes work well.

Driving in snow

Driving in snow is more difficult for the following reasons:

- ■ The road, signs, and vehicles are harder to see.
- ■ The tyres have less grip on the road. When this happens, the vehicle needs more space to brake.

The precautions you must take to drive in snow are:

- ■ Start the vehicle with the wheels straight.
- ■ Choose a gear in the **gearbox** that allows the vehicle to move off at a higher speed, but with little engine force.

Gearbox. Vehicle mechanism that is responsible for converting the engine force into movement of the wheels.

With the gearbox, the driver can choose to go faster or slower and with more or less engine force.

■ Do not make sudden movements with the steering wheel or change gear suddenly.

When going downhill, you must do it more slowly than normal and choose low gears (first or second) so that they hold the vehicle back.

- ■ Reduce speed little by little.
- ■ Keep a greater safety distance from the other vehicles.
- ■ Use the brake as little as possible and do it gently.
- ■ Drive over the tracks made by other vehicles with their wheels.

When the sun comes out after it has snowed, it is advisable to wear sunglasses so that the light does not dazzle you.

The R-412 sign indicates that you are obliged to fit snow chains on the vehicle to continue driving in snow.

The chains are fitted, at least, on the driving wheels.

You must fit at least one chain on each side of the vehicle.

Driving on ice

Ice means that the wheels cannot grip the road and the vehicle skids a lot.

The precautions you must take to drive on ice are the same as for driving in snow. Drive slowly and keep a very large safety distance from other vehicles because you will need more space to brake.

There may be ice on the road, during the night or early morning, in the following places:

- ■ In damp areas.
- ■ In areas where the sun does not reach.
- ■ On bridges and flyovers.
- ■ On speed humps.
- ■ Where there are P-34 or P319 signs with a panel on which the word Ice is written.

Ice can also remain on the vehicle windows. In these situations, before you start driving, you must:

- ■ Scrape the ice off all the windows, without scratching them.
- ■ Clean the rear-view mirrors.

Driving in fog

Fog is very dangerous for driving for the following reasons:

- ■ The road, signs, and vehicles are harder to see.
- ■ The tyres have less grip on the road because the surface is damp.

The precautions you must take to drive in fog are:

- ■ Keep the vehicle well ventilated so that the windows do not mist up.
- ■ Switch on dipped headlights and fog lights.
- ■ Drive slowly.
- ■ Keep a very large safety distance from other vehicles.
- ■ Pay close attention to road signs and road markings.
- ■ Try not to overtake other vehicles if it is not necessary.
- ■ Take extra care when you approach junctions.

Driving in clouds of dust or smoke

They are a danger because they do not allow you to see the road, signs, or other vehicles well. Also, they can appear suddenly.

To drive in clouds of dust and smoke, you must take the same precautions as for driving in fog.

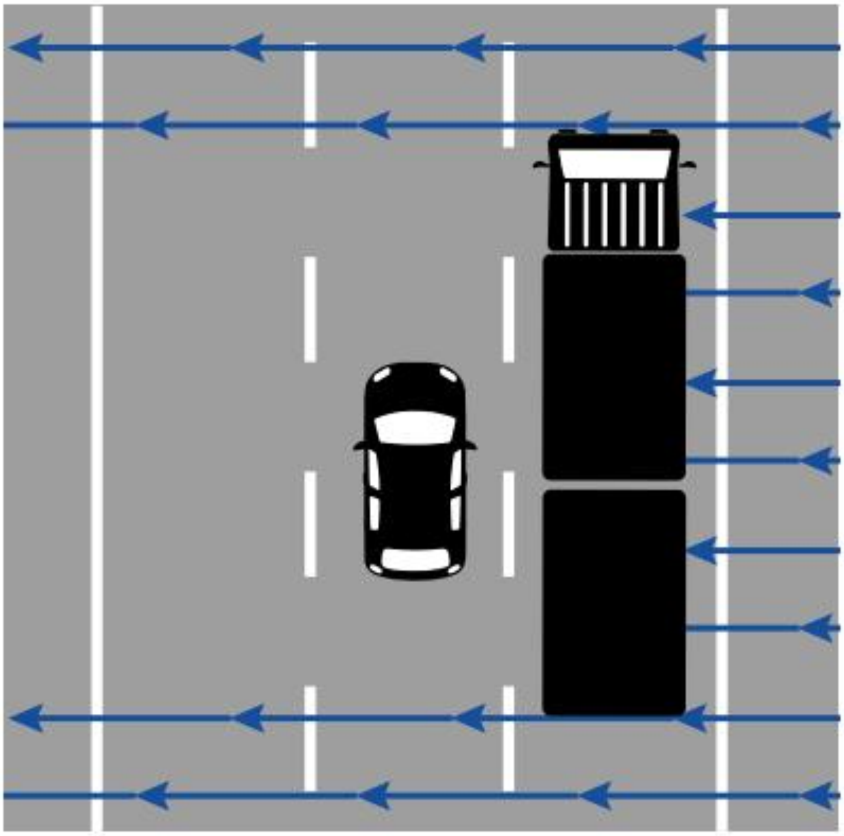
Driving in strong wind

It is dangerous to drive in strong wind, especially when it blows from the side, because it can make the vehicle lose control, overturn, or leave the road.

Wind affects two-wheeled vehicles and vehicles towing a trailer more.

Wind is more dangerous for driving in the following situations:

- ■ When you meet another vehicle.
- ■ When overtaking a vehicle that takes up a lot of space.



■ When passing in front of buildings, trees, and other objects that can cause the wind to appear suddenly.

The precautions you must take to drive in strong side wind are:

- ■ Drive more slowly.
- ■ Hold the steering wheel firmly and steer against the wind.
- ■ Keep the windows closed.
- ■ Bear in mind that trees, branches, or stones may fall.

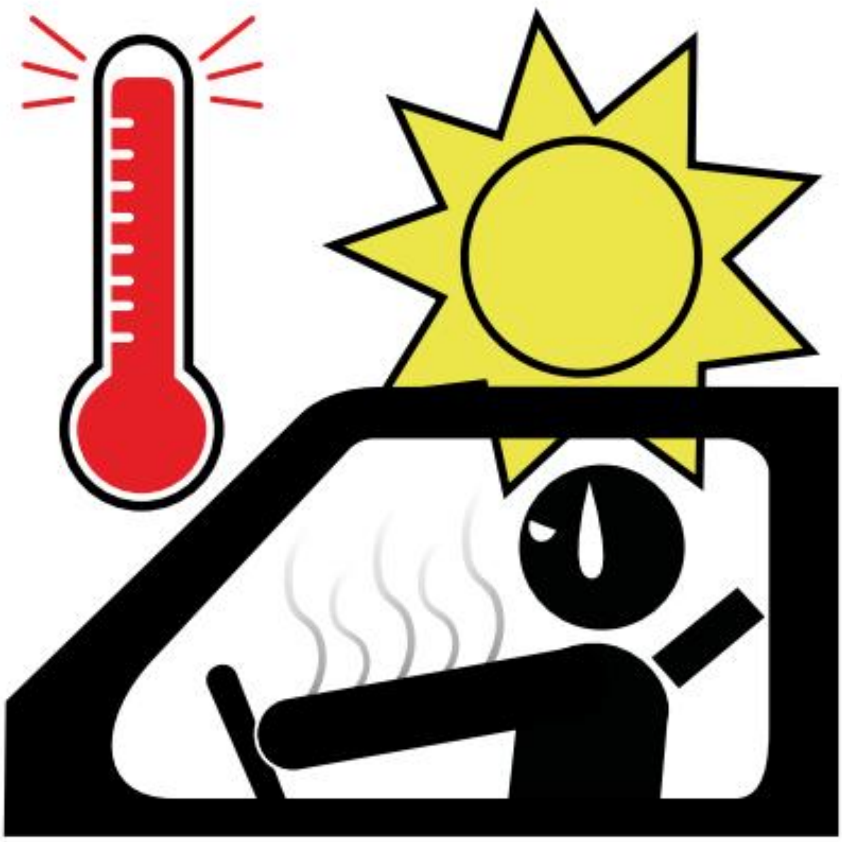
Driving in heat

It is dangerous to drive in heat for the following reasons:

- ■ Sleepiness and fatigue appear sooner and can cause distractions and mistakes.
- ■ You may need more time to react to unexpected events.
- ■ Aggressiveness towards other drivers may increase.

The precautions you must take to drive on a very hot day are:

- ■ Use the vehicle's air conditioning and keep it at a temperature between 20 and 23 degrees.
- ■ Take more breaks during the journey.
- ■ Drink plenty of water or juices.
- ■ Pay more attention when you drive after eating because you may become sleepy.
- ■ Wear light-coloured, light, loose clothing.



Contents

Vehicle systems

What are they?

All the mechanisms and elements of the vehicle that make it work and be safe.

Vehicles have eight main systems:

- ■ Fuel system
- ■ Electrical system
- ■ Lubrication system
- ■ Cooling system
- ■ Transmission system
- ■ Steering system
- ■ Suspension system
- ■ Braking system

Fuel system

What is its function?

To bring air and fuel to the engine so that the vehicle can work.

The air can carry dirt from the street. That is why the system has a filter that is responsible for cleaning that air so that it reaches the engine in good condition.

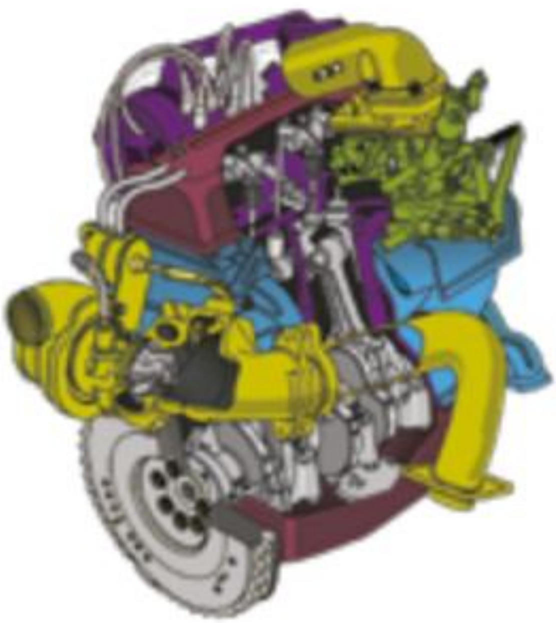
You must clean this filter from time to time because, when it is dirty, the fuel passes through it worse.

This means you use more fuel than when it is clean.

Also, when the filter is very dirty or broken, black smoke may come out from the fuel through the **exhaust pipe**.

Exhaust pipe. Pipe that cars have at the back to expel the gases that are created in the engine.

You must check the filter more often in summer than in winter and when you drive on roads with a lot of dust.



Electrical system

What is its function?

To provide energy to the car so that it can switch on, the engine can start, and other elements such as the lights or the horn can work.

This system has several parts:

Battery Ignition circuit

Charging circuit

Lighting circuit

Battery

It provides the energy needed to start the engine.

It also supplies energy to the rest of the vehicle when necessary.

The battery must be kept clean, dry, and properly secured in its place.

Ver vídeo

Ignition circuit

It is responsible for producing the spark of electricity needed for the air and fuel to turn into energy and for the vehicle to start working.

This spark of electricity is produced in an engine part called a spark plug.

To keep the ignition circuit in good condition, you must check the condition of the spark plugs and change them when necessary.

You must also check that the engine is in good condition.

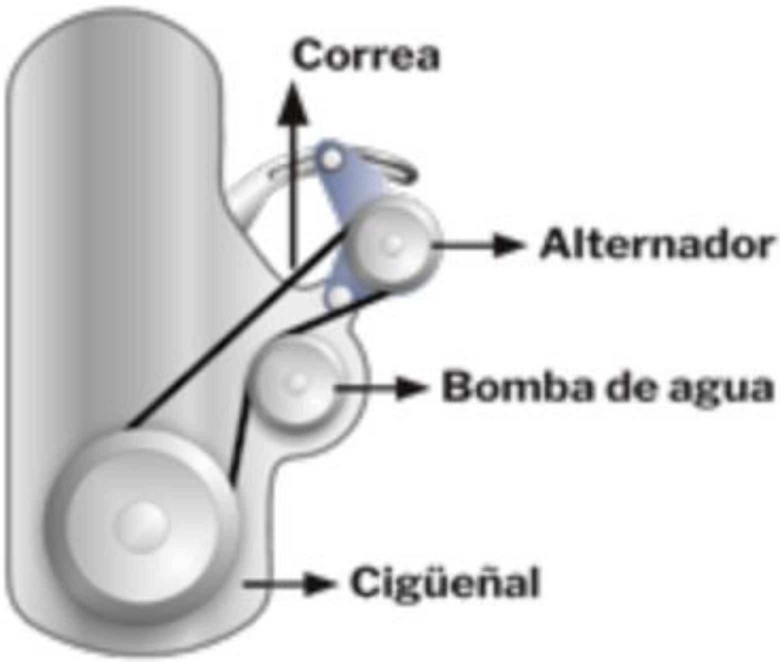
Charging circuit

It is responsible for supplying electric current to the battery and to all the systems that need it while the vehicle engine is running.

Ver vídeo

The part that allows the vehicle to produce electricity and store it in the battery is called the alternator.

The alternator is driven by a belt.



You must check from time to time that this belt is in good condition and change it when necessary.

Lighting circuit

It is made up of all the elements that allow the vehicle lights to be switched on.

Ver vídeo

It is important to check the lighting system.

You must change the bulbs that give light when they shine less.

Lubrication system

What is its function?

To distribute oil to all parts of the vehicle engine to create a layer that covers the engine parts to protect them and prevent them from rubbing against each other.

The oils used for vehicles are special substances that prevent the vehicle parts from wearing out more.

The instruments that monitor the oil in the lubrication system are:

■ Dipstick. It indicates how much oil there is in the engine.

■ Pressure gauge or warning light. It monitors the oil pressure in the engine. The oil must have the correct pressure to be distributed well throughout the engine and cover all its parts.

Pressure gauge Warning light

[Watch video]

When the warning light comes on, it means that there is little oil or that it does not have the pressure it needs.

In that case, you must stop the vehicle and not continue until you know what the problem is and fix it.

To check the oil level, you must look at the dipstick when the engine is stopped and cold. The oil level must be between the minimum and maximum marks.

Types of oils

Depending on where they come from

Depending on their thickness

Depending on where they come from

Type of oil	How is it obtained?
Mineral	From oil. Nowadays it is used very little.
Synthetic	It is made in a laboratory by mixing substances from oil and from other materials.
Semi-synthetic	A mixture of mineral oils and synthetic oils.

Why are synthetic oils used more?

Because they have the following advantages:

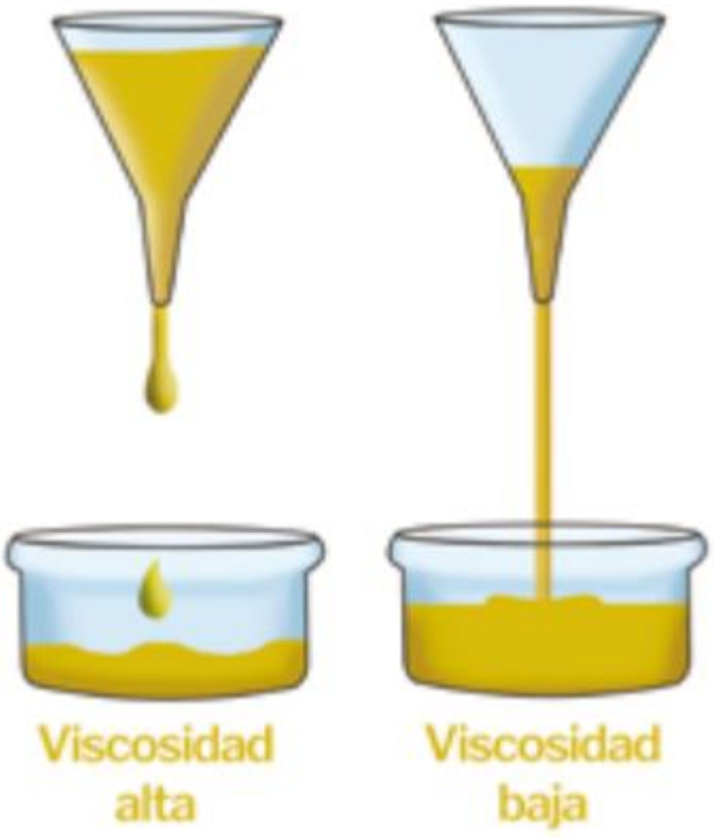
- ■ They resist cold and heat better.
- ■ They allow the vehicle to start better when it is very cold.
- ■ They protect the engine better because they are thicker and less runny than mineral oils.
- ■ Less oil is needed.
- ■ They last longer. Therefore, the vehicle’s oil needs changing less often.

Depending on their thickness

Oil is more runny when it heats up and thicker when it is cold.

That is why it is better to use a more runny oil when the temperature is low. This way it will circulate better through the engine when starting the vehicle, even if it is very cold.

However, when the engine is hot it is better to use a thicker oil. If it is too runny it will not cover the engine parts well.



To avoid these problems there are oils that adapt well to cold and heat. They are called multigrade oils and they have this label.

10W/40

10W indicates that this oil spreads well through the engine, even if the temperature is low.

40 indicates that it can withstand very high temperatures without being damaged.

To top up the vehicle with oil you must lift the engine cover and pour the oil through the cap that is in that place.

From time to time it is necessary to change the oil and the filter.

To change it, the vehicle must be level and the engine must be stopped and warm.

You must avoid the oil falling onto the ground because it is very polluting.

If oil spills while you are topping up the vehicle, you must collect it.

When a bluish-white smoke comes out through the exhaust pipe it means that the vehicle has too much oil.

Cooling system

What is its function?

To make sure the engine stays at a good temperature so it can keep working and to prevent its parts from wearing out and breaking due to excess heat.

Without this system, the engine would heat up very quickly when running and would break down.

A liquid called coolant passes through the engine parts and absorbs the heat so that it stays cool.

Then this liquid goes to a part called the radiator. There it cools down again and returns to the engine driven by a water pump.

You must check that the belts that drive the water pump are in good condition and that the whole cooling circuit works well.

Ver vídeo

You must also check that the vehicle has enough coolant. It must stay between the minimum and maximum marks when the engine is cold.

White smoke may come out of the exhaust pipe. That smoke is water vapour. This is normal when starting, especially when it is cold.

However, it may indicate that there is a broken part or a fault if the white smoke comes out when the vehicle has been running for a while and the vehicle is hot.

At the start of winter it is important to check that the coolant is in good condition and is not going to freeze.

If the vehicle is in a very cold place during winter, the liquid can freeze and break the engine or the cooling system.

Transmission system

What is its function?

To transmit the engine's power to the wheels so that the vehicle can move.

A vehicle's engine can drive some wheels or others.

Depending on which wheels receive the drive, the vehicle can be:

	Which wheels receive the drive from the engine?
Front-wheel drive	The front ones.
Rear-wheel drive	The rear ones.
Four-wheel drive	All the wheels.

First gear is the one that sends the most force to the wheels, but it is the slowest.

Steering system

What is its function?

To transmit the movement of the steering wheel to the front wheels so that the driver can turn the vehicle without problems.

Signs that the steering system is failing:

- ■ It takes a lot of effort to turn the steering wheel.
- ■ The tyres may have low pressure and need inflating more.
- ■ The steering wheel is too loose.
- ■ The vehicle pulls to one side when you let go of the steering wheel on a straight road.
- ■ Some tyres may be more inflated than others.
- ■ The tyres wear out very quickly.
- ■ The steering wheel vibrates while you are driving. The wheels may not be properly balanced.

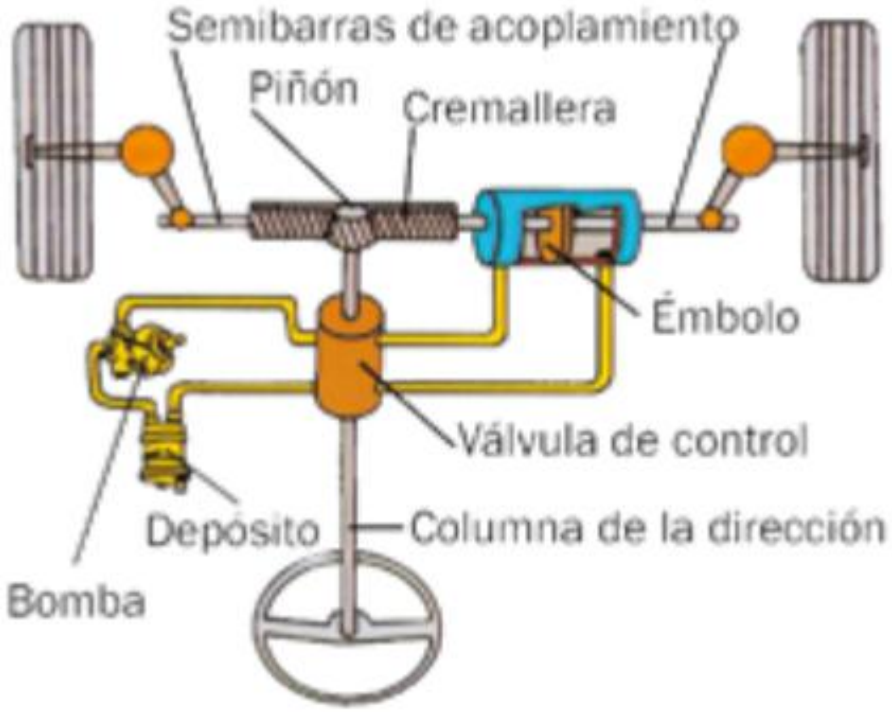
Power steering

A system that helps the driver so they have to use less force to turn the steering wheel and control the vehicle.

There is also a type of power steering called progressive.

Progressive power steering makes it very easy to turn the steering wheel when the vehicle is going slowly and makes it a bit harder when the vehicle is travelling at higher speed.

This makes it easier to control the vehicle.



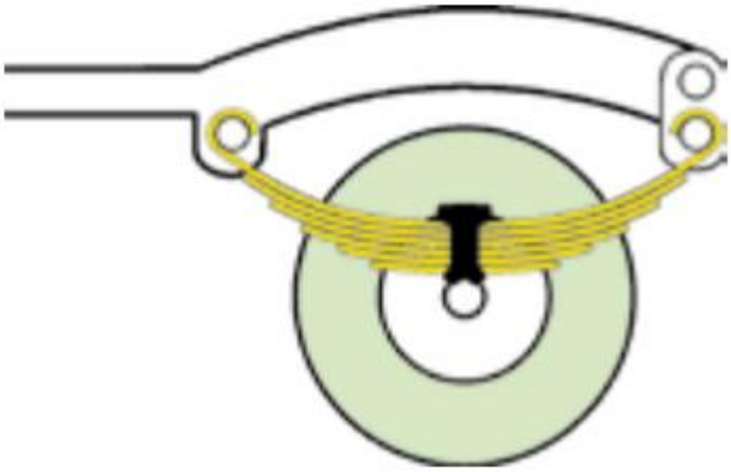
Suspension system

What is its function?

To keep contact between the tyres and the road at all times.

Thanks to this system, the vehicle does not lose stability and it allows passengers to travel more comfortably.

Without the suspension system the driver would have more difficulty getting over small obstacles in the road and driving without jolts.



What happens when the suspension system fails?

- ■ The vehicle dips forwards or the rear lifts a lot when braking.
- ■ The vehicle sways from side to side or leans a lot when taking a bend.
- ■ Bumps or wind are felt too much.
- ■ The tyres wear out very quickly.
- ■ The vehicle's lights move up and down when they are on.

What consequences does a suspension system in poor condition have?

■ The vehicle loses stability. Especially on bends and when it is windy.

- ■ There is a higher risk of *aquaplaning*.
- ■ The vehicle needs more space to brake. Especially when the road surface is wet.
- ■ The system that prevents the brakes from locking works worse.
- ■ Other parts of the vehicle wear out and break more easily.
- ■ The lights move up and down and can dazzle other drivers.
- ■ The driver may feel tired more easily.

Braking system

What is its function?

To reduce speed or stop the vehicle and prevent it from moving again when it should not.

When you press the brake pedal, a force is transmitted to the vehicle's wheels so that they stop and stop working.

This force passes through a liquid called brake fluid and reaches the parts that brake the wheels, which are the pads or the shoes.

The pads and the shoes rub against other parts of the wheels and make them stop.

What should you check?

■ That there is brake fluid in the vehicle's reservoir. And that it is between the minimum and maximum values and that it is in good condition.

- ■ That the pads or the shoes are not worn and are properly secured.
- ■ That the tyres are properly inflated, with the pressure they need.

Ver vídeo

Checking wheels and tyres

To keep the vehicle’s wheels and tyres in good condition, you must:

■ Check that the tyres are properly inflated, at least once a month. Especially if you are going to make a long journey, or load the vehicle a lot.

You must do this check before you start driving.

Ver vídeo

- Look at the tyre tread to make sure it is not too worn.

You must always carry a spare wheel in the vehicle and other systems. This wheel will be slightly more inflated than the others.

Contents

Preventing road traffic accidents

Risk factors

Most road traffic accidents can be avoided.

Some circumstances related to the driver, the vehicle, the road and the environment mean there is a higher risk of having an accident.

The circumstances that make a person have a higher risk of having an accident are called risk factors.

What are the main risk factors?

Risk factor	Some causes	Number of accidents
Human	Speeding. Drinking alcohol. Distractions.	Between 70 and 90 out of 100.
Condition of the road	The road is wet. Losing control on a bend.	Between 10 and 35 out of 100.
Vehicle fault	The brakes fail. A tyre punctures.	Between 4 and 13 out of 100.

Ver vídeo

Many of these risk factors can be avoided if the driver behaves responsibly.

For example, by checking the tyres before starting a journey to make sure they are in good condition and will not have a blowout.

Accidents can also be avoided by reducing speed and leaving a greater safe distance from the vehicle in front on a road when it is raining.

Where and when are there more road traffic accidents?

- ■ Most fatal accidents happen on roads outside towns or cities.

- ■ Most accidents happen on straight stretches and not on bends.
- ■ There are fewer accidents on motorways and dual carriageways than on the rest of the roads.
- ■ The times of year when there are more accidents are: Easter, December and summer.
- ■ There are more accidents at weekends and on public holidays. Especially in the early hours of the morning.
- ■ During the day, most accidents happen at the times of going to and coming back from work.
    - Especially at the end of the working day.

■ The accidents that happen most within cities are pedestrians being run over.

Consequences of road traffic accidents for society

Road traffic accidents are one of the main causes of injury and death. Especially in young people.

Also, each road traffic accident has very negative consequences for the whole of society.

These consequences are:

Human Material

Medical and healthcare costs

Costs in safety resources

Human

The death of a person causes physical and psychological suffering for the people around them.

Material

Road traffic accidents cause damage to vehicles, the road and the environment.

Spending on medical and healthcare resources

A lot of staff and money must be invested to provide first aid to the injured, treatment, rehabilitation and the adaptations that each injured person needs.

Spending on safety resources

A lot of staff and money must also be invested in the work that police officers and firefighters do at accidents.

Also, each accident means extra costs that insurance companies and the organisations that provide services to the injured have to pay.

For all these reasons, the World Health Organization considers that road traffic accidents are a health problem that affects the whole of society.

And it asks all of us to work together so that there are fewer deaths and injuries in road traffic accidents.

People with a higher risk of having road traffic accidents

There are studies that show that some groups of people are more likely to have an accident.

These groups of people are called risk groups.

Within these risk groups, we must distinguish between the risk that pedestrians face and the risk that drivers face.

Pedestrians

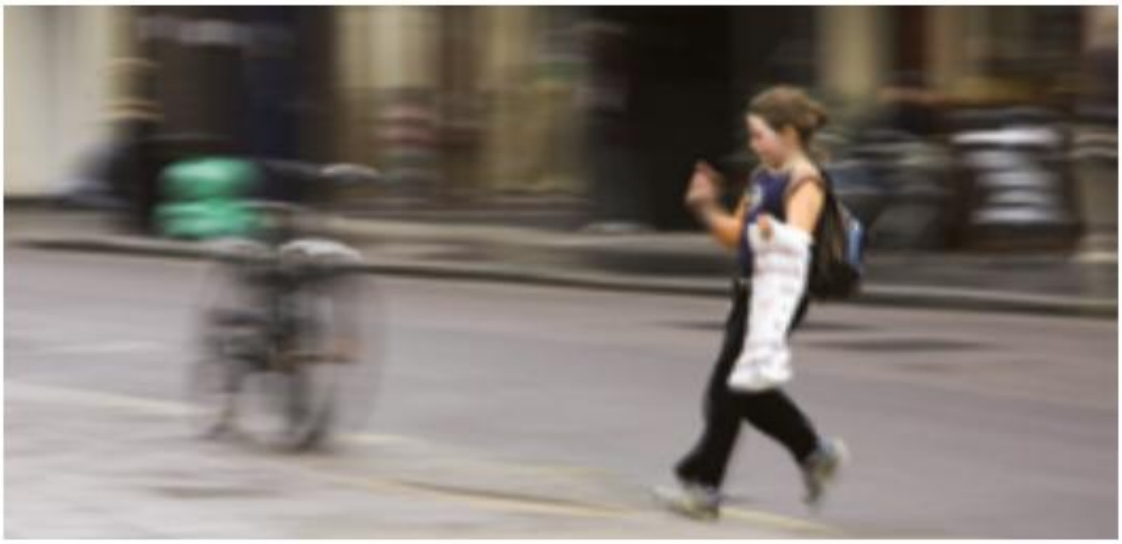
When a vehicle runs over a pedestrian, the pedestrian usually suffers very serious injuries.

They are more likely to die when the accident is on a road outside the city because vehicles travel faster.

Pedestrians being run over happens more in areas where drivers cannot see them well because there is some kind of obstacle.

To avoid being run over, pedestrians must take the following precautions:

- Cross at pedestrian crossings.



- ■ Cross when the traffic light is green.
- ■ Walk in the permitted areas on roads and hard shoulders.
- ■ Wait on the pavement to cross. Not on the road.
- ■ Always look before crossing.
- ■ Check that no other vehicle is coming before getting out of yours.

Drivers must also take measures so as not to run over pedestrians.

- ■ Drive at a moderate speed. Especially within the city.
- ■ Drive more carefully when you reach places where there are pedestrians and other parked vehicles with people inside. Some of these people may get out of the vehicle without looking.
- ■ Do not go through when the traffic light is red or amber.
- ■ Let pedestrians cross when they have priority.
- ■ Take special care when a pedestrian crosses while talking on their mobile phone. They may be

distracted.

- ■ Pay attention to pedestrians who walk in places near areas of parties and entertainment.
- ■ Take special care at the exit of garages.

■ Do not park the vehicle on the pavement.

Vehicles on the pavement force pedestrians to walk on the road.

■ Do not park on pedestrian crossings.

- ■ Do not make changes to the outside of vehicles.
    - The outside of today’s vehicles is designed to cause less damage in collisions with pedestrians.
- ■ Drive more slowly when passing near a bus that is stopped. Especially if it is a bus that takes children to school.
- ■ Drive more carefully on rainy days.

■ Take many precautions when reversing.

There is a system called a pedestrian detector that can detect when there is a pedestrian in front of a vehicle.

It warns the driver and, if they do not respond, the system activates the brakes and stops the vehicle.

Children and older people

The pedestrians who are most at risk of having a road traffic accident are children and older people.

Children

■ They are shorter than adults. This means they can see less of the road and drivers can see them worse.

- ■ They pay less attention to the road because they have less sense of danger.
- ■ They do not know the traffic rules.

Most collisions with children happen when they leave school.

Older people

The main problems that many older people find as pedestrians are:

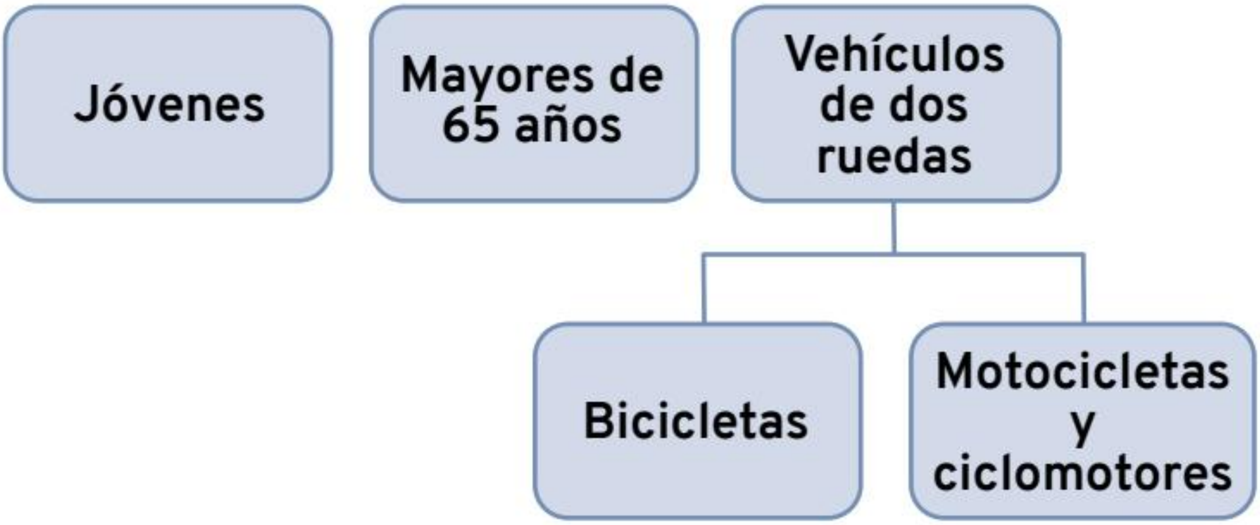
- ■ The noise in the environment does not let them hear a vehicle when it approaches.
- ■ They may have difficulty knowing at what speed a vehicle is coming.
- ■ They may have difficulty distinguishing the colour of traffic lights.
- ■ There are few pedestrian crossings in some areas.
- ■ Some streets are poorly lit and it is harder to cross them.
- ■ Some kerbs are too high.
- ■ There are obstacles on pavements such as plant pots or badly parked cars.
- ■ They may have orientation problems when they do not know the streets well.

Older people have more accidents when they go alone than when they are accompanied by children.

When they go with children they are more cautious to set a good example and to protect them.

Drivers

The drivers with the highest risk of having accidents are:



Young people

In Spain, road traffic accidents are the leading cause of death for young people between 15 and 29 years old.

These accidents happen, above all, in big cities, on the way to and from work, and in places where people go out to party.

The times when more young people die in road traffic accidents are: the summer months, Christmas and weekends.

The hours when there are most of these accidents are at night and in the early hours of the morning.

Main causes of young people's road traffic accidents:

■ Driving at excessive speed.

- ■ Drinking alcohol and taking drugs.
- ■ Not respecting traffic rules.

- ■ Taking many risks when driving.
- ■ Little experience.

■ Competing with other drivers.

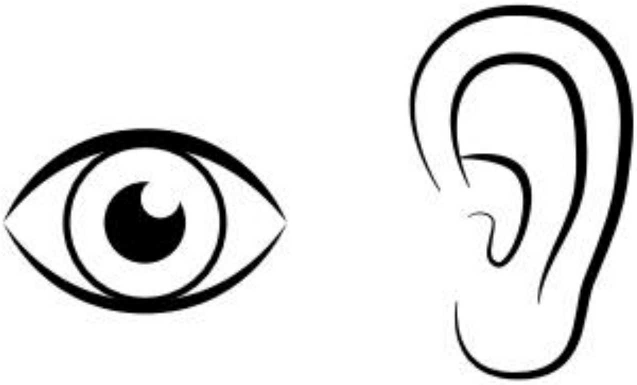
- ■ Not wearing a seat belt or a helmet because they believe they do not need it.
- ■ Following the advice of some advertising that encourages drivers to take risks.

People over 65 years old

These people are usually very cautious when driving and follow traffic rules. But they may have more accidents for the following reasons:

■ They may have less ability to pay attention and need more time to react to something unexpected.

■ Many people over 65 years old see and hear worse.



■ Some older people take medicines that affect driving.

In the event of an accident, older people have more serious injuries and less chance of surviving.

Drivers of two-wheeled vehicles

Two-wheeled vehicles are more fragile and are seen worse than the rest of the vehicles. That is why their drivers must drive with special care.

Bicycles

Cyclist accidents happen more at weekends. Especially when the good weather arrives. There are more accidents within cities, but more cyclists die on roads outside cities. Most of these accidents happen on straight stretches or at junctions due to a collision with another vehicle.

The causes of these accidents may be due to offences committed by cyclists or offences committed by drivers of other vehicles.

Offences committed by cyclists	**Offences committed by drivers of other vehicles**
Distractions.	Distractions.
Riding in the wrong or prohibited direction.	Driving very fast. Overtaking when
Making prohibited turns.	they must not.
Not obeying the Stop sign or the give way sign for other vehicles.	Making prohibited turns.
Entering the road without caution.	

To avoid running over cyclists, drivers of other vehicles must:

- ■ Leave space in front until you overtake them, and leave enough lateral separation when you are overtaking them.

- ■ Do not overtake other vehicles if cyclists are coming in the opposite direction.

■ Take more precautions when there is rain, snow, fog or visibility is poor.

- ■ Do not use the horn near cyclists so as not to frighten them.
- ■ Be careful when there are parked vehicles. Cyclists may appear between these vehicles.
- ■ Drive more carefully near buildings and leisure areas.

Motorcycles and mopeds

The most common accidents in this type of vehicle when overtaking are head-on and side collisions.

Most of these accidents happen within the city.

They have more serious consequences when the people travelling on the motorcycle or moped are not wearing a helmet.

The causes of these accidents may be due to offences committed by moped or motorcycle riders, or due to offences committed by drivers of other vehicles.

Offences committed by	**Offences committed by**
motorcycle riders	drivers
	of other vehicles
Taking the lane	Not respecting
of the road that goes	the right of way
in the opposite direction.	of motorcycles.
Distractions.	Taking the lane of the road that goes in the opposite direction. Distractions.

To avoid accidents with motorcycles and mopeds, drivers of other vehicles must:

- ■ Check that there are no two-wheeled vehicles travelling before changing lane.
- ■ Not stay alongside a two-wheeled vehicle. Travel in front of it or behind it.
- ■ Keep a safe distance from these vehicles.
- ■ Respect situations in which they have the right of way.

■ Be more careful when there is rain, snow, fog, or visibility is poor.

What to do in the event of an accident

Steps to follow

All people who witness a road traffic accident must:

- ■ Attend to the victims or ask for help so that someone helps them.
- ■ Co-operate so that there is no further damage or injuries.
- ■ Help traffic to become safe again when possible.
- ■ Explain what happened to the authorities and emergency services.
- ■ Give your name and contact details to the authorities and to other people involved in the accident. Drivers must also give the details of their vehicle.

When you witness an accident, but you cannot do anything to help or the traffic officers have already arrived, it is best to keep driving so as not to obstruct the accident scene.

Failure to provide assistance

You must always try to help the person who has had an accident.

Anyone who does not do so is committing an offence called failure to provide assistance, that is, not helping, and may go to prison.

This offence is committed by the person who:

- ■ Does not help the victims of an accident when they can do so without putting themselves in danger.
- ■ Does not report the accident so that someone comes to help.
- ■ Causes an accident and flees instead of helping.

Important moments after an accident

After an accident there are three moments when people are at risk of dying:

First moment	**The first seconds after the accident. It is called immediate death.**
Second moment	One or two hours after the accident. In this period, resuscitation work is very important to try to save life. It is called the golden hour.
Last moment	Days or weeks after the accident. It is called late mortality.

PAS rule

What is it?

These are the guidelines that must be followed to help a person who has had an accident. These guidelines are:

Ver vídeo

It is very important to follow the PAS rule in the first 10 minutes after the accident. Acting quickly helps to:

- ■ Save lives.
- ■ Prevent a more serious accident from happening.
- ■ Prevent the person from suffering more harm.
- ■ Prevent material damage. For example, more vehicles and road elements being damaged.

Protect Alert Assist

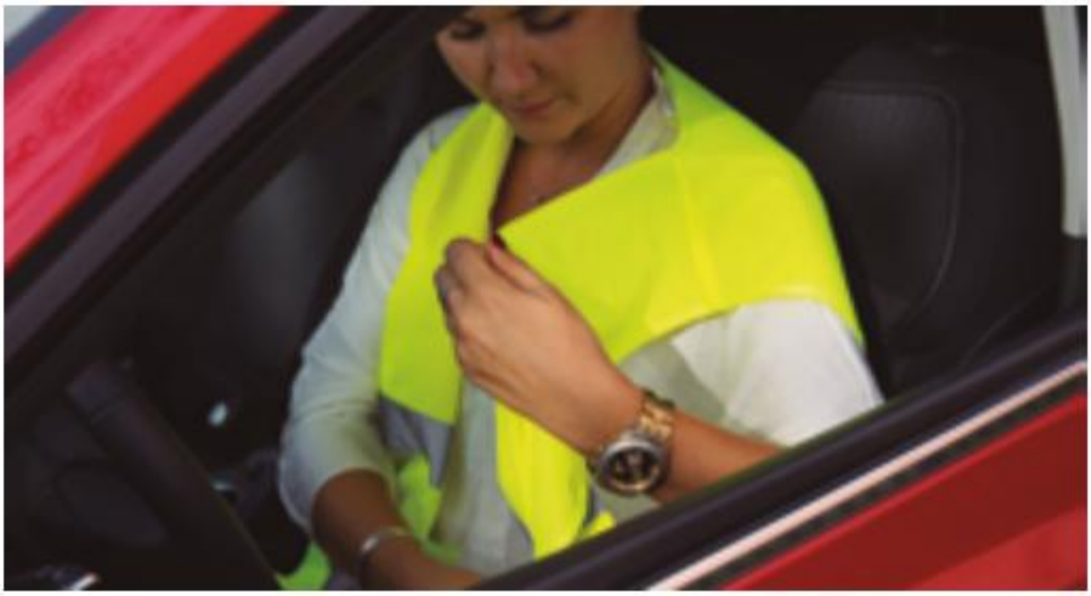
Protect

What must you protect?

- ■ Yourself. Do not put yourself in danger or risk having an accident.
- ■ The victims.
- ■ The accident scene. Mark the place so that it can be seen clearly, prevent more accidents, and help the emergency services find the place more easily.

What steps must you take to protect?

- ■ Keep calm.
- ■ Stop and park the vehicle in a safe place, leaving access for the emergency services.
- ■ Stop the engine and switch on the hazard warning lights.
- ■ Put on the reflective vest before getting out of the vehicle. This vest must be **approved** to ensure that it meets all safety rules. It can be yellow, orange, or red.



Approved. It is officially registered and meets the characteristics set by law.

- ■ Observe the situation to assess the seriousness of the accident and decide how to help.
- ■ Mark the accident area to warn other vehicles.
- ■ Apply the handbrake of all vehicles involved in the accident to make sure none of them moves.
- ■ Do not smoke or light a fire at the accident scene to prevent a fire.

If the fire has already started, try to put it out with a fire extinguisher or by throwing earth, sand, or blankets over the fire.

You must not throw water on the fire.

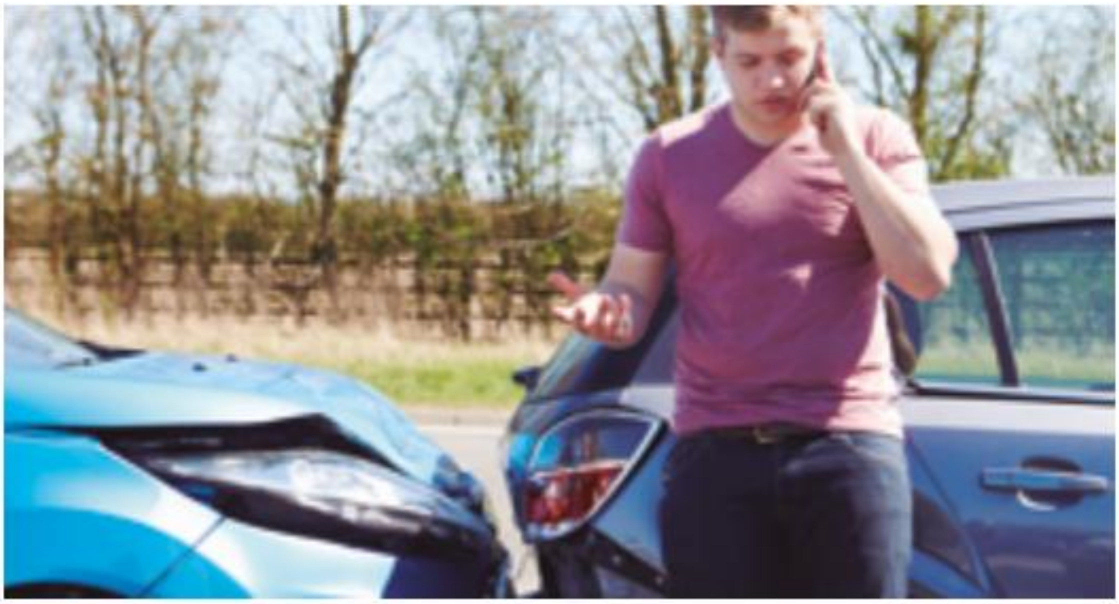
- ■ Help the area to become safe again and traffic to be able to move again.
- ■ Try not to touch or move people or things if there are dead people or people with very serious injuries.

Alert

Before alerting the emergency services, you should try to gather as much information as possible to make it easier for the necessary services to come and do their job well.

For example, report if there is a fire so that the fire brigade comes. Or explain how many injured people there are so they know how many ambulances they must send.

To ask for help you must call the emergency number 112 from your mobile. If you do not have a mobile, you can go to the nearest SOS post to report it.



You must stay at the accident scene or nearby until the authorities and emergency services arrive.

In some vehicles there is a system called eCall.

This system automatically sends a message to 112 in the event of an accident so that the emergency services go to the place, even if nobody alerts them.

Assist

You must help the injured quickly but keeping calm.

You must stay with the injured and not leave them alone.

General rules for assisting.

- ■ Do not move the injured unless it is necessary to get them to safety.
- ■ Keep the neck protected from sudden movements. You can place clothing, sand, or your hands at the sides of the injured person’s neck. Never under the neck.

- ■ Do not remove the injured person’s helmet.
- ■ Loosen any clothing that is tight on the body.
- ■ Do not give medicines, food, or drinks to the injured.
- ■ Do not apply ointments or alcohol to their wounds.

■ Cover the injured with clothing or thin blankets so that they keep their body temperature.

■ If in doubt about how to act, talk to the injured and give them emotional support. It is better not to touch or move them if you are not sure how to do it because you could make their injuries worse.

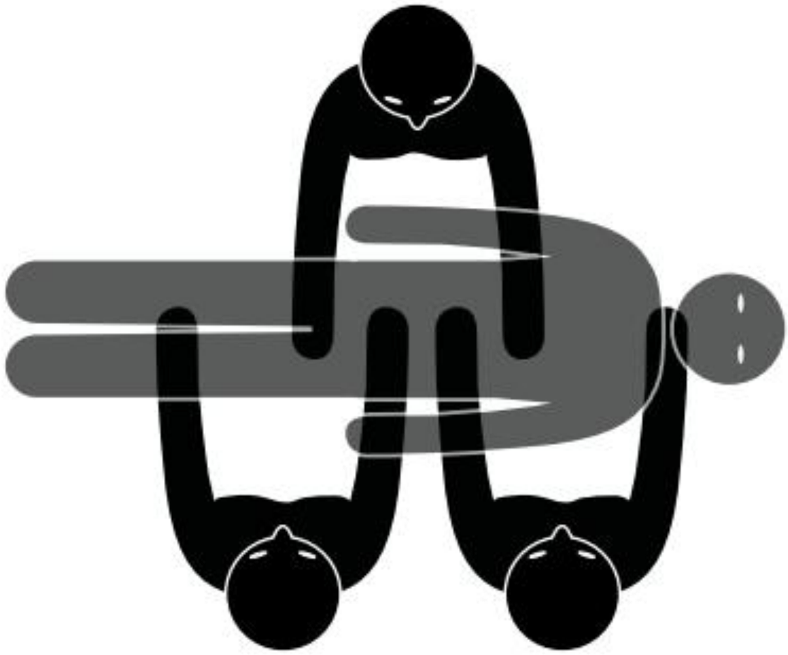
How should you move an injured person?

When it is necessary to move an injured person because in that place their life is in danger, it must be done by three people, to move them as if they were a single block.

The three people must be co-ordinated so as not to move their neck and to ensure that the head, neck, and body remain aligned.

To remove an injured person from their vehicle, you must follow these steps:

- ■ Pass your arms under their armpits, carefully.
- ■ Hold their arm with one hand and support the chin with the other.
- ■ Remove the person from the vehicle slowly and keep their head, neck, and trunk in the same line, as if it were a block.
- ■ Place them in a safe place.



First aid

Vital signs

In road traffic accidents, the parts of the body that usually suffer the most damage are the head and the legs.

To know how serious the injured are, the first step is to check their vital signs, always following the same order.

Consciousness Breathing

Consciousness

To know if a person is conscious you can ask: Are you OK? If they do not answer, you can give a small pinch to see if they react with any movement or sound.

How to act depending on their reaction?

The injured person responds by answering or moving	The injured person does not respond and does not move
Do not move the injured person.	They are unconscious.
Check if they have bleeding, burns, or fractures.	Check if they are breathing.
Observe them every few minutes to see if there are changes.	

Breathing

Steps to follow to check if a person is breathing:

- ■ Look at their chest to see if it moves.
- ■ Bring your face close to their mouth to hear their breathing and feel on your cheek the air coming out of their mouth. When the person is face down, turn them to place them face up and lift their chin to open their airways.

■ Check for normal breathing for 10 seconds. Normal breathing for an adult is between 15 and 20 breaths per minute. Normal breathing for a baby is between 30 and 40 breaths per minute. Normal breathing for a child is between 26 and 30 breaths per minute.

How to act depending on their reaction?

Breathing normally

It is a sign that the heart is working.

Check if they have bleeding, burns, or fractures.

Stay by their side until the emergency services arrive.

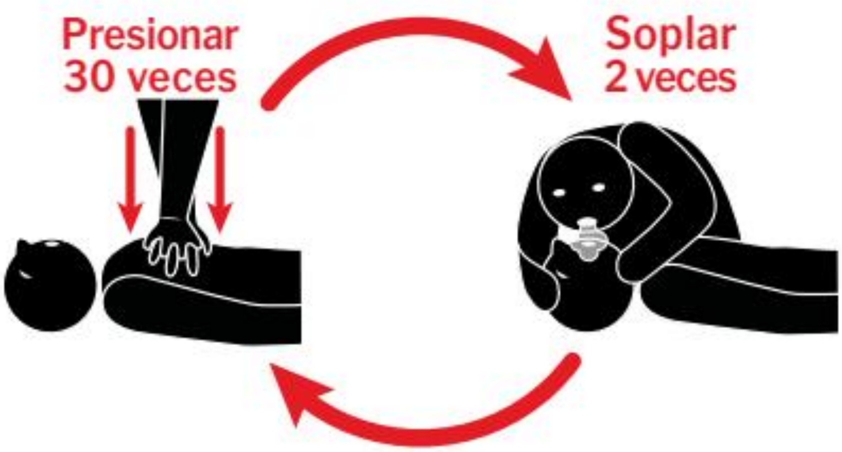
Place them on their side if you have to leave them alone to attend to other injured people.

Not breathing normally

Start cardiopulmonary resuscitation until the emergency services arrive, as follows:

- ■ Place both hands with fingers interlocked on top of the chest of the person who is not breathing.
- ■ With your elbows straight, push your hands up and down about 100 times per minute.
- ■ Give 2 mouth-to-mouth breaths after every 30 chest compressions so that air enters the injured

person’s mouth.



Continue like this until medical help arrives.

Knowing the condition of injured people

When the injured person is conscious and breathing, you must check whether they have other types of injuries or wounds.

To assess their condition, you must take into account whether there are:

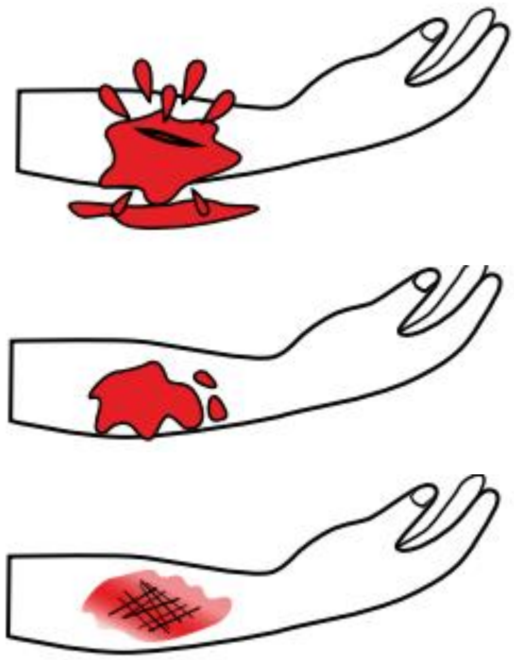
Haemorrhages

What is it?

Losing a lot of blood because blood vessels have been damaged. A person can go into **shock** or die if they lose a lot of blood.

Shock. Danger of death because the body does not receive the blood it needs.

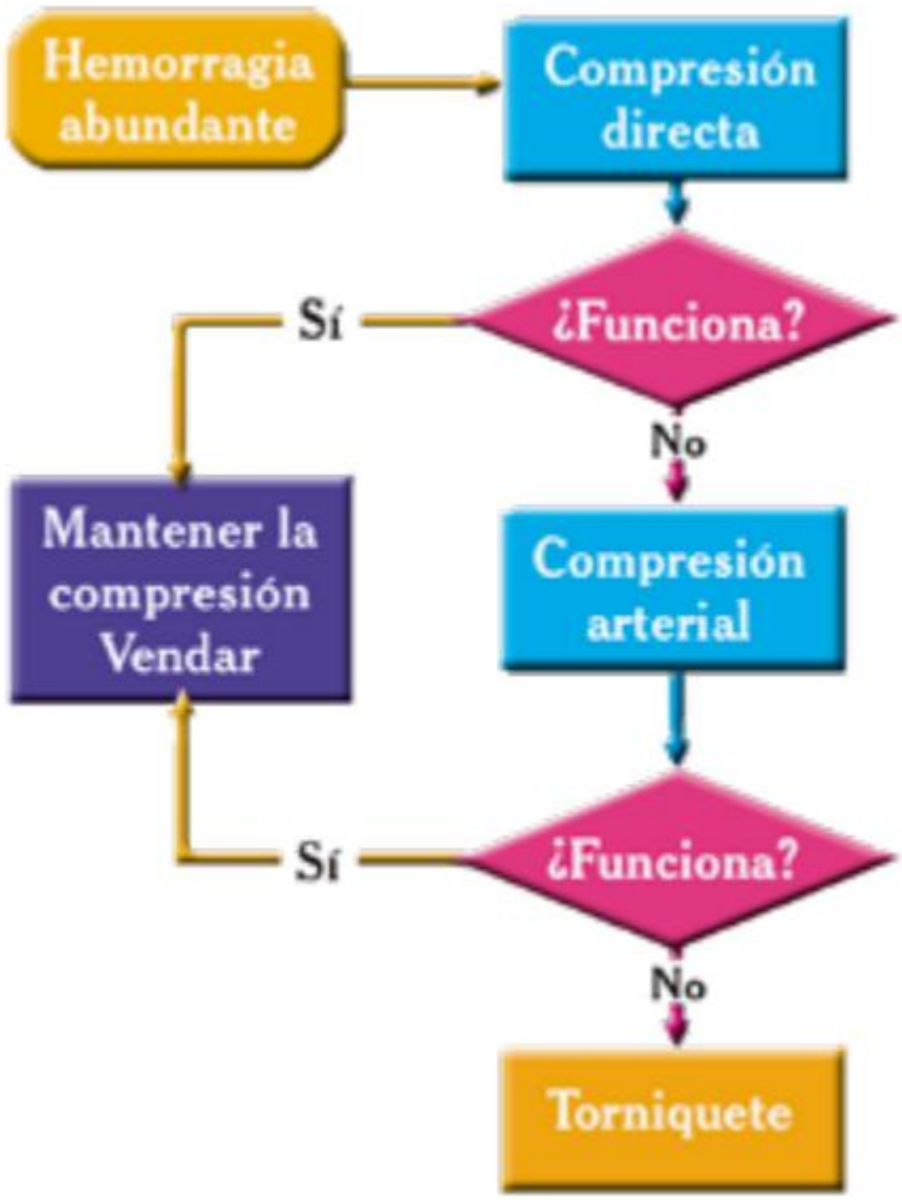
When the haemorrhage happens because an object has become stuck in the person's body, you must not try to remove the object.



The haemorrhage can be external or internal.

External haemorrhage

Blood comes out of the person's body. To control an external haemorrhage, three methods can be used:



Direct pressure

- ■ Press on the wound with your hand or fist using a gauze pad or a cloth that is as clean as possible.
- ■ Do not remove the gauze pad or cloth, even if it becomes soaked with blood.
- ■ If the wound is on an arm or a leg, keep the arm or leg raised.

Arterial pressure

Artery. Tube that carries blood from the heart to all parts of the body.

- ■ It is used when direct pressure fails.
- ■ Press the main artery of the arm or leg to stop blood circulation.
- ■ Keep the area pressed until the emergency services arrive.

Tourniquet

- ■ It is only applied for haemorrhages in arms and legs when direct pressure and arterial pressure have not worked.
- ■ Tourniquets are usually made with a folded cloth. Do not use very thin objects.
- ■ It is done above the place where the wound is. Never below.
- ■ You must write on a piece of paper the time when the tourniquet was applied and the place where it has been placed.
- ■ Only medical staff can remove the tourniquet.

Internal haemorrhage

It happens inside the body and cannot be seen. But you can know that there is this type of haemorrhage because the injured person goes into *shock*.

What symptoms does a person in *shock* have?

- ■ They breathe very fast and shallowly.
- ■ The pulse is fast and weak.
- ■ Their skin is pale and their sweat is cold and sticky.
- ■ They say things that do not make sense.

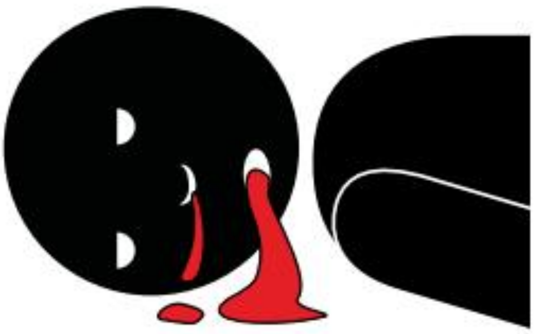
In these cases, you must place the injured person lying down with their feet higher than their head. If they are vomiting, place them on their side and keep their feet higher than their head.

Ver vídeo

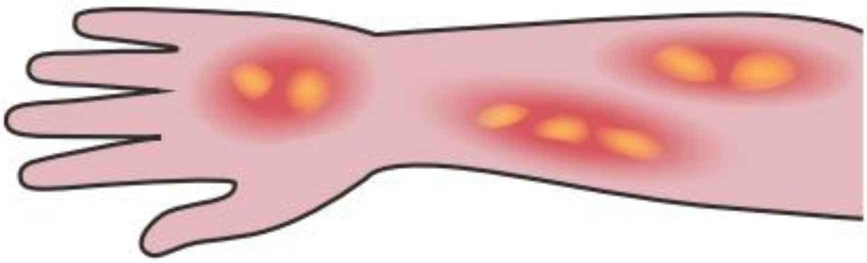
There is a type of internal haemorrhage in which the wound cannot be seen, but the blood does come out of the body through an opening such as the nose, the ear, or the mouth.

These haemorrhages are called externalised. In these cases you must:

- ■ Treat the injured person as very serious.
- ■ Do not plug or stop these haemorrhages.
- ■ Put the injured person on their side if there is a risk that they may choke.
- ■ When the blood from the haemorrhage comes out through the ear, you must cover it with a gauze pad, without pressing.



Burns



What to do in case of burns?

- ■ Do not touch the burnt area.
- ■ Do not remove clothing that has stuck to that area.
- ■ Pour cold water over the burnt area.
- ■ Do not cut or burst blisters.
- ■ Apply a disinfected and damp dressing.
- ■ Do not bandage two burnt areas together.
- ■ When the burnt area is on an arm or a leg, keep that arm or leg raised so that it swells less.
- ■ You can give the injured person water to drink as long as they have no other injuries, are conscious, and do not vomit.

Fracture

A fracture is a broken bone.

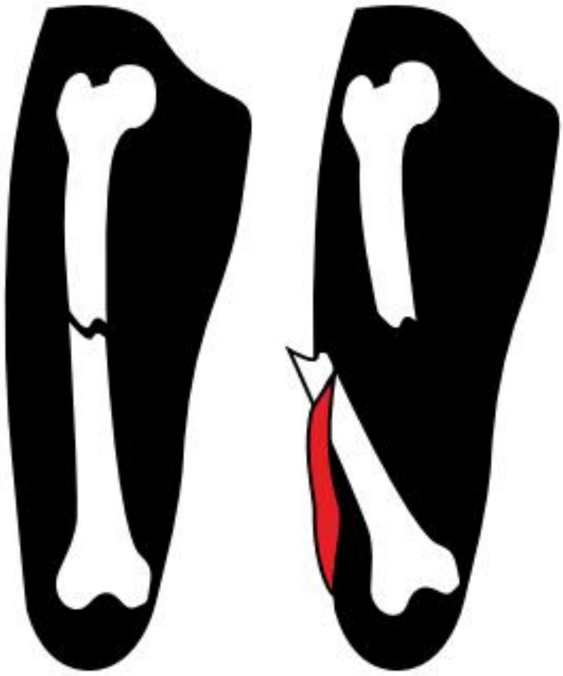
What are the symptoms of a fracture?

- ■ Severe pain in the area.
- ■ The area swells or becomes deformed.
- ■ The person cannot move that area or has difficulty doing so.
- ■ When the fracture is in the spine, the person cannot move and loses sensation.

What to do in case of a fracture?

- ■ Keep the fracture area immobile.

- ■ Prevent the injured person from moving that area.
- ■ Cover the wound if there is one.



Transporting injured people

You must always wait for the ambulance to arrive to transport injured people to hospital.

You should only transport injured people to hospital without waiting for the ambulance in these cases:

- ■ The accident has happened in an isolated place where you cannot ask the emergency services for help.
- ■ The emergency services take more than 30 minutes to arrive and the injured person is unconscious or has a haemorrhage that cannot be controlled.

The transport should be done, if possible, in a van or lorry so that the injured person can lie down. You must drive slowly and smoothly.


SEAPA

Contents

Preparing the journey

Safety checks

Before starting a journey in a car or in a vehicle that transports goods, you must check that you have:

- ■ The warning light or the triangles that you must place on the road in case of breakdown or accident.
- ■ A reflective vest.
- ■ A spare wheel.

It is also advisable to carry a first aid kit.

People who wear glasses are recommended to carry a spare pair.

Choosing the route

Before starting the journey, you must plan the route you are going to follow by looking at a map.

It is important to choose the safest and most comfortable route, taking into account which roads have roadworks, the weather, and the number of vehicles using each road that day.

You must also plan the breaks you are going to take during the journey.

When you travel in winter, you must take the following precautions:

- ■ Carry snow chains in the vehicle.
- ■ Avoid driving at night.
- ■ Travel with a full fuel tank.
- ■ Carry warm clothes, water, food, and a torch in the vehicle.

Defensive driving

What is it?

A way of driving that allows you to anticipate unexpected events that may happen during the journey.

In defensive driving, the driver:

- ■ Gathers the necessary information before starting the journey to drive safely.
- ■ Anticipates unexpected events that may happen and reacts well to them.
- ■ Adapts to the circumstances at each moment of the journey.

To drive defensively, you must follow a technique based on three principles:

Ver vídeo

	What does it consist of?
Vision	Look in all directions to gather information and not focus on things that may be a distraction.
Anticipation	Predict the movements and reactions of other drivers so you can react in time.
Space	Keep a safe distance from the rest of the vehicles at all times.

Vision

Look far ahead

Look to the sides

Look far ahead

You must look far ahead to control what happens in the space your vehicle will cover in the next 20 seconds.

This way you can anticipate dangerous situations and avoid harsh braking and sudden acceleration.

The faster you drive, the further ahead you must look.

Look to the sides

It takes us longer to see what happens at the sides than what happens in front.

That is why it is necessary to keep checking all the time what is happening to the left and to the right during the journey.

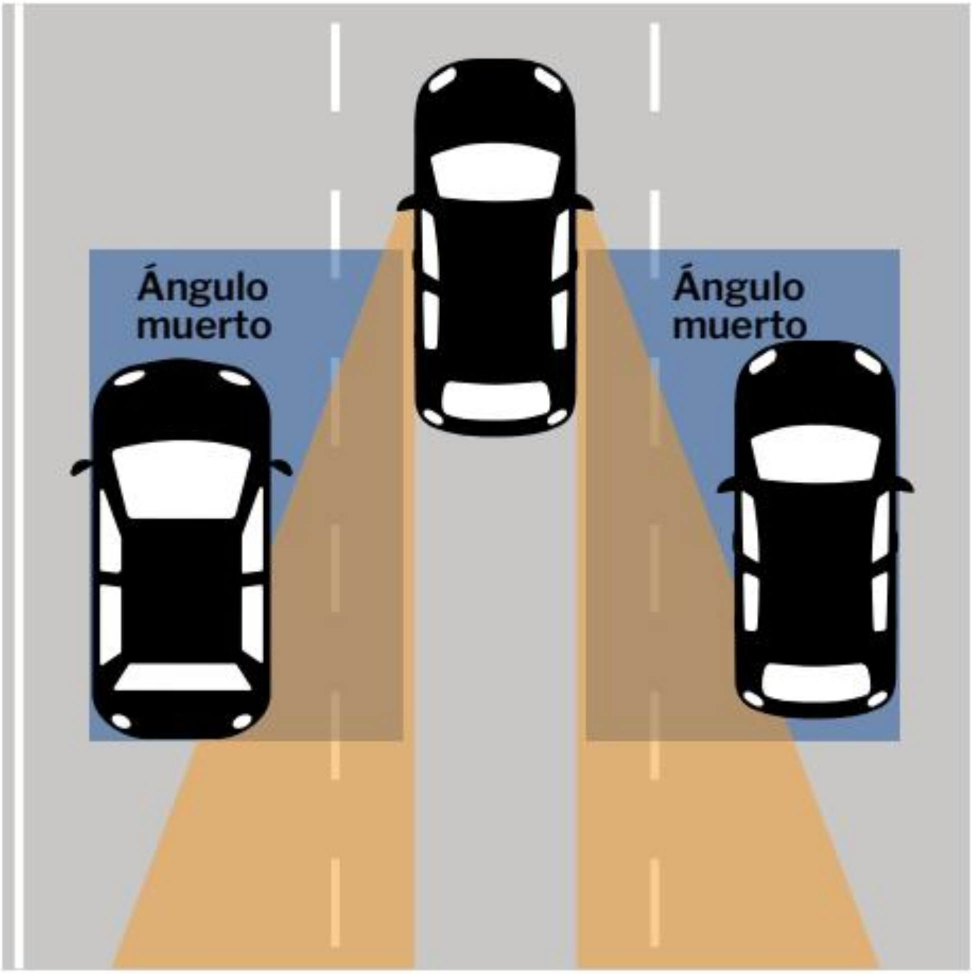
This is done through the rear-view mirrors because they allow you to see what happens behind and to the sides of the vehicle.

You must look at them during the journey, even if you are not going to do any manoeuvre. How often you look at them will depend on the type of road you are on.

You look at them quickly, briefly, so you keep paying attention to the rest of the road.

You must bear in mind that there is always a space on both sides of the vehicle that you cannot see, even if your rear-view mirrors are well adjusted.

These spaces are called blind spots and they are dangerous because you cannot control what is happening in that place.



Ver vídeo

To make sure there is no other vehicle in the blind spot area, you can turn your head and look through the window.

It is important to check that there is no other vehicle in the blind spot before steering the vehicle towards that side to change lanes.

Blind spot detector (BSM)

There is a system that warns you when there is another vehicle in the blind spot area that is moving towards your vehicle.

In those cases, a light that is placed in the rear-view mirror comes on.

Some blind spot detectors light up whenever another vehicle is in the blind spot area.

Other detectors only light up if you activate the indicator to change lanes and there is another vehicle in the blind spot.

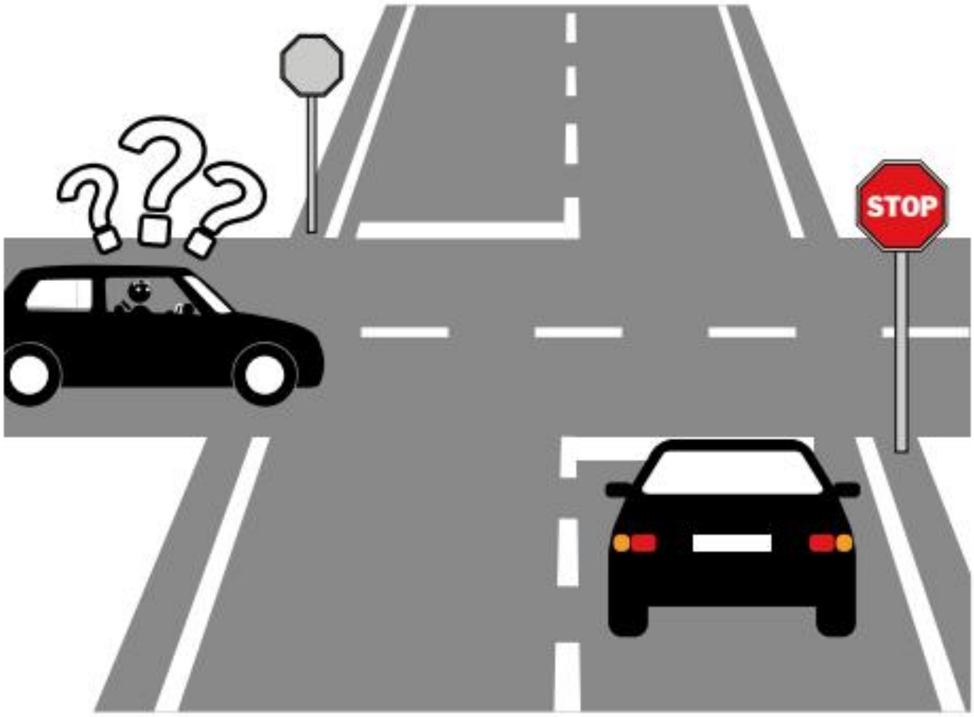
Ver vídeo

Anticipation

Ver vídeo

To avoid risks and react quickly to unexpected events on the road, you must:

- ■ Keep a speed suitable for your circumstances, the vehicle's circumstances, and the road's circumstances at all times.
- ■ Switch on the lights that are necessary at each moment so that other vehicles can see you and know what movement you are going to make.
- ■ Do not stay for a long time in the blind spot of another vehicle's rear-view mirrors. Especially if you are driving alongside or behind a very large vehicle.
- ■ Always signal the manoeuvres you are going to do for as long as necessary.



Controlling space

Space in front Space behind

Space at the sides

Space when stopping the vehicle

Space in front

It is advisable to have two or three seconds of separation between your vehicle and the one in front.

That is, it should take you two or three seconds to reach it at the speed you are travelling.

However, there are circumstances in which you must leave at least one more second of space.

These circumstances are:

- ■ There is rain, snow, fog, or it is night.
- ■ The vehicle behind is getting too close.

Rear space

Sometimes it is the vehicle behind that gets too close.

What you must do in those situations is:

- ■ Leave more safe distance from the vehicle in front so you do not brake sharply if something unexpected happens.
- ■ Signal the manoeuvres you are going to do earlier.
- ■ Brake smoothly and with enough time so that the driver of the vehicle behind can react.

Space at the sides

You must drive at a suitable speed and keep the necessary separation distance when overtaking other vehicles or passing them in the opposite direction.

For example, when changing lane or opening the vehicle door to get out.

You should try to stay out of other vehicles' blind spot area.

Space when stopping the vehicle

When you stop the vehicle for some reason, such as a traffic light or a traffic jam, you must keep a distance of at least two or three metres from the vehicle in front.

In this way:

- ■ You will have time to warn the driver in front if they roll their vehicle backwards.
- ■ You will be able to overtake the vehicle in front if it stays parked for some reason.

- ■ You will not hit the vehicle in front if another vehicle hits yours from behind.

Also, the driver of the last vehicle in the queue, to avoid rear-end collisions, can:

- ■ Keep a distance of five or six metres from the vehicle in front.
- ■ Keep the brake pressed and switch on the hazard warning lights in a traffic jam so that they can be seen better.
- ■ Look in the rear-view mirror and watch the vehicles coming from behind.

Efficient driving

What is it?

A way of driving in which less fuel is used, it helps to pollute less, and driving is safer.

What is achieved with efficient driving?

- ■ Improve air quality because fewer polluting gases are released into the atmosphere.
- ■ Save money because less is spent on fuel and on vehicle maintenance.
- ■ Increase safety because techniques similar to those of defensive driving are used.
- ■ Make passengers travel more comfortably because sharp braking is avoided and there are no big changes in speed.
- ■ Reduce the noise vehicles make when driving.

Pollution

Vehicles pollute because they produce toxic gases that reach the atmosphere.

The measures you can take to pollute less with your vehicle are:

- ■ Check the engine frequently so that it does not give off clouds of smoke.
- ■ Do not accelerate sharply when the vehicle is stopped and starts moving again.
- ■ Use the horn only when necessary.
- ■ Secure the load properly so that it does not move and make noise by hitting the vehicle.
- ■ Prevent oil or other vehicle fluids from falling onto the road.

■ Do not wash the vehicle on the road. It must be washed in places prepared for it.

- ■ Do not throw objects onto the road that could dirty it, start fires, or cause accidents.
- ■ Do not make unnecessary noise or emit more gases or smoke than allowed.

Vehicles have a device in the exhaust pipe called a catalytic converter. The catalytic converter is responsible for reducing the pollution produced by the gases that come out of the exhaust pipe.

When the vehicle battery is flat, you must not try to start the engine by pushing the vehicle. Unburnt fuel can reach the catalytic converter and destroy it.

Techniques for driving efficiently

When starting and moving off

When accelerating and changing gear

When choosing the speed

When slowing down and stopping

When starting and moving off

- ■ Start the engine without pressing the accelerator.
- ■ Start driving just after starting the engine.
- ■ Start driving at low speed and increase it when the engine warms up. Driving at high speed with a cold engine makes it use more fuel and makes the engine wear out sooner.

Ver vídeo

When accelerating and changing gear

- ■ Accelerate gradually by pressing the pedal smoothly.
- ■ Start driving in first gear. In this gear the engine has a lot of power, but it goes at very low speed.
- ■ Change to second gear after a few seconds. In this gear the vehicle has a little less power and goes a bit faster.
- ■ After that, you can increase speed smoothly and little by little.

The vehicle uses less fuel in fourth and fifth gear, which is when the engine runs at higher speed and has less power.

In the city you should try to use the highest possible gear, always respecting the speed limits.

When choosing the speed you drive at

From 80 or 90 kilometres per hour, the vehicle uses much more fuel and pollutes more.

Changing speed many times also makes more fuel be used. In addition, it makes the driver get more tired.

You should travel at a constant speed, that does not change all the time, and avoid sharp braking and sudden acceleration.

When slowing down and stopping the vehicle To slow down the vehicle you have to:

- ■ Lift your foot off the accelerator and let the vehicle roll.
- ■ Use the brake smoothly to reduce speed little by little.
- ■ Switch off the engine when the vehicle is going to be stopped for more than one minute.

What makes more fuel be used?

- ■ **Street air**

- ■ **Not having the vehicle serviced**
- ■ **Driving in towns or cities**
- ■ **Using the air conditioning**
- ■ **Carrying a lot of weight**

Street air

Most of the fuel that is used is spent on fighting against the air that does not let the vehicle move forward.

Some of the elements fitted to the vehicle make it harder to fight against the air and, therefore, it uses more fuel.

For example, the roof rack or the **deflectors**.

Deflectors. Accessory fitted to the vehicle to divert the air and prevent it from entering the interior.

So that the vehicle does not use so much fuel because of the air,

the following measures can be taken:

■ Do not fit a roof rack to the vehicle. It is better for luggage and other loads to go in the boot.

■ Do not lower the vehicle windows while it is moving.

■ Do not tow a trailer or caravan. Especially if the trailer or caravan is wider or taller than the vehicle.

Not having the vehicle serviced

Having the vehicle serviced and checking that it is in good condition helps to use less fuel.

To save fuel you must check:

- ■ The ignition system. The spark plugs must be checked following the manufacturer's instructions.
- ■ The cooling and lubrication systems.
- ■ Tyre inflation. They must be properly inflated.

■ The engine fuel system. The air filter must be changed when necessary and the **idle speed** must be kept at the correct value.

Idle speed. The engine's ability to run without the driver pressing the accelerator.

An idle speed that is too high will make more fuel be used.

Driving in towns or cities

In towns and cities more fuel is used even though vehicles drive more slowly than on other roads.

Ver vídeo

The reasons are that there are more traffic jams, the vehicle has to stop more times, you have to change gear more, and the engine is forced more.

To save fuel in towns and cities and not suffer traffic jams, it is advisable to:

- ■ Not use the vehicle for short distances.
- ■ Use public transport.
- ■ Avoid driving at the busiest traffic times.
- ■ Choose the route with fewer vehicles, even if it is the longer route.

Ver vídeo

Using the air conditioning

Using the air conditioning in the vehicle uses more fuel.

It is advisable to have a temperature inside the vehicle of 23 or 24 degrees.

Carrying a lot of weight

A vehicle uses more fuel when it is carrying a lot of weight.

That is why you should try to carry only the amount of luggage and loads that are necessary.

It is also important to distribute the load well in the vehicle to use less fuel.

False measures to save fuel

Some measures used to save fuel are false and must not be done because they harm the vehicle.

These measures are:

- ■ Putting a fuel in the vehicle that is different from the one specified by the manufacturer. An unsuitable fuel will break the vehicle's engine.
- ■ Going downhill in **neutral**. The vehicle may lose stability and you will have to use the brakes too much.
- ■ Not spending money on the necessary vehicle maintenance. Worn parts and faults will make more fuel be used.

Neutral. Position of the gearbox in which the engine's movement is not transmitted to the wheels.

New techniques to use less fuel

Start-Stop *function*

This system automatically starts and stops the engine when the vehicle stops for a moment at a traffic light, in a traffic jam, or for other reasons.

In this way, when the vehicle is stopped it does not use fuel and does not release gases that pollute the environment.

Eco mode

This system gives the option to set the engine to lower power and speed to save fuel.

It takes into account all the elements that make a vehicle use fuel to know how it can work without using full power and speed.

By limiting the vehicle's speed and temperature, less fuel is used.

Eco mode is switched on and off manually in each vehicle.

Environmental labels

What are they?

A way of classifying vehicles depending on the pollution caused by their gases and the damage they do to the environment.

There are four different types of environmental labels.

Cero emisiones   Eco   B   C

The information shown on each label is:

The aim of this classification is to give preference to vehicles that harm the environment less.

City authorities can:

■ Create low-emission zones in the city. These are zones that only vehicles that harm the environment less can enter. This is done to improve air quality. Low-emission zones are indicated with a vertical sign. Only vehicles that have the environmental label shown on the lower part of the sign will be able to enter that zone.

- ■ Decide which vehicles can enter the city centre on days when there is a lot of air pollution.
- ■ Give economic or traffic benefits to vehicles that help to protect the environment.

For example, they may allow vehicles with the “zero emissions” label to use the VAO lane, even if only the driver is travelling in the vehicle.

Environmental badges must be placed in front of the windscreen, on the right-hand side of the vehicle’s front glass.

In vehicles that do not have a windscreen, it will be placed in a visible place.

Shared vehicles

Another measure to protect the environment is the use of shared vehicles.

This initiative means that a person can hire a **vehicle through an application (App)** for hours or minutes and share it with other people.

Shared-use vehicles carry this badge.

Points annex. The points-based driving licence

Contents

How many points does each driver have? Losing points What offences take points off the driving licence?

Points annex. The points-based driving licence

The aim of the points-based driving licence is to reduce the number of road traffic accidents.

How many points does each driver have?

Drivers who start driving have 8 points during the first two years. If during that time they do not lose any points, they will move to 12 points.

Drivers who keep the 12 points for three more years will get another two points. Therefore, they will have 14.

Drivers who keep the 14 points for another three more years will get another point.

The maximum number of points a driver can get is 15.

Type of driver	Points
New drivers	8
Drivers with more than two years of driving licence	12
Drivers with more than five years of driving licence	14
Drivers with more than eight years of driving licence	15

Losing points

A driver loses points when they commit some offences or penalties while driving.

A person who loses all the points will not be able to drive again until six months have passed.

After those six months, they will have to do a 24-hour course and an exam at the Traffic Headquarters to recover the points and the driving licence.

If, in the following three years, they lose all the points again, they will have to wait 12 more months to recover them again.

Drivers who only lose some points can recover them again if they do not lose any more in two years.

In addition, they can do a 12-hour road safety education course to recover up to 6 points.

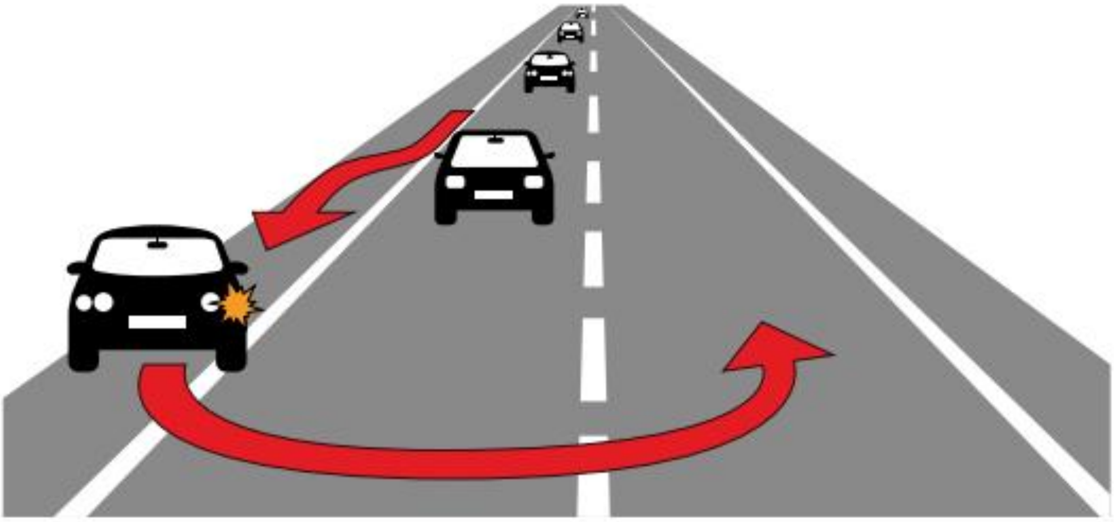
What offences take points off the driving licence?

Offences that take 2 to 6 points

■ Driving faster than the permitted speed. The number of points lost for this offence will depend on the speed at which the vehicle is travelling in each case.

Offences that take 3 points

■ Making a U-turn where it is not permitted.



Points annex. The points-based driving licence

■ Driving with helmets or headphones connected to the mobile phone or to another electronic device.

■ Carrying in the vehicle devices to detect **speed cameras.**

Speed camera. System used to detect an object, know how far away it is and at what speed it is travelling.

Offences that take 4 points

■ Driving with a blood alcohol level between 0,25 and 0,50 milligrams of alcohol per litre of air.

Professional drivers and those who have had their driving licence for less than two years will lose the 4 points with a blood alcohol level between 0,15 and 0,30 milligrams of alcohol per litre of air.

Points annex. The points-based driving licence

- ■ Driving a vehicle with a licence that does not authorise you to drive it. For example, driving a car when the driver’s licence only authorises them to drive motorcycles.
- ■ Not complying with right-of-way rules for other drivers or pedestrians and not stopping at Stop, Give Way signs and at red traffic lights.
- ■ Overtaking other drivers in places where it is prohibited.
- ■ Reversing on motorways or dual carriageways.
- ■ Not respecting or complying with the signals and orders of traffic officers.

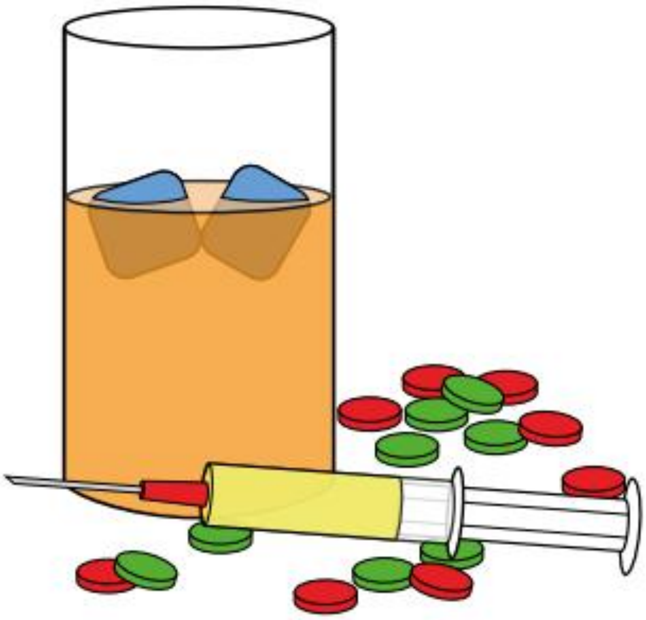
- ■ Not keeping a safe distance from the vehicle in front.
- ■ Driving a vehicle when the driver has lost their driving licence for committing offences.
- ■ Not wearing the seat belt, the helmet, child restraint systems for children, and other compulsory safety systems.

Offences that take 6 points

■ Driving with a blood alcohol level higher than 0,50 milligrams of alcohol per litre of air.

Professional drivers and those who have had their driving licence for less than two years will lose the 6 points with a blood alcohol level higher than 0,30 milligrams of alcohol per litre of air.

■ Driving after taking drugs or when some of these drugs are still in the body.



■ Refusing to take tests to detect alcohol or drugs in the body.

Points annex. The points-based driving licence

- ■ Driving in the opposite direction to that permitted, taking part in illegal races, or endangering other people's lives while driving.
- ■ Driving vehicles that have mechanisms installed so that speed cameras do not detect them and do not know what speed they are travelling at.
- ■ Driving for more than half of the permitted time or taking shorter breaks than permitted (for professional drivers). For example, driving for 6 hours in a row if the time limit is 4 hours, or resting

for 10 minutes when breaks of at least 20 minutes are required.

- ■ Fitting elements in the vehicle that change how the devices that limit speed work, or the ones that count the time the professional driver has been driving.
- ■ Driving with the mobile phone in your hand.
- ■ Throwing objects onto the road that can cause fires or accidents.
- ■ Overtaking while endangering cyclists or without leaving at least 1,5 metres of separation from them.

Contributors: